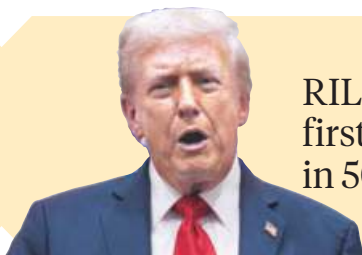


THE MARKETS ON WEDNESDAY			change †
Sensex	76,863.7	▼	1,342.3
Nifty	23,866.8	▼	394.8
Nifty Futures‡	23,939.1	▲	72.3
Dollar	₹92.0		₹91.8 ‡
Euro	₹106.7		₹107.0 ‡
Brent Crude (\$/bbl)	90.8 *		90.5 ‡
Gold (10gm)**	₹1,59,588.0	▲	₹41.0

† Over previous close; ‡ (Mar) Premium on Nifty Spot; * Futures price at 6 pm IST; ‡ Previous close; * At 9pm IST; ** Market rate exclusive of GST; Source: BBJA



Don't panic, fuel car-
goes on the way: Govt



RIL to invest in US'
first major refinery
in 50 years: Trump

'Death with dignity':
In a first, SC allows
passive euthanasia



3 Transformative Days

30 Trailblazing Sessions

A powerful exchange of ideas shaping the blueprint for
Punjab's next-generation industrial revolution.



13th March 2026

- 2.30–4.15 PM • Parallel Country Sessions
- 4.30–5.45 PM • Plenary Session — Brand Mohali



14th March 2026

- 11:00 AM–12:15 PM • Plenary Session — Academia & Research
- 11:00 AM–12:00 PM • Textile (Apparels & Technical Textiles) | Aerospace & Defence | Bicycle & e-Bikes | Startups
- 12:30–01:30 PM • Auto & Auto Components & EVs | Heavy Machinery & Agri-Implements | Tourism & Hospitality | Cattle Feed & Dairy Processing | Textile: Spinning & Weaving | Hospitals & Healthcare
- 02:30–03:45 PM • Plenary Session — Exports & Logistics
- 02:30–03:30 PM • Renewable Energy | Agri & Food Processing | Plastic & Chemical Products
- 04:00–5:00 PM • Sports & Leather Goods | Steel & Rolling Mills | Pharmaceuticals & Biotechnology | Textile: Dyeing & Finishing | Hand & Machine Tools, Power Tools | Electronic System Design & Manufacturing
- 05:15–06:30 PM • Plenary Session– Artificial Intelligence



15th March 2026

- 10:00–11:15 AM • Plenary Session — MSME
- 10:00–11:00 AM • Media & Entertainment | IT/ITeS and Furniture & Ply Industry
- 12:00–1:30 PM • Valedictory Session

Join us at

Progressive Punjab Investors' Summit 2026



13–15 March 2026



Plaksha University, Mohali



S. Bhagwant Singh Mann
Chief Minister, Punjab



ODISHA GRAMEEN BANK
INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY DEPARTMENT, HEAD OFFICE,
GANDAMUNDA, KHANDAGIRI, BHUBANESWAR-751030 (ODISHA)

Odisha Grameen Bank invites Tender Reference Number: **GEM/2026/B/7334158 dated 11.03.2026** application for supply, Printing and Personalization of ATM-cum-Debit Card with Stationery Kit. For more details and application format please visit Bank's website: <https://odishabank.bank.in/>

GENERAL MANAGER



Dr.Reddy's

Special Window for Re-lodgement of Transfer Requests of Physical Shares of Dr. Reddy's Laboratories Limited

Pursuant to SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-POD/ I/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, all shareholders are hereby informed that a Special Window is being opened for the period of one year, from **February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027** to facilitate re-lodgement of transfer requests of physical shares.

This facility is available for Transfer deeds lodged prior to April 01, 2019 and which were rejected, returned, or not attended due to deficiencies in documents/process/or otherwise. The shares so transferred shall be mandatorily credited to the transferee only in demat mode and shall be under lock-in for a period of one year from the date of registration of transfer. Such shares shall not be transferred/lien marked/pledged during the said lock-in period.

Investors who have missed the earlier deadlines are encouraged to take advantage of this opportunity by furnishing the necessary documents to the Company's Registrar and Transfer Agent (RTA), M/s. Bigshare Services Private Limited, 306, Right Wing, 3rd Floor, Amrutha Ville, Opp. Yashoda Hospital, Rajbhavan Road, Hyderabad 500 082, Telangana, India Tel: +91-40-2337 4967, Fax: +91-40-2337 0295, email ID: bssbvd@bigshareonline.com.

For Dr. Reddy's Laboratories Limited
K Randhir Singh
Company Secretary, Compliance Officer and Head - CSR

Place : Hyderabad
Date : 11-03-2026

Dr. REDDY'S LABORATORIES LIMITED
Regd. Office: 8-2-337, Road No.3, Banjara Hills, Hyderabad - 500 034
CIN: L85195TG1984PLC004507, Tel: 91 40 4900 2900; Fax: 91 40 4900 2999
email: shares@drreddys.com; [website:www.drreddys.com](http://www.drreddys.com)



Sun Petrochemicals Private Limited
[SunPetro]
8th, 9th & 10th Floors, ATL Corporate Park, Sakti Vihar Road, Chandivali, Andheri (E), Mumbai-72. Phone: 022-69325300.
CIN: U24219GJ1995PTC028519.

Invitation to Bid (ITB)

SunPetro invites following Bids against upcoming tenders for SunPetro's Oil & Gas fields, in Gujarat India:

1. Crude Oil Storage Tanks for Bhaskar I Field, Gujarat.
2. Rate Contract for Supply of Oil & Gas Wells Tubing of various sizes.
3. Hiring of Integrated Drilling Services on Callout basis.
4. Consultant for Phased Business Transformation including Organization Redesign and Digital Modernization for Upstream Business.
5. Hiring of Hospitality (Catering) Services for SunPetro's Onshore facility at Hazira Oil & Gas Facility in Gujarat.

Interested parties to visit website: www.sunpetro.com for further details of tender/Invitation to Bid.



**OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR OF HEALTH SERVICES
MEDICAL EDUCATION & RESEARCH (DME), MEGHALAYA
GOVERNMENT OF MEGHALAYA
PASTEUR HILLS, SHILLONG**

Email ID: pasteurinstitutehill@gmail.com Tel No. 0364-2591510 / 94851 06663

No.DHSM&R/SMC/H.Res/148/025-26/1144 Dtd: Shillong, the 11th March, 2026

NOTICE

The office of the Director of Health Services Medical Education & Research (DME) invites applications from eligible **In-Service Doctors for the post of Assistant Professors, Senior Resident and Tutor / Demonstrator** in various disciplines at Shillong Medical College.

Interested and eligible candidates are requested to visit the following website for detailed information:
<https://www.meghealth.gov.in>

Date and time of interview will be intimated accordingly.

Sd/-
Director of Health Services
Medical Education & Research (DME),
Pasteur Hills, Meghalaya, Shillong

MIPR No. : 3018
Dated : 11-03-2026



COCHIN INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LIMITED

CIAL/COMM/SNW/61 (E-Tender No: 2026_CIAL_841243) 12/03/2026

TENDER NOTICE

Item rate E-tenders are invited from reputed contractors for SITC of Software Patch & Asset Management Solution at Cochin International Airport.

Name of Work	Estimate Amount	EMD	Completion Period
SITC of Software Patch & Asset Management Solution	Rs. 74.88 Lakhs + GST	Rs. 2 Lakhs	3 Months

Interested firms may register themselves on the online E-Tendering portal <https://etenders.kerala.gov.in>. Tender document will be available for download from **13/03/2026**. For eligibility criteria and other details, visit our website www.cial.aero

Sd/-
MANAGING DIRECTOR



THE MAHARASHTRA AGRO-INDUSTRIES DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Maharashtra Undertaking)

Krushidyog Bhavan, Aarey Milk Colony, Dinkarrao Desai Marg, Goregaon (E), Mumbai-400065 E-mail: pesticidesmaidc65@gmail.com Website : www.maidcmumbai.com

CORRIGENDUM NOTICE

EOI Notice No. : Pest/MIL/2025-26/EOI/105, EOI ID : 2026_DOA_1281288_1

EOI Title : EOI for Appointment of Agency for Setting up of Bio- Input Resource Center (BRC)

This is to inform all prospective bidders that the purchase committee recommended some modifications on request received in Pre-bid meeting for details bidders are advice to visit www.mahatenders.gov.in and MAIDC web portal www.maidcmumbai.com. Revised Closing Date is **19.03.2026 at 4.00 PM**.

Sd/-
Dy. General Manager (Pest)
The M.A.I.D.C. Ltd.

Jharkhand Council on Science, Technology & Innovation (JCSTI), Ranchi
Department of Higher & Technical Education, Govt. of Jharkhand

Letter No. : 66 **Date : 11.03.2026**

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER

Online Bid are invited under a Two-Packet System from reputed experience service providers for providing Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC) for servicing and Maintenance of HVAC System Installed at Varahmihir Taramandal in the premises of Ranchi Science Centre, Chiraundi for 03 Years through GeM. For detailed specifications, eligibility criteria, and online submission, please visit www.gem.gov.in and search for the GeM Bid Number GEM/2026/B/7344393. The last date for submission is 01.04.2026 till 17:00 Hrs.

PR 374814 Higher Education, Technical Education and Skill Development Department (25-26)_D

Sd/-
(Dr. Raj Shekhar Prasad)
Executive Director, JCSTI



GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU



ELCOT

ELECTRONICS CORPORATION OF TAMILNADU LIMITED
9th Floor, Sigapi Aachi Building, 18/3, Rukmani Lakshmiapathi Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008. www.elcot.tn.gov.in | +91 44 2855 6100 | itparks@elcot.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

ELCOT invites tender for the following works:

Sl.No.	Tender No.	Description
1.	ELCOT-PROJ-2025-0050	Selection of Joint Venture Partner for development of Information Technology (IT) Park for a period of 65 years at ELCOT IT Park, Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu (International Competitive Bidding)

Pre-bid Meeting: **26.03.2026, 11:00 AM**, Last Date of submission: **28.04.2026, 3:00 PM**. For further details, please visit <https://tntenders.gov.in>. For queries: itparks@elcot.in.

DIPR/1741/Tender/2026

MANAGING DIRECTOR

OFFICE OF THE RETURNING OFFICER SPCDF & COLLECTOR GANDHINAGAR
AmulFed Dairy, Plot No. 35, Nr. Indira Bridge, Ahmedabad-Gandhinagar Highway, Village Bhat, Gandhinagar- 382428.
Email:- ro@spcdf.coop

ELECTION NOTICE

An election is to be conducted for the post of 14 Board of Directors for Sardar Patel Co-operative Dairy Federation Limited (SPCDF) under MSCS Act 2002 (as amended in 2023) read with MSCS Rules. The Election program for Board of Directors is as mentioned below. (detailed programme is also available on website: spcdf.coop)

Election Program for Board of Directors		
Particulars	Date	Time
Publication of Provisional List of Members and Delegate, Eligible to Vote on website	23 rd March, 2026 (Monday)	By 5 PM
Time window for raising objection to the Provisional List	24 th March, 2026 to 27 th March 2026 (Tuesday to Friday)	11:00 AM to 3:00 PM
Scrutiny of Objection received to the Provision List (if any)	30 th March, 2026 to 1 st April, 2026 (Monday to Wednesday)	11:00 AM to 3:00 PM
Publication of Final List of Members/Delegates, Eligible to Vote	1 st April, 2026 (Wednesday)	By 5 PM
Issue and Filing of Nomination	8 th April, 2026 to 10 th April, 2026 (Wednesday to Friday)	11:00 AM to 3:00 PM
Publication of List of Nominations Received	10 th April, 2026 (Friday)	By 5:00 PM
Scrutiny of Received Nomination Forms	11 th April, 2026 (Saturday)	11:00 AM onwards
Publication of List of Valid Nominations	11 th April, 2026 (Saturday)	By 5:00 PM
Withdrawal of Nominations	13 th April, 2026 (Monday)	11:00 AM to 3:00 PM
Publication of Final List of Contesting Candidates	13 th April, 2026 (Monday)	By 5 PM
Date of Polling, if Necessary	26 th April, 2026 (Sunday) 8:00 AM to 04:00 PM and all those who have entered polling station at 04 PM or before should be allowed to cast vote	
Counting of votes	26 th April, 2026 (Sunday)	Immediate after polling
Submission of Form 19M with recommendation for seeking approval of CEA before declaration of result of BOD	26 th April, 2026 (Sunday)	
Declaration of Result of Board of Directors	After approval of Cooperative Election Authority, New Delhi on Format 19M	
Nomination of Government Director as per Section 48 of MSCS Act.	To be done by 2nd May, 2026	
Election Program of Office Bearers		
Announcement of Election Schedule	4 th May, 2026 (Monday)	After Declaration of Result of Board Members' Election
I. Time window for filing nomination	09:30 AM to 11:30 AM	
II. Scrutiny of nomination papers	12:30 PM to 02:00 PM	
III. Time and date for withdrawal	02:00 PM to 04:00 PM	
IV. Display of list of the contesting candidate and schedule of election	04:00 PM	
Meeting of Newly Constituted Board & Publication of List for valid Nominations, Polling (if required)	5 th May, 2026 (Tuesday)	11:00 AM Onwards
Declaration of Result of Election of Office Bearers	After approval of Cooperative Election Authority, New Delhi on Format 19N	

Objection if any in resolution/name of delegates/Nomination can be filled in writing at Office of Collector, Gandhinagar within timeline prescribed mentioned in election programme above. Polling and counting of votes (If necessary) will take place at SPCDF, AmulFed Dairy, Gandhinagar within timeline prescribed mentioned in election programme above.

Sd/-
RO SPCDF and Collector, Gandhinagar



Piramal Finance

Registered Office Address: Unit No.601, 6th Floor Piramala Amiti Building, Piramal Agastya Corporate Park, Kamani Junction, Opp Fire Station, LBS Marg, Kurla (West), Mumbai- 400 070.
CIN: L65910MH1984PLC032639, Web Side:- www.piramalfinance.com

DEMAND NOTICE

Under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 3 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The undersigned is the Authorised Officer of Piramal Finance Limited (PFL) (Formerly Piramal Capital & Housing Finance Ltd.) under Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the said Act). In exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(2) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorised Officer has issued Demand Notices under Section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower(s) (the "said Borrower(s)"), to repay the amounts mentioned in the respective Demand Notice(s) issued to them that are also given below. In connection with above, notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Borrower(s) to pay to PFL, within 60 days from the publication of this Notice, the amounts indicated herein below, together with further interest as detailed in the said Demand Notice(s), from the date(s) mentioned below till the date of payment and/or realization, payable under the loan agreement read with other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Borrower(s). As security for due repayment of the loan, the following assets have been mortgaged to PFL by the said Borrower(s) respectively.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s)	Demand Notice Date and Amount with NPA date	Description of secured asset (immovable property)
1.	(LC No. BLSA00050FC4 of Faridabad Branch) Ajit Singh (Borrower) Om Prakash Tanwar (Co Borrower 1) Sheela (Co Borrower 2)	19-02-2026/Rs.22,61,867/- (Rs. Twenty Two Lakh Sixty One Thousand Eight Hundred Sixty Seven Only) NPA (03-02-2026)	Khwat No. 1090 NA Rect No. 79 Killa 13 (9- 17) total land area 09 Kanals 17 marla to the extent of 250 /9599 share i.e 8.26 marla (250 Sq.Yards) situated at Mouja NA Deeghot VVN High School Faridabad Palwal Faridabad Haryana-121105

If the said Borrowers shall fail to make payment to PFL as aforesaid, PFL shall proceed against the above secured assets under Section 13(4) of the Act and the applicable Rules, entirely at the risks of the said Borrowers as to the costs and consequences. The said Borrowers are prohibited under the Act from transferring the aforesaid assets, whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of PFL. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the said Act or Rules made there under, shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.

Date: March 12, 2026
Place: Faridabad

Sd/- (Authorised Officer),
Piramal Finance Limited

कार्यालयक अभियंता का कार्यालय, लघु सिंचाई प्रमण्डल, चाईबासा

**अल्पकालीन ई०-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या-
WRD/MID/CHAIBASA/ F2-16/2025-26(DMFT)**

1. कार्य का नाम :-

युप संख्या	योजना का नाम	जिला	प्रखण्ड	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख में)	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य (रुपये में)	अग्रघन की राशि (रुपये में)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1.	दिबुबालकाण्ड पंचायत के ग्राम-दुधपानी मझगांव मुख्य पथ (केशर) से बालकासाई तक पी०सी०सी० पथ निर्माण।	पश्चिमी सिंहभूम।	हाटगम्हरिया	154.698	10,000.00	309500.00	6 माह
2.	आंगरपदा पंचायत के ग्राम-महालिपोखर में मुख्य सड़क से लेकर मायां उडीसा सीमा तक पी०सी०सी० पथ निर्माण।	पश्चिमी सिंहभूम।	मझगांव	152.962	10,000.00	306000.00	6 माह
3.	सेरंगसिया पंचायत के ग्राम सेरंगसिया में सेरंगसिया नाला पर चेकडेम निर्माण।	पश्चिमी सिंहभूम।	टोन्टो	99.557	10,000.00	199500.00	11 माह
4.	द्विरीबुक्क पंचायत के ग्राम लिधुगा के ईचामुपी टोला से बिडीकुदा तक पी०सी०सी० पथ निर्माण।	पश्चिमी सिंहभूम।	नोवामुण्डी	72.895	10,000.00	146000.00	5 माह
5.	तोन्डांगहातु पंचायत के ग्राम तोन्डांगहातु मालुका आर०ई०ओ० रोड नवागांव बुरुसाई चौक से कादोमुद्द माया डिह्री कोलेज जगन्नाथपुर तक पी०सी०सी० पथ निर्माण।	पश्चिमी सिंहभूम।	जगन्नाथपुर	71.721	10,000.00	143500.00	5 माह
6.	जामिद पंचायत के मेरमेरा नायक टोला हनुमान मुर्ति के सामने बड़ा नाला में चेकडेम निर्माण।	पश्चिमी सिंहभूम।	चक्रधरपुर	91.015	10,000.00	182500.00	11 माह
7.	कुलीतोडांग पंचायत के कुलीतोडांग सोकवा बांध में चेकडेम निर्माण।	पश्चिमी सिंहभूम।	चक्रधरपुर	74.561	10,000.00	149500.00	11 माह

नोट :- केवल ई०-निविदा(Online Mode) ही स्वीकार होगा।
2. विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाइट WWW.jharkhandtenders.gov.in पर देखें।
3. वेबसाइट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि एवं समय :- 04.04.2026 के 11:00 बजे प्रकाशित करें।
4. ई०-निविदा में भाग लेने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय :- 10.04.2026 अपराह्न 03:00 बजे तक।
5. ई०-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :- 11.04.2026 को 05:00 बजे अपराह्न।
6. परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य एवं अग्रघन की राशि सूचना प्रौद्योगिकी एवं ई०-गवर्नेंस विभाग झारखण्ड मंत्रालय, धुबई, सैन्ची के आदेश सह ज्ञापक 120, दिनांक 03.10.2023 के अनुरूप (Online) प्राप्त की जायेगी।
7. निविदा आमंत्रित करनेवाले पदाधिकारी का नाम, पता, दूरभाष सं० एवं ई०मेल आई डी०- कार्यपालक अभियंता, लघु सिंचाई प्रमण्डल, चाईबासा / 9572468424 ई० मेल - eedmidchaibasa@gmail.com, eedmidchai-cem-jhr@nic.in
8. निविदा के B.O.Q की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार B.O.Q के मूल्य एवं अग्रघन की राशि में बदलाव होगा।
9. प्राक्कलित राशि का 10 प्रतिशत से नीचे के दर से निश्चित (Quoted rate is more than 10% below the schedule rate) के परिपेक्ष में पथ निर्माण विभाग झारखण्ड सैन्ची के पत्रांक 2146(S) दिनांक 09.09.2020 के अनुसार अतिरिक्त जमानत की राशि एकरारनामा करने के समय जमा करना अनिवार्य होगा।
10. निविदा निशानदार Double Bid Envelope पद्धति से किया जाएगा Technical Bid में सफल निविदादाता का ही Financial Bid खोला जाएगा। उपयुक्त, पश्चिमी सिंहभूम का पत्रांक 1679, दिनांक 23.12.2022 के आलेख में निविदा खोलने के समय चाईबासा जिलानर्गरत किसी भी प्रमण्डल / विभाग द्वारा आवंटित कार्य एकरारित अवधि बीत जाने के बाद लंबित नहीं होने संबंधी शपथ-देन Affidavit देना होगा। निविदा के एक NIT में एक निबंधन पर दो से अधिक कार्य आवंटित नहीं किया जाएगा। वैसे संवेदक जो एकरारनामा में अंकित कार्य पूर्ण करने की तिथि तक योजनाओं का कार्य अधूरा रखे हुए हैं। उन्हें जिला अंतर्गत चलने वाली किसी भी योजना में तब तक कार्य आवंटित नहीं किया जाएगा जब तक अपने पूर्व के कार्य को समाप्त न कर दें। जिला अंतर्गत किसी भी विभाग का कार्य लंबित होने की सूचना यदि इस कार्यालय को प्राप्त होती है तो संबंधित संवेदक को कार्य आवंटित नहीं किया जाएगा।
11. निविदा खोलने के की तिथि से 5 दिनों के अन्दर निविदादाता द्वारा अपनी आपत्ति / दावा दर्ज कराये अन्यथा अवधि बीतने के पश्चात् कोई भी आपत्ति / दावा मान्य नहीं होगा।
12. बिना कारण बताये किसी भी समय निविदा को रद्द करने का अधिकारी अधोस्तक्षरी को सुरक्षित रहेगा।
13- Technical Bid में Qualify करने वाले संवेदकों / फर्म का ही Financial Bid खोला जाएगा।
14. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई०-मुगतान सम्वेदक द्वारा जिस बैंक खाता से किया जाएगा। उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर बैंक खाता को बन्द कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही सम्वेदक की होगी।
ह० / -
कार्यपालक अभियंता
लघु सिंचाई प्रमण्डल, चाईबासा

PR 374725 West Singhbhum(25-26).D

THE MARKETS ON WEDNESDAY				change ↑
Sensex	76,863.7	▼	1,342.3	
Nifty	23,866.8	▼	394.8	
Nifty Futures*	23,939.1	▲	72.3	
Dollar	₹92.0		₹91.8	##
Euro	₹106.7		₹107.0	##
Brent Crude (\$/bbl)	90.8 *		90.5	##
Gold (10gm)**	₹1,59,588.0	▲	₹41.0	
* Over previous close; † (Mar) Premium on Nifty Spot; * Futures price at 6 pm IST; ## Previous close; * At 9pm IST; ** Market rate exclusive of GST; Source: IBSA				

Don't panic, fuel cargoes on the way: Govt

Two cargoes each of crude oil and LNG arriving in the next few days

SHUBHANGI MATHUR & SAKET KUMAR
New Delhi, 11 March

India will soon receive two cargoes each of crude oil and liquefied natural gas (LNG) that have bypassed the now-blocked Strait of Hormuz, a senior government official said on Wednesday. The country is facing energy supply shortages amid the continuing war in West Asia.

“There is no need to panic... About 70 per cent of India's crude supplies are now coming from routes outside the Strait of Hormuz, compared with about 55 per cent earlier,” said Sujata Sharma, joint secretary at the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, at a press conference. She said two cargoes each of crude oil and LNG will arrive “in the next few days”.

Meanwhile, Indian oil companies have increased produc-



PHOTO: REUTERS

tion of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) by 25 per cent at their refineries following a recent government order, Sharma said. On March 5, the government directed companies to maximise LPG production while

halting the diversion of propane and butane for petrochemicals. The US-Israel conflict with Iran, which led to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz, has triggered an energy supply shock for India. The

Kandla-bound ship attacked in Hormuz

A Thai-flagged cargo vessel, Mayuree Naree, was struck in the Strait of Hormuz on Wednesday shortly after departing from the United Arab Emirates. The vessel was bound for Kandla in Gujarat. The Ministry of External Affairs deplored the targeting of commercial shipping and civilian crew in military attacks, stressing that precious lives, including of Indian citizens, have already been lost in multiple such attacks in the conflict in West Asia. It said: “India reiterates that targeting commercial shipping and endangering innocent civilian crew members, or otherwise impeding freedom of navigation and commerce, should be avoided.”

BS REPORTER

ECONOMY & PUBLIC AFFAIRS 4

Fiscal pressures on govt may mount in FY27

Revenue collection next financial year may be affected, and, along with this, subsidies on food and fertilisers can go up if war in West Asia drags for long, according to experts.

■ Jaishankar speaks to Lavrov amid oil supply crunch

■ Low oil & gas stockpiles pose risk to Indian economy: S&P

WORLD 8

Get ready for oil at \$200 a barrel, Iran tells world

Iran's military command said on Wednesday the world should be prepared for oil to hit \$200 a barrel, as three more ships came under attack in the blockaded Gulf.

■ War in West Asia leaves wedding menus cooking on low flame 2

THE SMART INVESTOR 10

High costs, KYC hurdles deter overseas investors in GIFT City

WORLD 8

AI sparks a new wave of grieving parents fighting for online safety

Gas supply jitters begin rattling industry pockets

ISHITA AYAN DUTT, ANJALI SINGH, SHIVANI SHINDE, SHARLEEN D'SOUZA & GULVEEN AULAKH
Kolkata/Mumbai/New Delhi, 11 March

Concerns over disruptions in natural gas and LPG supplies are beginning to affect operations in some industries, though others say the impact so far remains limited.

At least two major steel producers said the shortage has started to affect certain downstream processes, although the disruption is not yet severe. One industry executive said natural gas or propane is commonly used in furnaces, meaning production cannot remain entirely insulated from supply constraints. “Natural gas or propane is used in the furnace, so there is an impact. As of now, it's not major,” said the executive.

Smaller steel mills, however, warn the situation could worsen if the shortage persists. Vivek Adukia, chairman of the



People queue up to get LPG cylinders in Guwahati on Wednesday

PHOTO: PTI

West Bengal-based Steel Re-Rolling Mills Association of India, said that while LPG may not be a primary raw material, it remains essential for certain operational processes. “Induction furnace operators who manufacture billets require LPG for lancing. Without it, the production cycle cannot be completed,” said Adukia.

According to him, most mills currently have enough inventory to operate for the next few days. “If the situation

continues, some mills may have to shut down,” he added.

Packaged food companies are also beginning to feel the strain.

Industry executives earlier this week told *Business Standard* that some manufacturers have had to cut production at plants in certain states as gas supplies remain constrained.

By contrast, the automotive sector has so far remained largely unaffected.

Turn to Page 7 ▶

Death with ‘dignity’: In a first, SC allows passive euthanasia

BHAVINI MISHRA
New Delhi, 11 March

The Supreme Court on Wednesday permitted the withdrawal of life-sustaining treatment for 32-year-old Harish Rana, who has remained in a permanent vegetative state since a fall from a fourth-floor building in August 2013. The case marks the first practical application of passive euthanasia in the country.

The apex court allowed the withdrawal of medical support for Rana, granting him the right to die with “dignity”.

A Bench of Justices J B Pardiwala and K V Viswanathan directed that all medical treatment being administered to Rana, including Clinically Assisted Nutrition and Hydration (CANH), “shall be withdrawn/withheld”. The court emphasised that the process must be implemented in a “humane” and dignified manner.

Taking note of the specific circumstances of the case, the Bench dispensed with the usual 30-day reconsideration period, observing that all stakeholders were unanimous that continuing medical intervention was not warranted. The court further directed the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AiiMS), Delhi, to admit Rana to its palliative care department so that the withdrawal of treatment could be carried out under medical supervision.

Turn to Page 7 ▶



Harish Rana has remained in a permanent vegetative state since 2013 after falling from the 4th-floor of a building

Elsewhere, in best interest

■ **US:** Courts have recognised withdrawal of life-sustaining treatment based on patient's autonomy and best interests

■ **UK:** Withdrawal decisions for incapacitated patients follow the best-interests doctrine

■ **Australia:** Courts have allowed discontinuation of artificial nutrition and hydration when treatment serves no therapeutic purpose

■ **New Zealand:** The high court has permitted withdrawal when treatment no longer benefits the patient

■ **EU:** The European Court of Human Rights in Lambert v France upheld withdrawal of life-sustaining treatment within a regulated legal framework

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*As of June 30, 2025 | **As on date of this Draft Herring Prospectus

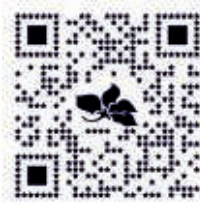
PRIDE PLAZA

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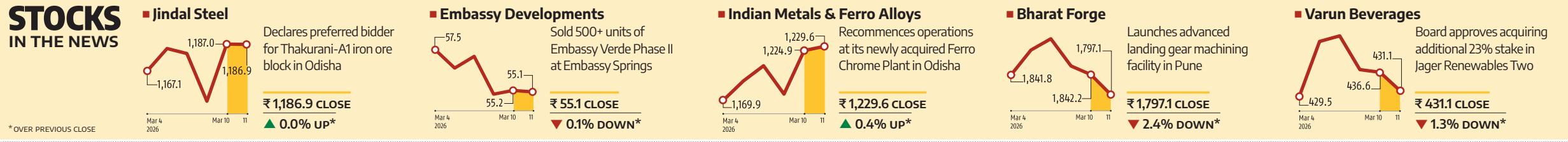
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PRIDE HOTELS LIMITED is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the DRHP dated September 30, 2025, with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges on September 30, 2025. The DRHP is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, as well as on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE and NSE at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, on the website of the Company at www.pridehotel.com and on the websites of the Book Running Lead Managers (“BRLMs”), i.e. Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited and JM Financial Limited at www.motilaloswalgroup.com and www.jmf.com, respectively. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see “Risk Factors” on page 41 of the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges for making any investment decision and should instead rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved in making any investment decision. The Equity Shares offered in the Offer have not been and will not be registered under the United States Securities Act of 1933, as amended (the “U.S. Securities Act”), and may not be offered or sold within the United States except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable U.S. state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold outside of the United States in “offshore transactions” in reliance on Regulation S and the applicable laws of the jurisdiction where those offers and sales occur.



Aster to add 4,000 beds, invest ₹4K cr in 2 years: Dy MD

Q&A The merger of Aster DM Healthcare with Blackstone-backed Quality Care India Ltd (QCIL) is expected to be through in the next quarter. In a video interaction, **Alisha Moopen**, deputy managing director (Dy MD) of Aster DM, talks to **Shine Jacob** about plans on merger and expansion. Edited excerpts:

What is the status of the merger?
■ One exciting news is that we have got creditors' and National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) approval. We have been eagerly waiting for this since filing for the merger in October 2024. We've already had Competition Commission of India (CCI) approval, Bombay Stock Exchange nod, and everything, but this was a big one that was pending. NCLT is going through some of its internal processes, in terms of getting the paperwork done, which we think should take around a quarter. So, it's just more paperwork and administration from their end, but in terms of all the regulatory approvals, everything has now been completed.

How will the synergy work?
■ We always knew the largest opportunities were of procurement synergies, in terms of whether it's our capital expenditure purchases as well as medical consumables, pharmaceuticals, and diagnostics. So, we have been doing a very deep and extensive exercise, doing the data collection and analysis in terms of seeing where the opportunities lie at the micro level.
We are of course in line with the regulatory environment and guidance. Once that happens, we should be able to kind of press the button in terms of getting a lot of those benefits.
With one unified management team, with all the groundwork that has been done, we believe that in FY27 you should see sort of very good, healthy numbers.



We are hopeful to continue double-digit growth on the top line as well as the bottom line, with very healthy earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) of more than 20 per cent, which is what the network is already showing.

What are your expansion plans?
■ Looking ahead, the merged entity will aim to increase bed capacity to around 14,710 beds over the coming years. Of the planned 4,080-bed additions by the merged entity in the next two years, 2,368 beds will be added by Aster and the remaining by QCIL. This is likely to see an investment of around ₹4,000 crore in two years.
Where will this expansion be focussed on?
■ Our expansion strategy focuses on both greenfield projects and selective acquisitions, enabling us to strengthen our presence in Kerala and Karnataka. These are states where we already have a dominant position. Around 2,000 of these beds are on brownfield.
Key upcoming additions

include two new hospitals in Bengaluru – a 430-bed and 500-bed facility on Sarjapur Road and Yeshwanthpur. Also, the addition of 350 beds at Aster CMI Hospital and 159 beds at Aster Whitefield, reinforcing our leadership position among the top three health-care providers in the city.
In Kerala, the 263-bed Aster Kasaragod Hospital became operational in October 2025. Additionally, we are developing the 454-bed greenfield Aster Capital Hospital in Trivandrum and expanding capacity at Aster Medcity, Kochi, with the addition of 100 beds.
We are also planning a state-of-the-art 300-bed women and children's hospital in Hyderabad, along with the addition of 75 beds at Aster Ramesh, Ongole. We are also looking at a sizeable asset in Chennai.

With Blackstone coming to the fold, what is your take on the role of private equity players in Indian health-care?
■ As a company, we have had private equity now for the last 20 years. We've always said that we want to make health-care more accessible for people, which means that you have to expand capacity. This also means capital becomes quite important, especially in health-care as it's a capex-heavy industry.
Now, having someone like Blackstone is a great asset for us because it is one of the largest and most-respected institutions. In the new structure, Azad Moopen will continue as executive chairman. Also, we have a professional CEO and MD, Varun Khanna, running the day-to-day business. We have got three family members and three Blackstone representatives on the board, in addition to the independent directors.

WhatsApp launches new parent-managed account with privacy controls for kids below 13

AASHISH ARYAN
New Delhi, 11 March

Peer-to-peer messaging app WhatsApp on Wednesday introduced new parent-managed accounts that will allow parents and guardians to set up WhatsApp for children under 13, with strict privacy controls managed only on the primary device.
“To begin, parents will need the phone they have bought for their family member and their own device, side by side, to link their accounts. Once set up, these

accounts are controlled by the parent or guardian, who will be able to decide who can contact the account and which groups they can join. In addition, parents can review message requests from unknown contacts and manage the account's privacy settings,” WhatsApp said in a blog post.
The parental controls and other settings for children's WhatsApp accounts will be gated by a personal identification number (PIN) on the managed device, WhatsApp said.

“Only parents can access and change privacy settings, ensuring they are empowered to tailor their family's experience,” the company said, adding that parents will have complete control over who can contact the children, the groups they can join, and the strangers who can message or call them. The new feature, WhatsApp said, has been built in response to feedback from par-

ents and guardians who requested a WhatsApp account for their pre-teens.
The introduction of a parent-controlled WhatsApp account option for pre-teen children comes at a time when governments around the world are considering banning the use of social media for children under 16. While Australia became the first country to ban social media

use for children under 16, other countries, including India, are considering similar guidelines to regulate social media use by minors.
In India, both Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh have proposed regulations that will bar children below a certain age from accessing social media platforms. While Karnataka has proposed regulating how children under 16 access these intermediaries, Andhra Pradesh has mooted completely barring social media for children under 13.



Rasna eyes 20% growth as summer comes early

AKSHARA SRIVASTAVA
New Delhi, 11 March

With the summer season already in full swing, beverage brand Rasna hopes to grow faster than the overall concentrate market.
The company, which commands a 70 per cent share of the concentrate market, aims to record revenue growth of 15-20 per cent this year, surpassing industry growth levels of 10-12 per cent.
“Summer has arrived early this year, and we hope it is not disrupted unlike last year. Growth will also be driven by our new launches and a greater focus on digital media. We are increasing our budget on Youtube by five times, and moving the TV budget to digital,” said Piruz Khambatta, chairman, Rasna India.
The company is also tapping micro and local influencers to promote the new launches.
“It is a digital-first campaign this year, which is very unique for a mass brand like ours,” he added.
Speaking about channels of growth, Khambatta said demand is primarily driven by quick commerce and standalone stores. E-commerce, which contributed to only 2

per cent of entire sales before the Covid-19 pandemic, is projected to contribute up to 15 per cent of entire sales by later this year.
The company is also consistently reducing the sugar content in its products.
“Some of our pre-mixes have no sugar and instead require added sugar. We have consciously and gradually reduced sugar content in other pre-mixes,” he said.
In the ₹2 pack for example, the brand has reduced sugar content to 3.5 gm from 23 gm earlier.
Speaking about the continued military escalation in western Asia, Khambatta said that exports account for 40 per cent of the company's business, “with greater demand especially during Ramzan,” he added.
“The ongoing war has severely impacted exports, with goods being returned and shipping lines facing delays. While we hope the situation will resolve in the coming few weeks, delays will persist due to container shortages,” he said.
The company, which acquired Jumpin in 2025, is present in over 60 countries and has 12 manufacturing units across India.



RASNA INDIA CHAIRMAN PIRUZ KHAMBATT SAID THAT GROWTH WOULD BE DRIVEN BY THE COMPANY'S NEW LAUNCHES AND A GREATER FOCUS ON DIGITAL MEDIA

Ashok Leyland to invest up to ₹500 cr in battery pack mfg unit in TN

SHINE JACOB
Chennai, 11 March

Ashok Leyland, the Indian flagship of the Hinduja Group and the country's leading commercial vehicle manufacturer, on Wednesday announced the ground-breaking of a greenfield battery pack manufacturing facility at Pillaipakkam near Chennai in Tamil Nadu, reinforcing its commitment to advancing India's electric mobility ecosystem.
The project would incur investment of ₹400-500 crore, and is part of the investments from Hinduja Group as per an earlier Memorandum of Understanding signed in September 2025. The new battery pack project aligns closely with Tamil Nadu's Electric Vehicle Policy 2023, the National Mission on Transformative Mobility and Battery Storage, and India's vision of achieving net-zero emissions by 2070.
Tamil Nadu Chief Minister MK Stalin unveiled the foundation plaque. The ceremony was graced by state's Minister for Industries, Investment Promotions and Commerce TRB Rajaa, along with the leaders of Guidance Tamil Nadu and representatives from the State

Industries Promotion Corporation of Tamil Nadu, Ashok Leyland managing director and chief executive officer Shenu Agarwal and several other dignitaries.
The new battery pack manufacturing facility at Pillaipakkam represents a strategic step in building a robust EV ecosystem. The facility will help localise EV battery pack production, strengthen India's electric mobility supply chain and create new opportunities for employment and advanced skill development in Tamil Nadu, further reinforcing the state's position as a leading hub for next-generation automotive manufacturing and EV innovation.
Dheeraj Hinduja, executive chairman, Ashok Leyland, said, “Our journey has been closely intertwined with the growth of Tamil Nadu for more than seven decades. Ashok Leyland, along with its subsidiary, Switch Mobility, have already developed a vast range of electric Commercial Vehicles, and have taken a lead position in the EV market. The ground-breaking of the new battery pack manufacturing facility marks an important step in our electric mobility journey.”

PROFITMART SECURITIES PVT LTD (PSPL)
Unit No 213, Opal Square, Plot No C-1, Thane, Mumbai – 400604.
Email support@profitmart.in Tel: 020 49119119

Public Notice

This is to inform the general public, investors, and all concerned parties that the registration of the following **Authorised Person (AP)** has been terminated/cancelled with immediate effect:

Name of Authorised Person	Address of AP	Other Details
Mr. Akash Dhanuka	Flat No-5b, Santosh Estate, 298 Ballygunge Circular Road, Ballygunge S. O. Kolkata, West Bengal - 700019	Mobile: 9038393226 Email Id: akashdhanuka@icloud.com Pan: EKP067280 MCX AP Reg No: 420759 NSE AP Reg No: 492815033511

Mr. Akash Dhanuka, the former Authorised Person, is no longer associated with M/s. Profitmart Securities Pvt. Ltd. in any capacity. It has come to our attention that he is allegedly involved in unlawful and unethical business practices (dabba trading). His authorization to act as an Authorised Person has been cancelled, and he does not have any authority to represent, solicit clients, execute trades, collect funds, or conduct any business on behalf of the company.

Accordingly, the general public and investors are hereby cautioned that any person dealing, transacting, or communicating with Mr. Akash Dhanuka in the name of M/s. Profitmart Securities Pvt. Ltd. shall do so entirely at their own risk, cost, and consequences.

M/s. Profitmart Securities Pvt. Ltd. shall not be responsible or liable for any acts, representations, commitments, transactions, financial dealings, or losses arising out of any interaction with the said person after the issuance of this notice.

Investors are strongly advised to verify the authenticity of any person claiming association with our company before entering into any financial transactions.

For any queries or concerns regarding this matter, please contact us within 15 days from the date of this notice at the details provided below:

◆ NSE Membership No.: 14556 ◆ BSE Membership No.: 6676 ◆ MCX Membership No.: 40885 ◆ CDSE Membership No.: 12083600
◆ SEBI Registration No.: IN2000939633 ◆ CDSE SEBI Registration No.: IN-DP-295-2016

PROFITMART SECURITIES PVT LTD (PSPL)
Unit No 213, Opal Square, Plot No C-1, Thane, Mumbai – 400604.
Email support@profitmart.in Tel: 020 49119119

Public Notice

Notice is hereby given to the general public and investors that Mr. Raviraj Gauridar Bhosale (Mobile No.: 9158565000) is not associated in any manner with M/s. Profitmart Securities Pvt. Ltd., a registered member of NSE, BSE, and MCX.

It has come to our attention that the said individual is unlawfully collecting funds from clients and allegedly using a fake bank account in the name of our company while engaging in unethical and unauthorized business activities under the name of M/s. Profitmart Securities Pvt. Ltd.

The general public and investors are strongly advised not to transfer any funds to any bank account without verifying the authenticity of the account details. All official bank account details of the company are available on our official website, and investors are requested to verify the same before making any transactions. Alternatively, investors may contact our official support team to confirm the bank details.

Any person dealing or transacting with the said individual shall do so at their own risk, cost, and consequences. M/s. Profitmart Securities Pvt. Ltd. shall not be responsible or liable for any loss, damages, or claims arising out of any such dealings.

Investors and members of the public are requested to exercise due caution and verify the authenticity of any person claiming association with our company or using our name, brand, or SEBI registration details.

Any investor having queries, complaints, or information regarding dealings with the above-mentioned individual is requested to contact us within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice at the details mentioned below:

◆ NSE Membership No.: 14556 ◆ BSE Membership No.: 6676 ◆ MCX Membership No.: 40885 ◆ CDSE Membership No.: 12083600
◆ SEBI Registration No.: IN2000939633 ◆ CDSE SEBI Registration No.: IN-DP-295-2016

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Bank of Baroda
India's International Bank

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TENDER NOTICE

Bank of Baroda, Security Department, BCC, Mumbai invites Request for Proposal for selection of vendor/ service provider for Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning and Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract of Addressable Fire Alarm System at the Baroda Sun Tower building.

Details are available on Bank's website
<https://bankofbaroda.bank.in/tenders/corporate-office>.

“Addendum”, if any, shall be published on Bank's website
<https://bankofbaroda.bank.in/tenders/corporate-office>, under Tenders section. Bidders must refer the same before final submission of the proposal.

Last date for bid submission: 06th April, 2026 upto 02:00 pm.

Place: Mumbai
Date: 12.03.2026

Chief Security Officer
(Security Department)

इंडियन बैंक
Indian Bank
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)

Corporate Office:
254-260, Avdal Shannugam Salai, Royapettah, Chennai - 600 014.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Important Information regarding TDS / TCS correction timelines.

- As per Income Tax Act, 2025 with effect from 01.04.2026, TDS / TCS corrections for FY 2018-19 (Qtr.4), FY 2019-20 to 2022-23 (Qtr.1 to Qtr.4) and FY 2023-24 (Qtr.1 to Qtr.3) shall be accepted only up-to 31st March 2026.
- Correction request received after the due date will be time barred by limitation on 31.03.2026 and would not be accepted from 01.04.2026 for the above-mentioned period.
- Customers / Vendors requesting corrections must submit the same well before 31.03.2026 and in case of any assistance nearest Indian Bank Branch may be contacted.**

HCL INFOSYSTEMS LIMITED
CIN: L7220DL1986PLC023955

Regd. Office: 806, Siddharth, 96, Nehru Place, New Delhi-110019
Corporate Office: A-11, Sector – 3, Noida - 201301 (U.P.)
Tel: + 91-120-2520977, 2526518/519

Email: cosec@hclinfosystems.com, **Website:** www.hclinfosystems.in

NOTICE OF POSTAL BALLOT TO MEMBERS

Notice is hereby given to the members of **HCL Infosystems Limited ("Company")** pursuant to section 110 read with section 108 and other applicable provisions, if any, of the Companies Act, 2013, ("**the Act**") (including any statutory modification(s) or re-enactment(s) thereof for the time being in force), read with rules 20 and 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, ("**Rules**"), Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulation, 2015 ("**SEBI Listing Regulations**") and the Secretarial Standard-2 on General Meetings issued by the Institute of Companies Secretaries of India ("SS-2"), as amended from time to time and in accordance with the requirements prescribed by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA") vide its General Circulars dated 14/2020 dated April 08, 2020, 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020, 10/2021 dated June 23, 2021, 03/2022 dated May 05, 2022, 11/2022 dated December 28, 2022, 09/2023 dated September 25, 2023, 09/2024 dated September 19, 2024 and 3/2025 dated September 22, 2025 issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("**MCA Circulars**"), (collectively referred to as '**MCA Circulars**') and any other applicable law, rules and regulations (including any statutory modification(s) or re-enactment(s) thereof, for the time being in force, the approval of members of the Company is sought for the following special resolution by way of e-voting process.

Description of Special Resolution:
"Appointment of Mr. Gaurav Bhalra as a Manager for a period of five years with effect from 01.05.2026."

Pursuant to the MCA Circulars, the Company has completed the dispatch of the Postal Ballot Notice along with the explanatory statement on Wednesday, March 11, 2026 through electronic mode to those members of the Company whose names appeared in the Register of Member as at close of business hours on Monday, March 09, 2026 (cut-off date) The said notice is also available on the website of the Company i.e. www.hclinfosystems.in, website of the Stock Exchange i.e. BSE Limited, & National Stock Exchange of India Limited, where the shares of the Company are listed and on the website of NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com. Members can vote only through remote e-voting process. The voting right of the members shall be reckoned based on the equity shares of the Company held by them as on the Cut-off Date i.e. **Monday, March 09, 2026**. The Company has engaged in the services of National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) for the purpose of providing e-voting facilities to its members. The remote e-voting shall commence from **Sunday, March 15, 2026, 09:00 AM IST** and shall end on **Monday, April 13, 2026, 05:00 PM IST**. The e-voting facility will be disabled by NSDL thereafter. Members holding shares in physical mode and who have not updated their email addresses with the Company are requested to update their email addresses by writing to the Alankit Assignments Limited ("RTA") at rtat@alankit.com. Members holding shares in dematerialized mode are requested to register/update their email addresses with the relevant Depository Participants. The Company have appointed CS Vineet K Chaudhary, Managing Partner of M/s VKC & Associates, Practicing Company Secretary having membership No F5327 and CP No 4548 and in case of his failure, CS Mohit K Dixit having membership no F12361 and CP No 17827 Partner of M/s VKC & Associates, Practicing Company Secretary, has been appointed as the Scrutinizer to scrutinize the remote e-Voting process and casting vote through the e-Voting system during the meeting in a fair and transparent manner.

In case of any queries, you may refer the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) for Shareholders and e-Voting user manual for Shareholders available at the download www.evoting.nsdl.com or call at 022- 4886 7000 or send a request to Ms. Pallavi Mhatre, Assistant Vice-President, National Securities Depository Ltd., 3rd Floor, Naman Chamber, Plot C-32, G-Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Mumbai, Maharashtra - 400051 at the designated email address: evoting@nsdl.com or at telephone no. 022-48867000.

The result of the Postal Ballot will be announced on or before **Wednesday, April 15th, 2026** and shall be displayed on the notice board of the Company and shall also be placed on the Company's website www.hclinfosystems.in and on the website of National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) www.evoting.nsdl.com and shall be communicated to BSE Limited, & National Stock Exchange of India Limited, where the shares of the Company are listed.

For HCL Infosystems Limited
Sd/-
Twinkle Monga
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer
A-54882

LGT BUSINESS CONNEXIONS LIMITED
CIN: L74999TN2016PLC112289

Registered office: No. 18/1 & 18/2 (18), First Cross Street, Brindavan Street Extension, West Mambalam Chennai - 600033
Tel: 044 4958 5855 **Email:** info@lgt holidays.com **Website:** <https://www.lgt holidays.com/>

NOTICE OF POSTAL BALLOT

Members are hereby informed that pursuant to Section 108 and Section 110 of the Companies Act, 2013, read with the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, and other applicable provisions of the Acts, Rules, Regulations, Circulars and Notifications issued thereunder (including any statutory modifications or re-enactment thereof for the time being in force and as amended from time to time), the Company has

* On Wednesday, 11th March 2026, sent an e-mail through Skyline, Registrar and Share Transfer Agents (RTA) of the Company, the Notice of Postal Ballot to the Members for e-voting who have registered their e-mail Id's with Depository Participant(s) or with the Company for seeking approval of members of the company for the proposed following resolutions as detailed in the Postal Ballot Notice dated Tuesday, 10th March 2026.

Sl No.	Description of Resolutions
1	APPROVAL OF NAME CHANGE OF THE COMPANY TO "LGT GLOBAL HOSPITALITY LIMITED"
2	REGULARIZATION OF MR. DHAWAL PADMAKAR BHUTE (DIN: 08426133) AS NON – EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR OF THE COMPANY
3	REGULARIZATION OF MR. CHINTAN VIRENDRU CHHEDA (DIN: 08085061) AS NON – EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR OF THE COMPANY
4	APPOINTMENT OF MRS. NAMRATA KALANOURIA (DIN: 11594142) AS INDEPENDENT DIRECTOR OF THE COMPANY

The Board of Directors of the Company has appointed Mr. Gouri Shanker Mishra (Membership No. F 6906 & CP No. 13581) of M/s. BGSMISHRA & Associates, Company Secretaries LLP as scrutinizer (hereinafter referred as the "Scrutinizer") for conducting the Postal Ballot and e-voting process in a fair and transparent manner.

Members only have an option to vote through electronic mode. For this purpose, the Company has engaged the services of CDSE as the agency for facilitating remote e-voting to enable the Members to cast their votes electronically ("remote e-voting"). The detailed procedure for e-voting is enumerated in the Notes to the Postal Ballot Notice. Members are requested to note that the voting through electronic mode shall commence from Thursday, 12th March 2026 at 9.00 A.M. (IST) and end on Friday, 13th April 2026 at 5.00 P.M. (IST).

The voting rights of Members shall be reckoned as on Friday, 6th March 2026 which is the cut-off date. A person who is not a member as on the cut-off date should treat the Notice of Postal Ballot for information purpose only. The copy of the Postal Ballot Notice is available on the website of the Company i.e., <https://www.lgt holidays.com/> and on the website of CDSE i.e., <http://www.evotingindia.com>.

If you have any queries or issues regarding e-Voting from the e-Voting System, you may refer the Frequently Asked Questions ("FAQ") and e-voting manual available at www.evotingindia.com, under help section or write an email to helpdesk.evoting@cdsindia.com or contact at toll free no. 1800 22 55 33.

The results of the remote e-voting will be announced not later than two working days of the closure of the e-voting i.e., on or before Tuesday, 14th April, 2026, at the registered office of the Company and will be intimated/communicated to BSE Limited (the "BSE") where the equity shares of the Company are listed. The results of the postal ballot will also be displayed on the Company's website i.e. www.lgt holidays.com.

By the order of the Board of Directors
For LGT Business Connexions Limited
(Formerly known as LGT Business Connexions Private Limited)

Sd/-
Ankita Jain
Compliance Officer and Company Secretary

TITAN COMPANY LIMITED
CIN: L74999T21984PLC001456

Regd. Office: 3, SIPCOT Industrial Complex, Hosur-635 126, Tamil Nadu.
Corporate Office: "INTEGRITY" #193, Veerasandra Electronics City P.O. Off Hosur Main Road, Bangalore - 560100, Karnataka. Tel: +9180 6704 7000
E-mail: investor@titan.co.in website: www.titancompany.in

A TATA Enterprise

NOTICE

SPECIAL WINDOW FOR TRANSFER AND DEMATERIALISATION (DEMAT) OF PHYSICAL SHARES

Please note that a Special Window for Transfer and Dematerialisation (Demat) of Physical Shares has been opened for a period of one year from February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027 as per SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-POD/1/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026 ("SEBI Circular").

This facility is available to those shareholders who had purchased shares of Titan Company Limited ("the Company") prior to April 01, 2019, and;

- had not lodged the shares for transfer; or
- had lodged the shares for transfer, but the same were rejected, returned or not attended to due to deficiency in the documentation.

Applicability of the Special Window

For clarity regarding the applicability of this window to transfer the deeds executed before April 1, 2019, shareholder may refer to the matrix below:

Lodged for transfer before April 01, 2019?	Is the Original Share Certificate available with the Shareholder?	Whether eligible to lodge in the current Special window?
No, it is a fresh lodgement	Yes	Yes (subject to conditions stated in the SEBI Circular)
Yes, but was rejected/returned earlier	Yes	
Yes, was lodged	NO	NO
No, was not lodged	NO	NO

Kindly note that request(s) which are accompanied by original share certificate(s) along with transfer deed(s) and other supporting documents will only be considered under the Special Window.

Shareholders wishing to avail of this Special Window may contact the Company's Registrar and Transfer Agent, MUFG Intime India Private Limited (Unit: Titan Company Limited), having their address at C-101, Embassy 247, LBS. Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai - 400083.

For further details, shareholders may contact Company's RTA at Investor.helpdesk@in.mprms.mufg.com or Company at investor@titan.co.in

For TITAN COMPANY LIMITED
Place: Bengaluru
Date: March 12, 2026

Dinesh Shetty
General Counsel & Company Secretary

Sealed tender in W.B. Form No. 2911(ii) are invited by the Executive Engineer, Bankura Division, P.W.D. from Bonafied outsider having 40% credential in a single work of similar nature of P.W.D. for Short N.I.T. No. 04 of 2025-2026 for 04 (Four) nos. works in connection with the Emergent Construction Of Temporary Kitchen / Dining Shed, Along With Allied Work For Accommodation Of CAPF Deployed During The WB Assembly Election- 2026 circulated vide this office memo no. 3073 dated, 11/03/2026. detailed may be seen at <http://www.wbpwd.gov.in> and from the notice board of the office of undersigned. Last date of Application, Permission and Receipt of tender documents are 13.03.2026, 13.03.2026 and 13.03.2026 respectively. For more information, the interested agencies may contact the office of the undersigned on any working day at working hours.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer,
Bankura Division P.W.D.

Iran war: Fiscal pressures on govt may mount next FY, say experts

RUCHIKA CHITRAVANSHI, SANJEEB MUKHERJEE & HIMANSHI BHARDWAJ
New Delhi, 11 March

Revenue collection next financial year may be affected, and, along with this, subsidies on food and fertilisers can go up if the war in West Asia drags for long, according to experts. This, they say, can create fiscal pressures.

Since the crisis broke out, urea prices have increased by almost \$100 per tonne to around \$600 (free on board), while rates for di-ammonium phosphates (Dap) have risen to \$750-770 per tonne from \$650-670.

In 2024-25 (FY25), India imported from Gulf countries roughly 70 per cent of its urea, 42 per cent of Dap, 83 per cent of ammonia, and 60 per cent of liquefied natural gas (LNG).

Prices of ammonia, a key input in fertiliser production, are expected to rise sharply in the next quarterly fixation cycle. Prices of rock phosphate and phosphoric acid, both critical fertiliser inputs, too are increasing.

To meet sudden economic shocks, the finance ministry doubled the allocation for the “Economic Stabilisation Fund” to ₹1 trillion for FY26 as part of the second “supplementary demands for grants”, tabled in Parliament on Tuesday. It also allocated an additional ₹19,230 crore on account of fertiliser subsidies and ₹23,640 crore for food subsidies.

Experts said the war might not significantly impact the subsidy burden in FY26 because most deliveries were tied

up before the crisis. However, if it lingers, the landed prices of fertilisers can go up from April, when demand picks up.

The FY27 Budget estimates have set food subsidy at ₹227,629 crore, slightly less than the revised estimates of FY26.

However, according to sources, if the government procures for the central pool more wheat and rice than estimated, adding to the bulging grain stocks, food subsidies will increase.

The Centre has estimated procuring around 30.3 million tonnes of wheat in FY27, but traders said purchases could exceed this because the minimum support price (MSP) was much higher than the current market rate. India is poised to harvest more than 120 million tonnes of wheat in FY27, which is a record. A similar situation awaits rice.

The subsidy calculations factor in a normal monsoon. In the case of a monsoon below normal due to El Nino, there could be a further burden on the exchequer because more support for agriculture and rural works will be required.

In a report released on Wednesday, CRISIL Intelligence said the conflict was a new and multidimensional risk, and a downside risk to the 7.1 per cent growth estimate for gross domestic product in FY27.

“Imports face significant upside risk from sustained higher crude oil prices in case of prolonged geopolitical uncertainties in the Middle East, which may widen the current account deficit (CAD) to 1.5 per cent of GDP in FY27 (from 0.8 per cent estimated in FY26),”

Low oil & gas stockpiles pose risk to Indian economy: S&P

Flagging the adverse effects of the West Asia conflict, S&P Global Ratings on Wednesday said India’s low strategic stockpiles for its energy needs posed a risk to its economy.

Asian nations like India, Thailand, South Korea, Vietnam and Singapore have high energy import needs relative to gross domestic product (GDP). Despite the high exposure, India has limited reserves. Its strategic petroleum reserves support 10 days of consumption while its commercial stocks support

around 65 days.

Stockpiles of liquefied petroleum gas and liquefied natural gas are even lower, reportedly at around 25-30 days and 10-12 days, respectively, S&P said in two reports. One report covers Asian Oil and Gas defences, and the other covers credit conditions. Less protection from reserves drives the search for alternatives. India imports 88 per cent of its crude oil, making it the third-largest oil importer in the world.

ABHIJIT LELE

IGL advises C&I sector customers to draw gas within 80% usage limit

SUDHEER PAL SINGH
New Delhi, 11 March

Following up on the government’s directive to regulate gas supply to priority areas in light of the West Asia crisis, Indraprastha Gas Ltd (IGL), the country’s largest city gas distributor, on Wednesday advised its commercial and industrial (C&I) customers to draw gas within the prescribed limit.

Issuing an advisory, the company said that as per information received from upstream supplier GAIL, supplies to all C&I customers are being restricted to 80 per cent of their average consumption for the past six months, effective from 6am on March 11.

It added that the advisory aligns with the government’s gazette notification of March 9, and that customers are requested to make best endeavours to maintain drawal within 80 per cent.

With the ongoing conflict in West Asia disrupting liquefied natural gas (LNG) shipments through the Strait of Hormuz, and key suppliers announcing the force majeure clause, the government invoked the Essential Commodities Act, 1955 on March 9 to divert natural gas to

the economy’s priority sectors.

The Natural Gas (Supply Regulation) Order, 2026 stated that supply to four sectors will receive priority allocation, maintained at 100 per cent of their average gas consumption over the past six months. The first priority includes domestic piped natural gas (PNG), compressed natural gas (CNG) for transport, liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) production, including LPG shrinkage requirements, and pipeline compressor fuel and other essential pipeline operational requirements.

The second priority was supplying natural gas to fertiliser plants, ensuring they receive 70 per cent of their average gas consumption over the past six months. The third priority sector includes tea industries, manufacturing, and other industrial consumers supplied through the national gas grid who will be maintained at 80 per cent of their past six-month average gas consumption.

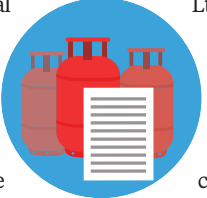
Under the “Priority Sector IV” subhead, the order stated: “All City Gas Distribution entities shall ensure that industrial and commercial

consumers supplied through their networks receive 80 per cent of their past six month average gas consumption subject to operational availability.”

It added that for the purpose of gas allocation to this sector, the principles shall be evolved by Petroleum Planning & Analysis Cell (PPAC) in coordination with the industry committee.

IGL is a joint venture between GAIL and Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL), with the Delhi government holding 5 per cent equity. The company operated 954 CNG stations, 31 lakh domestic PNG connections, and over 12,000 C&I connections at the end of April 2025.

C&I consumers accounted for 13 per cent of IGL’s sales volume of 8.9 million standard cubic meters per day (mscmd) in 2024-25 (FY25). Regasified LNG accounts for around a half of the company’s annual gas purchase. The West Asia crisis has severely disrupted India’s LNG supply due to blocked shipping routes in the Strait of Hormuz, causing temporary suspension of cargoes from key supplier Qatar.



Oil marketing companies, GAIL facing cashflow pressure: Fitch

Indian oil marketing companies (OMCs) and gas utility GAIL (India) Ltd are facing cashflow pressure from prolonged oil and gas supply disruption tied to the Iran conflict, Fitch Ratings said on Wednesday.

“An extended closure of the Strait of Hormuz or sustained high oil prices beyond a few quarters could pressure issuers’ near-term credit metrics and Standalone Credit Profiles although ratings will remain

supported by strong government linkages and state support,” the ratings agency said in a note.

Among the OMCs, Bharat Petroleum Corporation (BPCL) currently has the most balance-sheet buffers to absorb a prolonged supply disruption and feedstock price increase, while Indian Oil (IOC) and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation (HPCL) also have adequate.

SUDHEER PAL SINGH

High oil prices to intensify financial pressure on oil companies: Moody’s

The heightened risk of supply disruption from West Asia, a key crude source for Asia, has driven a sharp rise in global oil prices which will likely intensify financial pressure on national oil companies in the coming months in the region, according to Moody’s Ratings.

Fuel-pricing regimes and speed of policy response will drive effects of oil-price spike, it said in a report, adding that India’s state-owned oil-marketing companies (OMCs) are facing heightened margin and cash-flow volatility.

Domestic retail prices of fuels have remained largely steady since April 2022, despite swings in global oil and gas prices and the country’s high dependence on imports. The three OMCs control around 90 per cent of retail fuel outlets in the country.

“The companies will bear rising input costs from higher energy prices without corresponding increases in selling prices because the government’s influence over retail pricing prevents timely cost pass-throughs,” Moody’s said in the report.

SUDHEER PAL SINGH

Jaishankar speaks to Lavrov after US’ Russian oil waiver

ARCHIS MOHAN
New Delhi, 11 March

Days after the US issued a temporary 30-day waiver to New Delhi, allowing Indian refiners to purchase Russian oil in view of disruptions in the energy market, External Affairs Minister (EAM) S Jaishankar on Wednesday spoke to Russia foreign minister, Sergey Lavrov. Jaishankar also had a conversation with the European Union’s (EU)’s Foreign Policy Chief Kaja Kallas.

The EAM has, over the past few days, reached out to his counterparts in the West Asian region, including Iran, where he has sought the help of the governments of those countries for the welfare of Indians who live and work there, and also discussed the regional situation, including energy security.

The conflict in West Asia has hampered energy supplies from the region to India via the Strait of Hormuz, a narrow shipping lane between the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman that handles roughly 20 per cent of global oil and liquefied natural gas (LNG).

In a social media post, Jaishankar said he had a good telephonic conversation with Lavrov, where the

two shared their assessments on the West Asia conflict and related diplomatic efforts. The two also took stock of “our bilateral cooperation agenda”, Jaishankar said. The EAM also said that he held a “useful” discussion on the West Asia conflict and its repercussions with Kallas.

On Tuesday, Jaishankar spoke to Iranian Foreign Minister Seyed Abbas Araghchi, German Foreign Minister Johann Wadephul, and South Korean Foreign Minister Cho Hyun.

According to a readout of the Jaishankar-Araghchi conversation released by the Iranian foreign ministry on Wednesday, the Iranian foreign minister held the US responsible for the disruptions in the shipping of crude oil and gas through the Strait of Hormuz, holding Washington’s “destabilising actions” as the cause of the problem.

The readout said Araghchi provided Jaishankar a “detailed” account of the “crimes” committed by the US and Israel against Iran over the past 11 days, including the missile attack on a girls’ school in Minab and subsequent strikes on civilian sites. He emphasised Iran’s determination to comprehensively defend the integrity of Iran, the readout added.



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar also held a ‘useful’ discussion with EU foreign policy chief Kaja Kallas

this situation,” the readout said.

On the overall situation, the Iranian readout described the “aggressive act by the US and Israel” as a “violation of the fundamental principles and rules of the United Nations Charter and international law”. It said all governments have a responsibility to condemn “this military aggression and blatant law-breaking”.

“The Indian foreign minister, while emphasising the importance of continuing and enhancing bilateral relations between Tehran and New Delhi, stressed the necessity of ongoing consultations to help restore stability to the region,” it said. Jaishankar and Araghchi had earlier spoken on February 28 and March 5. An Iranian warship is currently docked at the Kochi port.

In a related development, US Ambassador to India Sergei Goron Wednesday posted on social media that “India has been a great partner in maintaining stable oil prices around the world”. Gor said “the US recognises” that “the ongoing purchases of Russian oil are a part of this effort”, “India is one of the largest consumers and refiners of oil, and it is essential for the US and India to work hand in hand for market stability for Americans and

Indians,” Gor said.

A top White House official on Tuesday said the US has “temporarily permitted” India to “accept” Russian oil already on ships to ensure energy supplies amid the conflict with Iran, and highlighted that America’s allies in India are “good actors”.

US President Donald Trump, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, and the whole national security team “came to this decision because our allies in India have been good actors and have previously stopped buying sanctioned Russian oil”, White House Press Secretary Karoline Leavitt told a press conference.

“So, as we work to ease this temporary gap of oil supply around the world because of the Iranians, we have temporarily permitted them (India) to accept that Russian oil. And this Russian oil was already at sea,” she said, adding that this short-term measure will not provide significant financial benefit to the Russian government at this time.

The Congress party said that her remarks were a “capitulation certificate” to Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

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With PTI inputs

Across workshop lanes of Punjab, the workbench warms again

Textile mills, engineering units, and sports goods makers across Ludhiana and Jalandhar test a fragile export revival

HARSH KUMAR
Ludhiana 5, Jalandhar, 11 March

The wheels of the wool-processing machines spin at a relentless pace inside Ganga Acrowools, their rhythmic hum filling the vast factory floor. Women workers stand intently at their stations, carefully filtering waste fibres and checking the quality of yarn as it moves swiftly through the system.

“This kind of buzz we are witnessing again after four to five months. With the reduction of tariffs to 18 or 15 per cent, exporters and manufacturers like us have become very bullish. We’ve already instructed our plant managers and heads to be prepared for larger orders,” said Amit Thapar (52), president of the company, located along the historic Grand Trunk Road in Kot Sekhona, Khanna, in the Ludhiana district, Punjab.

The factory, spread across more than 150 acres with 30-40 buildings, employs over 5,000 workers and runs day-and-night shifts. It had been planning the fresh construction of new units, but had to halt work due to business disruptions.

“Construction has regained pace. We also provide hostels inside the factory campus and are planning to build more in the coming years, especially for women, so they may be able to work night shifts as well,” Thapar added.

“However, there are some ongoing challenges — many customers have grown accustomed to discounted prices, and returning to original pricing isn’t easy. These legacy issues are still being worked through,” he said.

He added that no layoffs were carried out in the past five months due to the tariffs, but if the situation had continued, the company might have considered some cuts.

“However, I think we will be adding about 400 to 500 employees in 2026-27 across all segments we operate in,” Thapar said.

Thapar also said the US court’s tariff order and the bilateral agreement are both a relief. “Customers who had been trying to find other sources will now return, and orders will go

back to normal.”

“Ocean freight rates are bound to rise, and raw material prices have already started increasing. Even packing materials have become expensive. With the US dollar hitting a new high, an immediate impact on local prices is imminent,” he said.

Global fault lines keep exporters on edge

However, the war in West Asia remains a concern for the industry, adding uncertainty to the global outlook. “Global geopolitical tensions are contributing to volatility in shipping routes, freight costs, and insurance premiums. While supply chains have not been severely disrupted yet, logistics costs and uncertainties in transit times are becoming a concern for exporters who rely on timely delivery to international markets,” said Mukul Verma (45), second-generation entrepreneur at Savi International, a company started by his father in 1978.

Thapar said that after the 50 per cent tariff was imposed, the company had been operating at 70-75 per cent capacity. “Now we expect that within the next two to three months we’ll need to scale up to 100 per cent or even 110 per cent capacity,” he said. He added that businesses naturally become cautious in such situations.

“For investment and capital expenditure, uncertainty isn’t good for business. We are being cautious and, due to volatility, not entering long-term commitments. The government should continue signing free trade agreements and bilateral trade agreements and ensure a steady supply of gas and other essentials to industry,” he said.

After the silence, factory hum returns

Outside the factory gate, a queue of trucks waited to unload fresh raw material while workers inside prepared long, colourful sheets for further processing. Similar activity was visible at another textile unit roughly 10 kilometres (km) away — Shingora Textiles.

Amit Jain, chairman of Confederation of Indian Industry Punjab State Council and managing director of Shingora Textiles, said the tariff



Workers at a football manufacturing unit in Jalandhar, a major sports goods production hub

PHOTO: HARSH KUMAR

reduction would help recover the market, though regaining lost customers remains a challenge.

“The past five to six months have pushed our core customers to explore other markets. That’s a big challenge — bringing them back. Fashion cycles are longer; we have already lost two seasonal cycles. Getting business back is another challenge,” he said. During the difficult period, the company explored markets within India and in West Asia. “Vietnam and Türkiye are big challenges in the wool and textile sector,” he said.

For workers, revival means survival

Though daily routines for labourers changed, Rajesh Kumar (*name changed*), 36, a worker at the factory, said, “We did not lose our jobs, but we were not getting overtime, which used to help us earn extra income.”

Another worker, Manoj Mahto (*name changed*), said: “We are migrants who have come from 1,000 km away in Bihar just to work. Salary alone cannot sustain a family of six. My wife and I both work in this factory and together earn about ₹30,000 per month. Now that work has picked up again, it has given us a new ray of hope.”

Workshop fires up

- **Tariff shackles snap:** US tariff cuts revive exporter confidence across Punjab’s textile, engineering, and sports goods clusters
- **Factories roar back:** Units running at 70-75% expect to scale up to 100-110% within two to three months as orders return
- **Hiring wheels turn:** Ganga Acrowools plans to add 400-500 employees in FY27 across manufacturing segments
- **Shopfloor squeeze:** No layoffs, but shrinking overtime cut into workers’ extra earnings

Forging shops wait for next order

At Pankaj International, a medium enterprise near Sidhwan Canal Road in Ludhiana, iron rods were being coated with zinc while machines shaped fasteners into the required forms.

The pace here has been slower as the company largely supplies the domestic market.

“After the reduction in tariffs, we are expecting more bulk orders. We have started receiving some calls,” said Pankaj Gupta (57), chairman and founder of the company, which has been jointly run since its start in 1995. About 20 per cent of his business comes from the US.

“Some of the machines, which cost over ₹1-2 crore, had stopped running due to a shortage of orders. Some shipments were already en route, and we had to pay an extra 25 per cent, which wiped out the entire profit. But we had to execute it because it was a very large order,” Gupta said while showcasing his tin-shed factory.

“We see a jump of about 30 per cent in the next financial year. The European Union trade deal shows the world is favouring India, and we are looking for stronger global demand,” he added.

“The US is not replaceable for some specific products — consumption there is very high.”

A crowded export battlefield

“Orders were impacted, and buyers were holding a wait-and-watch position. No one was sure about the 50 per cent tariffs. Ten to 15 per cent of our total order book was affected over the past five months,” Verma said. He added that Pakistan remains a major competitor in sports goods.

“In terms of volume, they are about 10x ahead of us. Exporting sports goods is a core sector for them. China and Vietnam are also major competitors,” he said.

Major industries in Punjab export yarn, textiles, hand tools, agricultural equipment, and tractor parts to the US, among other products.

Exporters said countries such as Vietnam, Bangladesh, Pakistan, and Türkiye gained during the period, as clients naturally shifted to markets with lower tariffs.

Upkar Singh Ahuja, president of Chamber of Industrial and Commercial Undertakings, Ludhiana, said the broader impact on employment has been limited.

“Going forward, there will still be demand for labour, particularly in grey-collar segments. Exporters who were supplying to the US have spent the past five months exploring and developing alternative markets to sustain customer demand,” he said.

Game isn’t over yet in Jalandhar

At Jalandhar’s iconic Football Chowk, trucks loaded with footballs and cricket gear move alongside mustard fields in full bloom — a contrast between Punjab’s agrarian roots and its industrial ambition.

“A 50 per cent rate was not feasible at all — neither for importers nor exporters, especially for sectors like engineering goods, carpet, leather, and footwear. There is strong demand in the US, particularly for steel products, and both customers and exporters stand to benefit,” said Ashwani Kumar, partner at Victor Forgings, a Jalandhar-based company.

Surjit Singh (46), working at Savi, threading cricket balls into their final position, hopes India-US relations strengthen further so that work remains steady and opportunities continue to grow.

This is an advertisement issued, pursuant to Regulation 30(1) and Schedule V of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Issue and Listing of Non-Convertible Securities) Regulations, 2021, for information purposes only.



(Please scan the QR code to view the Abridged Prospectus)

PAAPACHAN

muthoot

FINCORP

MUTHOOT FINCORP LIMITED

Our Company, Muthoot Fincorp Limited (the “Company” or the “Issuer”) was incorporated in the Republic of India under the Companies Act, 1956, as amended as a public limited company on June 10, 1997 at Trivandrum as Muthoot Debt Management Services Limited. Subsequently, the name of the Company was changed to Muthoot Fincorp Limited, and a fresh certificate of incorporation dated March 19, 2002 was issued to the Company by the RoC. The Company is registered as a Non-Banking Financial Company (“NBFC”) vide registration number N-16.00170 dated July 23, 2002 within the meaning of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934, as amended (the “RBI Act”). For further details, see “General Information” on page 44 and “History and Certain Corporate Matters” on page 136, respectively, of the Tranche II Prospectus.

CIN: U65929KL1997PLC011518; PAN: AACCM1453E, Website: www.muthootfincorp.com
Registered office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022 Punnen Road, Trivandrum 695 001, Kerala; Tel: +91 471 491 1550; Email: cs@muthoot.com;
Corporate office: Muthoot Centre, Near Spencer Junction, M.G. Road, Trivandrum 695 039, Kerala; Tel: +91 471 491 1430; Email: cs@muthoot.com;
Compliance Officer and Company Secretary: Sachu Sivas; Email: sachu.sivas@muthoot.com; Tel: +91 471 491 1621
Chief Financial Officer: Joseph Oommen; Email: joseph.oommen@muthoot.com; Tel: +91 471 491 1588
Link to download the Abridged Prospectus - https://www.nuvama.com/muthoot-fincorp-limited-fy26/

PROMOTERS OF THE COMPANY :

- (i) Thomas John Muthoot, Email: muthoot@muthoot.com; Tel: +91 471 491 1505, (ii) Thomas George Muthoot; Email: muthoot@muthoot.com; Tel: +91 484 416 1650 and
(iii) Thomas Muthoot, Email: muthoot@muthoot.com Tel: +91 484 416 1616. For further details, please see “Our Promoters” on page 182 of the Tranche II Prospectus.

PUBLIC ISSUE BY THE COMPANY OF UPTO 60,00,000 SECURED, RATED, LISTED, REDEEMABLE, NON-CONVERTIBLE DEBENTURES OF FACE VALUE ₹1,000 EACH (“NCDs” OR “DEBENTURES”), AMOUNTING UP TO ₹20,000 LAKHS (“BASE ISSUE SIZE”) WITH A GREEN SHOE OPTION OF UP TO ₹40,000 LAKHS (“GREEN SHOE OPTION”) AGGREGATING UP TO ₹60,000 LAKHS (“TRANCHE II ISSUE SIZE” OR “TRANCHE II ISSUE”). THE TRANCHE II ISSUE SIZE IS WITHIN THE SHELF LIMIT OF ₹3,00,000 LAKHS AND IS BEING OFFERED BY WAY OF THE TRANCHE II PROSPECTUS DATED MARCH 10, 2026 CONTAINING *INTER ALIA* THE TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF TRANCHE II ISSUE (“TRANCHE II PROSPECTUS”), WHICH SHOULD BE READ TOGETHER WITH THE SHELF PROSPECTUS DATED JANUARY 29, 2026 (“SHELF PROSPECTUS”) FILED WITH THE ROC, STOCK EXCHANGES AND SEBI. THE SHELF PROSPECTUS AND THE TRANCHE II PROSPECTUS CONSTITUTES THE PROSPECTUS. THE TRANCHE II ISSUE IS BEING MADE PURSUANT TO THE PROVISIONS OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE AND LISTING OF NON – CONVERTIBLE SECURITIES) REGULATIONS, 2021, AS AMENDED (THE “SEBI NCS REGULATIONS”), THE COMPANIES ACT, 2013 AND RULES MADE THEREUNDER AS AMENDED (THE “COMPANIES ACT, 2013”) TO THE EXTENT NOTIFIED AND THE SEBI MASTER CIRCULAR, AS AMENDED FROM TIME TO TIME. THE TRANCHE II ISSUE IS NOT UNDERWRITTEN.

CREDIT RATING : “Crisil AA-/Positive” by Crisil Ratings Limited and "BWR AA/Stable" by Brickwork Ratings India Private Limited
Instruments with this rating are considered to have high degree of safety regarding timely servicing of financial obligations and carry very low credit risk

The following are the salient terms of the NCDs to be issued pursuant to the Tranche II Prospectus dated March 10, 2026.

Series	I	II	III	IV	V	VI**	VII	VIII	IX	X	XI	XII
Nature	Secured	Secured	Secured	Secured	Secured	Secured	Secured	Secured	Secured	Secured	Secured	Secured
Tenure	24 Months	36 Months	60 Months	72 Months	24 Months	36 Months	60 Months	72 Months	24 Months	36 Months	60 Months	72 Months
Frequency of Interest Payment	Monthly	Monthly	Monthly	Monthly	Annual	Annual	Annual	Annual	Cumulative	Cumulative	Cumulative	Cumulative
Minimum Application	₹10,000 (10 NCDs)											
In multiples, of	1 NCD after minimum application											
Face Value of NCDs (₹ /NCD)	₹1,000 (1 NCD)											
Issue Price (₹ /NCD)	₹1,000 (1 NCD)											
Mode of Interest Payment/ Redemption	Through various options available											
Coupon (%) (per annum) for Debenture Holders in Category I, II, III and IV	8.37%	8.52%	8.65%	8.75%	8.70%	8.85%	9.00%	9.10%	NA	NA	NA	NA
Coupon Type	Fixed											
Redemption Amount (₹ /NCD) for Debenture Holders in Category I, II, III and IV***	₹ 1,000	₹ 1,000	₹ 1,000	₹ 1,000	₹ 1,000	₹ 1,000	₹ 1,000	₹ 1,000	₹ 1,181.84	₹ 1,289.99	₹ 1,538.99	₹ 1,687.16
Effective Yield (%) (per annum) for Debenture Holders in Category I, II, III and IV	8.70%	8.85%	9.00%	9.10%	8.69%	8.84%	8.99%	9.09%	8.70%	8.85%	9.00%	9.10%
Put and Call Option	N.A.											
Nature of Indebtedness	Secured											

- ***Subject to applicable tax deducted at source, if any.
** The Company would allot the Series VI of NCDs, as specified in the Tranche II Prospectus to all valid Applications, wherein the Applicants have not indicated their choice of the relevant Series of NCDs.
1. With respect to Series where interest is to be paid on an annual basis, relevant interest will be paid on each anniversary on the face value of the NCDs. The last interest payment under annual Series will be made at the time of redemption of the NCDs.
2. With respect to Series where interest is to be paid on monthly basis, relevant interest will be paid on the first date of every month on the face value of the NCDs. The last interest payment under monthly Series will be made at the time of redemption of the NCDs. For the first interest payment for NCDs under the monthly options, interest from the Deemed Date of Allotment till the last day of the subsequent month will be clubbed and paid on the first day of the month next to that subsequent month.
3. Please refer to Annexure C of the Tranche II Prospectus for details pertaining to the illustrative cash flows of the Company in accordance with the SEBI Master Circular.

TRANCHE II
ISSUE PROGRAMME

TRANCHE II ISSUE OPENS ON: FRIDAY, MARCH 13, 2026

TRANCHE II ISSUE CLOSES ON*: MONDAY, MARCH 23, 2026

** The Tranche II Issue shall remain open for subscription on Working Days from 10:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time) during the period as indicated in the Tranche II Prospectus. Our Company may, in consultation with the Lead Manager, consider closing the Tranche II Issue on such earlier date or extended date (subject to a minimum period of two working days and a maximum period of ten working days from the date of opening of the Tranche II Issue and subject to not exceeding thirty days from filing the Tranche II prospectus with ROC, including any extensions), as may be decided by the Board of Directors or the Stock Allotment Committee, subject to relevant approvals, in accordance with the Regulation 33A of the SEBI NCS Regulations. In the event of an early closure or extension of the Tranche II Issue, our Company shall ensure that notice of the same is provided to the prospective investors through an advertisement in an English daily national newspaper with wide circulation and a regional daily with wide circulation where the registered office of the Company is located (in all the newspapers or electronic modes such as online newspapers or websites of the Issuer or the stock exchange in which pre-issue advertisement for opening of the Tranche II Issue has been given on or before such earlier or initial date of Tranche II Issue closure). On the Tranche II Issue Closing Date, the Application Forms will be accepted only between 10:00 a.m. and 3:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time) and uploaded until 5:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time) or such extended time as may be permitted by the Stock Exchange. Further, pending mandate requests for bids placed on the second last day and the last day of bidding will be validated by 5:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time) on the Tranche II Issue Closing Date. For further details please see “General Information” on page 44 of the Tranche II Prospectus.
A copy of the Shelf Prospectus and the Tranche II Prospectus has been filed with the RoC, in terms of Section 26 and Section 31 of the Companies Act, 2013, along with the requisite endorsed/certified copies of all requisite documents. For further details please see “Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection” on page 395 of the Tranche II Prospectus.

ASBA*

Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application

* Application Supported by Blocked Amount (“ASBA”) is a better way of applying to issues by simply blocking of the funds in the bank account. For further details, check section on “Issue Procedure - Method of Application” on page 369 of the Tranche II Prospectus.

Mandatory in public issues from October 01, 2018. No Cheques will be accepted.



UPI

UNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE

UPI-Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and High Networth Individuals applying through Registered Brokers, DPs and RTAs submitting bids up to an application value of ₹5,00,000/- (“UPI Limit”). Retail Individual Investors and High Networth Individuals submitting bids up UPI Limit. also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account.

Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN.

UPI is now available for Retail Individual Investors and High Networth Individuals submitting bids up to an application value of ₹ 2,00,000/- and ₹ 5,00,000/- respectively, applying through Designated Intermediaries, SCSBs or through the BSE Direct App / Web interface of Stock Exchange or any other permitted methods. For details of the ASBA and UPI Process, refer to the details given in the Application Form and also refer to the section titled “Issue Procedure” beginning on page 366 of the Tranche II Prospectus. List of banks supporting UPI is also available on the website of SEBI at HYPERLINK “http://www.sebi.gov.in/www.sebi.gov.in”. Axis Bank Limited has been appointed as Sponsor Bank for the Tranche II Issue, in accordance with the requirement of SEBI Master Circular dated October 15, 2025 on UPI mechanism, as amended.

NCD allotment will be made in dematerialised form only. Allotment in consultation with the Lead Manager and the Designated Stock Exchange shall be made on the basis of the date of upload of each application into the electronic platform of the Stock Exchange, in each proportion subject to the allocation ratio indicated in the section titled “Issue Procedure” at page 366 of the Tranche II Prospectus.

Information required under Section 30 of Companies Act, 2013:

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of the Company as regard to its objects: For information on the main objects of our company, see “History and Certain Corporate Matters” on page 136 of the Tranche II Prospectus and clause II of the Memorandum of Association of our company. The Memorandum of Association is a document for inspection in relation to the Tranche II Issue. For further details, see the section titled “Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection” on page 395 of the Tranche II Prospectus.

Liability of Members: Limited by Shares

Amount of share capital of the Company as on December 31, 2025: The Authorised Share Capital of the Company is ₹10,00,00,00,000 divided into 40,00,00,000 equity shares of face value of ₹10 each and 60,00,00,000 preference shares of face value of ₹10 each. The Issued share capital of the Company as on December 31, 2025, is ₹5,94,06,71,420 divided into 19,40,67,142 equity shares of face value ₹10 each and 40,00,00,000 preference shares of ₹10 each. Further, both the Subscribed and Paid-up share capital of the Company as on December 31, 2025 is ₹ 5,93,97,19,020 divided into 19,39,71,902 equity shares of ₹ 10 each and 40,00,00,000 preference shares of ₹10 each.

Names of the signatories at the time of signing of the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the number of shares subscribed for by them at the time of signing the Memorandum of Association: Given below are the Names of the signatories to the Memorandum of Association of our Company and shares held by them at the time of the signing of the Memorandum of Association: Mr. Thomas John Muthoot: 100 equity shares, Mr. Matthew M Thomas: 100 equity shares, Ms. Jananama Thomas : 100 equity shares, Mr. Thomas George : 100 equity shares, Mr. Thomas Muthoot : 100 equity shares, Ms. Preethi John : 100 equity shares, Ms. Nina George : 100 equity shares and Ms. Remy Thomas : 100 equity shares.

LISTING: The NCDs offered through the Tranche II Prospectus are proposed to be listed on BSE Limited (“BSE” or “Stock Exchange”). Our Company has received an ‘in-principle’ approval from BSE vide their letter no. DCS/AS/PI-BOND/30/25-26 dated January 29, 2026. BSE shall be the Designated Stock Exchange for the Issue.

GENERAL RISK: Investment in non-convertible securities is risky and investors should not invest any funds in such securities unless they can afford to take the risk attached to such investments. Investors are advised to take an informed decision and to read the risk factors carefully before investing in the Tranche II Issue. For taking an investment decision, the investors must rely on their own examination of the Issuer and the Issue, including the risks involved in it. Specific attention of the Investors is invited to the section “Risk Factors” on page 19 and “Material Developments” on page 186 of the Tranche II Prospectus. before making an investment in such Issue. These risks are not, and are not intended to be, a complete list of all risks and considerations relevant to the non-convertible securities or investor’s decision to purchase such securities. The Tranche II Prospectus has not been and will not be approved by any regulatory authority in India, including the Securities and Exchange Board of India (“SEBI”), the Reserve Bank of India (“RBI”), any Registrar of Companies, Kerala and Lakshadweep, or any stock exchange in India nor do they guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of this document.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in anyway be deemed or construed that the Tranche II Prospectus has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Tranche II Prospectus. The investors are advised to refer to the Tranche II Prospectus for the full text of the disclaimer clause of the BSE.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF USE OF BSE ELECTRONIC PLATFORM: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by the BSE to use their network and software of the Online system should not in any way be deemed or construed as compliance with various statutory requirements approved by the Exchange; nor does it in any manner warrant, certify or endorse the correctness or completeness of any of the compliance with the statutory and other requirements; nor does it take any responsibility for the financial or other soundness of the Company, its promoters, its management or any scheme or project of the Company.

DISCLAIMER STATEMENT OF CRISIL: Crisil Ratings Limited (Crisil Ratings) has taken due care and caution in preparing the material based on the information provided by its client and / or obtained by Crisil Ratings from sources which it considers reliable (information). A rating by Crisil Ratings reflects its current opinion on the likelihood of timely payment of the obligations under the rated instrument and does not constitute an audit of the rated entity by Crisil Ratings. Crisil Ratings does not guarantee the completeness or accuracy of the information on which the rating is based. A rating by Crisil Ratings is not a recommendation to buy, sell, or hold the rated instrument; it does not comment on the market price or suitability for a particular investor. The rating is not a recommendation to invest / disinvest in any entity covered in the material and no part of the material should be construed as an expert advice or investment advice or any form of investment banking within the meaning of any law or regulation. Crisil Ratings especially states that it has no liability whatsoever to the subscribers / users / transmitters/ distributors of the material. Without limiting the generality of the foregoing, nothing in the material is to be construed as Crisil Ratings providing or intending to provide any services in jurisdictions where Crisil Ratings does not have the necessary permission and/or registration to carry out its business activities in this regard. Muthoot Fincorp Limited will be responsible for ensuring compliances and consequences of non-compliances for use of the material or part thereof outside India. Current rating status and Crisil Ratings’ rating criteria are available without charge to the public on the website, www.crisilratings.com. For the latest rating information on any instrument of any company rated by Crisil Ratings, please contact customer service helpline at 1800-267-3850.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF BRICKWORK: The credit rating assigned by Brickwork Ratings India Private Limited (“BWR” or “CRA”) to the debt instruments of the Issuer has been undertaken in accordance with the provisions of the SEBI (Credit Rating Agencies) Regulations, 1999, and the applicable SEBI master circulars, guidelines and directions, as amended from time to time. The rating is based on information and data furnished by the Issuer and other sources believed by the CRA to be reliable. The CRA does not audit, verify, or independently validate such information and does not guarantee its accuracy, adequacy, or completeness. The credit rating is not a recommendation to buy, sell or hold the securities, nor does it constitute an opinion on the price, marketability, legal compliance, or suitability of the issue for any particular investor. The rating is an opinion on the relative credit risk of the rated instrument as on the date of assignment and is subject to revision, or withdrawal at any time, in accordance with applicable regulations and the CRA’s internal policies, without prior notice. The CRA shall not be liable for any losses, damages, claims or expenses (direct, indirect, incidental, special or consequential) arising out of the use of, or reliance upon, the credit rating, the consent, or the contents of any of the above documents, except to the extent mandated under applicable law. The Issuer shall not state or imply that the CRA has verified, endorsed, guaranteed or assured the performance, repayment, or compliance of the issuer or the rated instruments.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF CRISIL (INDUSTRY REPORT): Crisil Intelligence, a division of Crisil Limited, provides independent research, consulting, risk solutions, and data & analytics to its clients. Crisil Intelligence operates independently of Crisil’s other divisions and subsidiaries, including, Crisil Ratings Limited. Crisil Intelligence’s informed insights and opinions on the economy, industry, capital markets and companies drive impactful decisions for clients across diverse sectors and geographies. Crisil Intelligence’s strong benchmarking capabilities, granular grasp of sectors, proprietary analytical frameworks and risk management solutions backed by deep understanding of technology integration, makes it the partner of choice for public & private organisations, multi-lateral agencies, investors and governments for over three decades.

For the preparation of this report, Crisil Intelligence has relied on third party data and information obtained from sources which in its opinion are considered reliable. Any forward-looking statements contained in this report are based on certain assumptions, which in its opinion are true as on the date of this report and could fluctuate due to changes in factors underlying such assumptions or events that cannot be reasonably foreseen. This report does not consist of any investment advice and nothing contained in this report should be construed as a recommendation to invest/disinvest in any entity. This industry report is intended for use only within India. Provided that, the company shall be responsible for ensuring compliances and consequences of non-compliance for use of the report, material & issue documents or any part thereof outside india in relation to the issue.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF RBI: The company is having a valid certificate of registration dated July 23, 2002 bearing registration no. n-16.00170 issued by the Reserve Bank of India under section 45 IA of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. However, RBI does not accept any responsibility or guarantee about the present position as to the financial soundness of the company or for the correctness of any of the statements or representations made or opinions expressed by the company and for repayment of deposits/ discharge of liability by the company.

CREDIT RATING: Our Company has received rating of “Crisil AA-/Positive” (pronounced as Crisil double A minus rating with positive outlook) each, for an amount of ₹2,73,704 lakhs (of which ₹2,40,000 lakhs is unutilised) of NCDs by Crisil Ratings Limited vide its letter dated March 6, 2026 along with the rating rationale dated March 6, 2026, for the NCDs proposed to be issued pursuant to the Tranche II Issue. Further, our Company has received rating of “BWR AA/Stable” for an amount of ₹3,00,000 lakhs by Brickwork Ratings India Private Limited vide its letter dated October 08, 2025 along with rating rationale dated October 08, 2025, for the NCDs proposed to be issued pursuant to the Tranche II Issue. The rating given by Crisil Ratings Limited and Brickwork Ratings India Private Limited is valid as on the date of the Tranche II Prospectus and shall remain valid on date of issue and Allotment of the NCDs and the listing of the NCDs on BSE. The ratings of the NCDs indicates that instruments with this rating are considered to have high degree of safety regarding timely servicing of financial obligations. Such instruments carry very low credit risk. The ratings provided by Crisil Ratings Limited and Brickwork Ratings India Private Limited may be suspended, withdrawn or revised at any time by the assigning rating agency and should be evaluated independently of any other rating. These ratings are not a recommendation to buy, sell or hold securities and Investors should take their own decisions. Please refer to Annexure A on page 398 for the rationale and press release for the above ratings. There are no unaccepted ratings and any other ratings other than as specified in the Tranche II Prospectus.

Availability of Application Form : Application form can be obtained from: Muthoot Centre, Near Spencer Junction, M.G. Road, Trivandrum - 695 039, Kerala; Tel: +91 471 491 1430, **Lead Manager :** Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Tel: +91 22 4009 4400 and offices of Sub Syndicate Members, Trading Members and Designated Branches of The SCSBs. Application forms may be downloaded from the websites of the Company, BSE and the Lead Manager.

Availability of Shelf Prospectus and Tranche II Prospectus : Investors are advised to refer to the Shelf Prospectus and Tranche II Prospectus and the Risk Factors contained therein, before applying in the Tranche II Issue. Physical copy of the Shelf Prospectus and Tranche II Prospectus may be obtained from Registered Office of the Company and the Lead Manager. The soft copy of the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the website of Company at www.muthootfincorp.com, Lead Manager to the Issue at www.nuvama.com and Registrar to the Issue at www.integratedregistry.in

Public Issue Account Bank, Sponsor Bank and Refund Bank : Axis Bank Limited

Note: All Capitalised terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the Shelf Prospectus dated January 29, 2026 and Tranche II Prospectus dated March 10, 2026.

Name of the Consortium Member: Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited

LEAD MANAGER TO THE ISSUE	REGISTRAR TO THE ISSUE	DEBENTURE TRUSTEE	CREDIT RATING AGENCY	JOINT STATUTORY AUDITORS	
					M/s. Isaac & Suresh, Chartered Accountants 1st Floor, NRA-52, Thennala Towers, Nandavanam, Palayam, Thiruvananthapuram – 695033, Kerala Tel: +91 471 2329875, +91 9447427862 Email: isaacsandureshtrvm@gmail.com, 58suresh@gmail.com Website: www.isaacsanduresh.com Contact Person: Sobha Sethumadhavan Peer Review No.: 017346 Firm Registration No.: 001150S
Nuvama Wealth Management Limited 801-804, Wing A, Building No 3 Inspire BKC, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex Bandra East, Mumbai – 400 051 Tel: +91 22 4009 4400 Email: mfl.ncd@nuvama.com Website: www.nuvama.com Contact Person: Ms. Sail Dave	Integrated Registry Management Services Private Limited 2 nd Floor, Kences Towers, No. 1 Ramakrishna Street, North Usman Road, T. Nagar, Chennai – 600 017 Tel: +91 44 2814 0801 to 2814 0803 Fax: +91 44 2814 2479 Email: yuvraj@integratedindia.in Website: www.integratedregistry.in Contact Person: S Yuvraj	Vardhman Trusteeship Private Limited* Unit No. 412, The Capital, C-70 G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Audit Bhavan, Mumbai, Bandra, Maharashtra, India, 400051 Tel: +91 22 4264 8335/ 4014 0832 E-mail: compliance@vardhmantrustee.com Website: www.vardhmantrustee.com Contact Person: Rushabh Desai	Crisil Ratings Limited Lightbridge IT Park, Saki Vihar Road, Andheri East, Mumbai – 400 072 Tel: +91 22 6137 3000 (B) Email: crisilratingsdesk@crisil.com Contact Person: Ajit Velonie	M/s. Vishnu Rajendran & Co, Chartered Accountants No.55/359, South Bridge Avenue Road, Panampilly Nagar, Ernakulam – 682036 Tel: +91 9400627999 Email: kochi@vrc.co.in Website: http://www.vrc.co.in Contact Person: M.P. Jose Peer Review No.: 015121 Firm Registration No.: 004741S	
COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER		Sachu Sivas Muthoot Fincorp Limited, Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Trivandrum – 695 001. Tel: +91 471 491 1621; Email: sachu.sivas@muthoot.com			Investors may contact the Registrar to the Issue or the Compliance Officer in case of any pre- Issue or post Issue related issues such as non-receipt of Allotment Advice, demat credit, refund orders, or interest on application money etc.

* Vardhman Trusteeship Private Limited has by its letter dated January 21, 2026 given its consent for its appointment as Debenture Trustee to the Issue and for its name to be included in the Draft Shelf Prospectus, the Shelf Prospectus and the Tranche II Prospectus and in all the subsequent periodical communications sent to the holders of the NCDs issued pursuant to the Tranche II Issue.

Disclaimer: Muthoot Fincorp Limited (“Company”), subject to market conditions, and other considerations, is proposing a public issue of secured, rated, listed, redeemable, non-convertible debentures (“NCDs”) and has filed Tranche II prospectus dated March 10, 2026 (“Tranche II Prospectus”) which should be read together with the Shelf Prospectus dated January 29, 2026 (the “Shelf Prospectus”) (together with the Tranche II Prospectus, the “Prospectus”) with the Registrar of Companies, Kerala and Lakshadweep (“RoC”), BSE Limited (“BSE” or “Stock Exchange”) and Securities and Exchange Board of India (“SEBI”). The Shelf Prospectus and Tranche II Prospectus is available on the website of the Company at www.muthootfincorp.com, on the website of BSE at www.bseindia.com, on the website of the lead manager at www.nuvama.com, and on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in. Investors proposing to participate in the Tranche II Issue should invest only on the basis of the information contained in the Shelf Prospectus and Tranche II Prospectus. Investors should note that investment in the NCDs involves a high degree of risk and for details in relation to the same, refer to the Tranche II Prospectus, including the section titled “Risk Factors” beginning on page 19 of the Tranche II Prospectus and “Material Developments” beginning on page 186 of the Tranche II Prospectus. The Issuer and the Lead Manager accept no responsibility for statements made otherwise than in the Shelf Prospectus and Tranche II Prospectus or in the advertisement or any other material issued by or at the instance of the Company and that anyone placing reliance on any other source of information would be doing so at their own risk. Capitalised terms not defined herein shall have the same meaning as assigned to such terms in the Tranche II Prospectus dated March 10, 2026.

Place: Trivandrum
Date: March 11, 2026

For Muthoot Fincorp Limited
Sd/-
Thomas John Muthoot
Managing Director
(DIN : 00011618)

Adaptors 867/26

SBI, MUFG sign pact on M&A, aviation and realty

SUBRATA PANDA
Mumbai, 11 March

State Bank of India (SBI), the country's largest lender, on Wednesday said it had signed a strategic partnership agreement with Japan-based MUFG Bank to explore collaboration in structuring and financing projects, focusing on sectors such as mergers and acquisitions (M&A), aviation, and real estate finance, to support Indian and global clients. The announcement comes weeks after SBI Chairman C S Setty said they are in talks with Japanese lenders to partner for M&A financing in light of new norms announced by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). SBI has a lending ceiling of ₹94,000 crore according to the new rules. "Both banks will also help facilitate the introduction of Indian mid-corporates and micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) to Japanese corporate clients, identifying

financing opportunities that deepen transaction-level collaboration," the bank said in a statement. Additionally, SBI will also cooperate on M&A advisory, trade finance, and retail banking solutions, facilitating Japanese corporate-linked potential inbound and outbound transactions by leveraging its deep expertise in the Indian market and MUFG's extensive global network, it said. The partnership between SBI and MUFG will leverage the complementary strengths of both institutions to facilitate cross-border capital flows, create new synergistic financing opportunities, and support sustainable

economic growth across two of Asia's largest economies. "India represents one of the most compelling growth markets globally, and the India-Japan corridor continues to deepen. We are witnessing strong momentum from Japanese companies expanding their presence in India, alongside increasing global ambition from Indian enterprises. Through our partnership with SBI, MUFG aims to provide integrated cross-border solutions that support both inbound investment into India and outbound expansion by Indian corporates," said Takuya Senoo, regional executive for India & Sri Lanka, MUFG Bank, adding that this collabora-

tion with SBI reflects MUFG's long-term commitment to strengthening economic ties between Japan and India. The partnership builds on an expanding track record of collaboration between MUFG Bank and SBI. Recently, SBI launched a \$500 million syndicated gender loan facility with a green-shoe option, arranged by MUFG, aimed at advancing women's economic empowerment. Earlier, in 2023, MUFG acted as the lead social loan coordinator and arranger for SBI's \$1 billion inaugural social loan, one of the largest such loans raised by a bank in the Asia-Pacific region. MUFG has also engaged with SBI's CHAKRA Centre of Excellence under its project finance and structuring function to support the development of financing frameworks for India's priority sunrise sectors aligned with the Viksit Bharat 2047 vision.



PARTNERSHIP WILL FACILITATE CROSS-BORDER CAPITAL FLOWS AND SUPPORT SUSTAINABLE ECONOMIC GROWTH ACROSS ASIA'S TWO MAJOR ECONOMIES

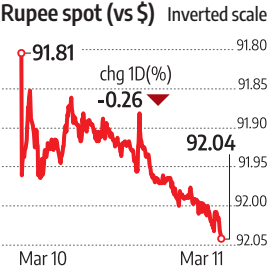
Rupee depreciates as crude rises, domestic equities fall

ANJALI KUMARI
Mumbai, 11 March

The rupee depreciated on Wednesday tracking the rise in crude oil prices and selling in domestic equities, said dealers. The local currency settled at 92.04 per dollar, against the previous close of 91.81. Intensifying geopolitical tensions in West Asia over the past two weeks have heightened risk aversion in global markets and pushed crude oil prices higher, putting sustained pressure on the rupee. Brent crude oil price rose to \$99.06 per barrel, against the previous day's \$98.63. Market participants said that state-owned banks sold dollar likely on the behalf of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to cap further losses. "The Indian rupee has depreciated against the US dollar, even as regional currencies show a mixed performance. While the central bank's dollar supplies have helped limit losses, firm demand from

importers continues to drag the currency lower," said Dilip Parmar, senior research analyst, HDFC Securities. "In the near term, spot dollar-rupee finds immediate support at 91.60 per dollar, with key resistance seen at 92.40," he added. The currency has also been weighed down by tight dollar liquidity, partly due to capital outflows from domestic equity and debt markets. While movement in Asian currencies was mixed, dollar index firmed to 99.06 against the previous day's 98.63. The dollar index measures the strength of the greenback against a basket of six major currencies. "There was support from RBI, but the pressure is consistent on rupee because of the continuous selling by foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) in both equities and bonds," said a dealer at a state-owned bank. Dollar index rose on Wednesday as the battle between US-Israel and Iran intensified with Israel targeting Iran overnight while Iran targeting those bases that constitute the aggression against Iran.

Under pressure



Source: Bloomberg
Compiled by BS Research Bureau

Orissa HC asks MHA to formulate uniform policy to freeze bank a/cs

Says blanket freeze hurts businesses and individuals

HEMANT KUMAR ROUT
Bhubaneswar, 11 March

The Orissa High Court (HC) has called for a uniform national policy on freezing bank accounts during criminal investigations, observing that indiscriminate blocking of entire accounts is causing serious hardship to individuals and businesses dependent on such transaction accounts. The HC directed the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) to examine the issue and frame a comprehensive national policy and standard operating procedure (SOP) governing the freezing of bank accounts by investigating agencies. The order came while adjudicating a petition filed by M/s Sairam Bharat Gas, a liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) distributor operating in Odisha's Gajapati district, which challenged the freezing of its current

account by the State Bank of India's Paralakhemundi branch during a criminal investigation. The account was frozen following a direction from the cyber-crime police station in Thiruvananthapuram in connection with a cyberfraud probe. A single-judge Bench of Justice Sanjeeb Kumar Panigrahi observed that the growing tendency of law enforcement agencies to freeze entire bank accounts during investigations, often without prior notice, has resulted in severe operational difficulties for businesses and financial distress for account holders. The petitioner told the court that its account had been frozen without prior intimation, effectively halting its business operations. The LPG distributor, which relies on the account for routine transactions such as payments to suppliers, employee salaries and statutory

dues, argued that while investigating agencies may secure suspected amounts linked to alleged offences, freezing the entire account irrespective of the amount under investigation was arbitrary and disproportionate, as it paralysed operations and disrupted LPG distribution. Taking note of this, the HC emphasised that investigative powers must be exercised in a balanced and proportionate manner, ensuring that legitimate business activities are not unnecessarily disrupted. During the hearing, the court examined the scope of the police's power to freeze accounts under Section 106 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita. While acknowledging that such power exists for investigative purposes, the court said it must be exercised proportionately and with due regard to constitutional rights.

FATF: India developing capability to detect unregistered virtual asset service providers

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 11 March

India is working to create an indigenous Virtual Asset Lab for detection of unregistered, high-risk offshore virtual asset service providers (oVASPs) by using analytics and web surveillance tools. A Financial Action Task Force (FATF) report, titled 'Understanding and mitigating the risks of offshore virtual asset service providers', gave case studies of India and other countries on how oVASPs are

being used for money laundering and supervision being done by the nations. According to the report, some jurisdictions have established structured cooperation with internet service providers, app-store operators and online platforms to disrupt unauthorised oVASPs activity. Giving a case study from India, the FATF report said that FIU-India, along with the Home Ministry, has directed intermediaries (social media platforms, web hosts, internet service pro-

viders) to take down website content. "So far, 85 URLs pertaining to unregistered non-compliant oVASPs have been taken down," it said. Giving insights into how India handles trading in virtual assets, the report said that when a VASP raises multiple red flags, FIU-India (Financial Intelligence Units-India) initiates supervisory actions and directs the entities to comply or cease operations. Notices are issued to these entities under the relevant money laundering regulations.

RBI revises CCR rules, aligns them with Basel norms

ANJALI KUMARI
Mumbai, 11 March

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has revised its counterparty credit risk (CCR) framework to better align with norms set by the Basel Committee on banking supervision, aiming to improve how banks measure exposures arising from derivatives. The revisions lower capital add-ons for interest rate and foreign exchange contracts while increasing them for some long-dated equity and commodity swaps, a move that could temper activity in those segments. The revised framework also clarifies the capital treatment for banks acting as clearing members on exchanges recognised by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) in equity and commodity derivatives segments. Regulated entities must now include CCR exposures of all entities consolidated under the Basel III framework when computing capital on a consolidated basis. They also revise the add-on factors used to calculate potential future exposure under the current exposure method, bringing them broadly in line with international standards. "The amendment... seeks to ensure that banks more accurately capture potential exposures arising from derivatives, particularly where they act as clearing members in exchange-traded markets," said Pururaj Bhar, partner at Cyril Amarchand Mangaldas. Experts said the clarification on clearing member exposures could encourage greater use of central clearing, collateralised netting, and stronger margining practices to manage risks. While overall impact could be limited, banks with larger proprietary derivatives exposures may need to adjust pricing and operational frameworks.

DATANOMICS



Poorest, richest hit hard by tobacco

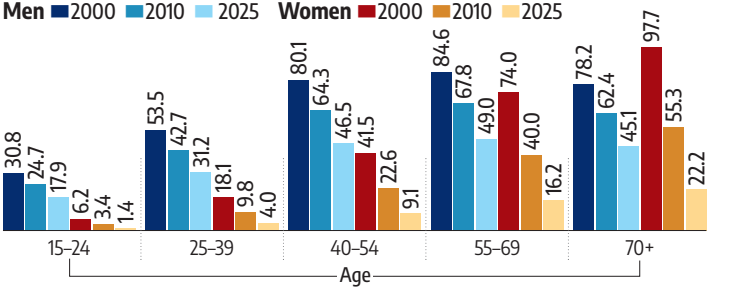
SNEHA SASIKUMAR

No Smoking Day, observed on the second Wednesday of March, aims to spread awareness about the harms of smoking. This year, it was on March 11. According to the World Health Organization, men smoke far more than women in India, but the numbers have declined between 2000 and 2025. Tobacco expenditure rose highest among the poorest 5 per cent in rural areas and the richest 5 per cent in urban areas during 2011-12 to 2022-23.

Young women smoke the least

Among men, smoking rates roughly halved, with the sharpest drop occurring in the 55-69 age group in the past 25 years. Among women, the steepest decline occurred in the 70+ group. Women aged 15-24 now have the lowest smoking rate, at just 1.4 per cent.

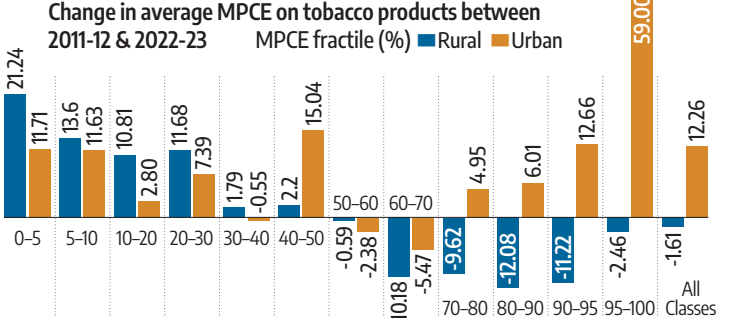
Rates of current tobacco smoking (%)



Note: Current tobacco use is the percentage of people aged 15+ who currently use any tobacco product daily or occasionally. Source: WHO

Urban spending on tobacco rises

In rural areas, overall tobacco spending fell 1.6 per cent between 2011-12 and 2022-23, while in urban areas they moved in the opposite direction, rising 12 per cent over the same period.

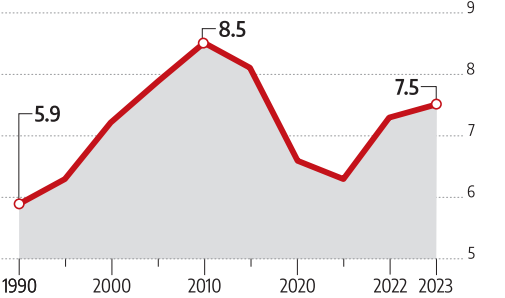


Note: Tobacco products include bidi, cigarettes, chewing tobacco (gutka, zarda, kimam, surty, leaf tobacco), hookah, among others; MPCE: Monthly per capita expenditure Sources: Mospi, National Institute of Public Finance and Policy

Deaths by smoking rising again

Between 1990 and 2023, the share of respiratory deaths linked to smoking in India rose by 1.6 percentage points.

Share of smoking in deaths caused by respiratory diseases (%)



Sources: IHME, Global Burden of Disease (2025)

CreditAccess to boost annual overseas borrowings to \$400 mn

In talks with ADB for direct lending

ABHIJIT LELE
Mumbai, 11 March

Microfinance lender CreditAccess Grameen plans to increase its international borrowings to \$400 million per annum in the next two to three years, up from the current level of \$300 million. This move is part of plans to diversify the resource pool and support the target of growing the asset book to ₹50,000 crore by December 2028. At present, most of its overseas funding comes through external commercial borrowings (ECBs). This week, CreditAccess, a non-banking financial company-micro finance institution (NBFC-MFI), signed a syndicated social loan facility of \$75 million, qualifying as an ECB under the automatic route of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). HSBC acted as Sole Mandated Lead Arranger for the fundraise and secured participations from HSBC (GIFT City), Doha Bank, State Bank (Mauritius), Bank of China, and National Development Bank Plc (Sri Lanka). Nilesh Dalvi, chief financial officer (CFO), CreditAccess Grameen, told *Busi-*

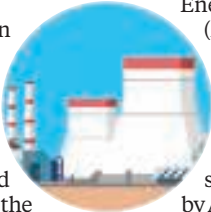
ness Standard: "We should be raising around \$400 million of foreign funds every year. Some of it will go for repayment of our past loans, and some of it will be used, obviously, for business growth." Overseas borrowing in the current financial year 2025-26 (FY26) will be close to \$300 million. This would mean the company's borrowing requirements in FY26 through foreign sources will be over 15 per cent. The outstanding foreign borrowings will be around \$600-650 million by the end of FY26. The share of foreign borrowings has increased from 9 per cent five years ago to 24 per cent now, Dalvi said. It would gradually move up to 30-35 per cent over next two to three years. The share will go up because these are longer-term loans, which don't get repaid quickly. They keep adding up to the overall borrowings. Foreign currency borrowings with a tenure of three to five years significantly enhance our asset-liability management (ALM) profile, and liquidity position. The maximum tenure of loans in the micro-finance business is three years.

Barc developing 220 Mw Bharat Small Modular Reactors

SUDHEER PAL SINGH
New Delhi, 11 March

The Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (Barc) is developing 220 Megawatt (Mw) Bharat Small Modular Reactors, also called BSMR-200, at a cost of ₹5,960 crore apart from two units of 55 Mw capacity Small Modular Reactor or SMR-55 at a cost of ₹7,000 crore. Barc has undertaken design and development works on these SMRs under the Nuclear Energy Mission announced in

the Union Budget 2025-26 which has a total budgetary provision of ₹20,000 crore for SMRs. In a written reply in Parliament, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science & Technology and Earth Sciences, and Minister of State in the Prime Minister's Office, Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions, Atomic Energy and Space, Jitendra Singh shared



the progress of the SMRs. He said the in-principle approval from the Atomic Energy Commission (AEC) has been received for the BSMR-200 project and the proposal for administrative and financial sanction is cleared by AEC for submission of the proposal to the Cabinet Committee. He said in-principle approval has been received for the

SMR-55 project and the High Temperature Gas Cooled Reactor (HTGCR) project too. Barc is currently engaged in the design and construction of HTGCR with a cost outlay of ₹320 crore. "Lead units of these SMRs will be constructed by DAE at its existing sites. So far, PSUs like Engineers India Limited and Bharat Heavy Electrical Limited (BHEL) have been contacted for detailed engineering of SMRs," Singh said. He added that the Tarapur

Atomic Power Station site in Maharashtra has been identified for lead units of BSMR-200 and SMR-55 whereas Vizag, Andhra Pradesh site of Barc is identified for the High Temperature Gas Cooled Reactor. The BSMR project is being jointly designed and developed by Barc and Nuclear power Corporation of India (NPCIL) and the estimated time for construction of BSMR is 60 to 72 months from the date of receipt of administrative and financial approval, Singh said.

ALL IN A DAY

₹590 cr IDFC First Bank 'fraud': ED registers case, searches 19 locations

The Enforcement Directorate registered a case and conducted searches at multiple locations on Wednesday in connection with alleged embezzlement of ₹590 crore from the Haryana government's accounts maintained with IDFC First Bank in Chandigarh, official sources said. The agency conducted searches at 19 premises in Chandigarh, Gurugram in Haryana and Mohali in Punjab against various business entities which helped the accused persons get accommodation (hawala) entries to conceal the money trail and proceeds of crime, they said. The raids were undertaken after the ED booked a case under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) taking cognisance of a Haryana State Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau (SV & ACB) FIR.

PTI

RBI to buy ₹50,000 cr govt bonds via OMO tomorrow

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) announced plans to purchase ₹50,000 crore worth of government bonds via open market operation (OMO) auction on Friday. The move follows the RBI's earlier announcement regarding liquidity infusion through OMOs. The central bank will buy government bonds through a multi-security auction using the multiple price method. The securities identified for purchase include the 6.45 per cent government security (GS) 2029, 7.95 per cent GS 2032, 6.79 per cent GS 2034, 6.64 per cent GS 2035, 7.41 per cent GS 2036, 7.62 per cent GS 2039, and 7.06 per cent GS 2046. The RBI said there is no security-wise notified amount for the auction and the total purchase will be up to ₹50,000 crore across the selected securities.

BS REPORTER

Govt to prepare road map for resolution of issues in shipping sector

Union Minister for Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal on Wednesday asked officials to prepare a road map to resolve challenges faced by the shipping industry, which has been impacted by geopolitical developments and supply chain management. The minister chaired a high-level meeting with the National Shipping Board and other stakeholders and officials, which focused on "identifying policy interventions to strengthen India's shipping ecosystem, enhance fleet capacity and ensure resilience in maritime logistics," a ministry release said. Officials said the interaction covered the government's efforts to ensure uninterrupted cargo movement and maintain stability across the maritime sector while addressing industry concerns.

BS REPORTER

FSSAI calls for QR codes on labels of plant-based products

Food safety authority FSSAI on Wednesday urged plant-based food manufacturers to adopt QR codes on product labels, saying existing labels are too small for consumers to read, as the regulator seeks to build trust in a rapidly growing sector. Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) Chief Executive Officer Rajit Punhani, speaking at the 4th Plant-Based Foods Summit, said the authority was not looking to make QR codes mandatory, but wanted companies to voluntarily adopt the technology. "The label is too small, it's difficult to read and difficult to comprehend," Punhani said, adding that Gen Z consumers in particular could benefit from being able to scan codes to check daily nutritional requirements.

PTI

Cred gets RBI approval to operate as payment aggregator

Fintech firm Cred received a final licence from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to become a payment aggregator on Tuesday, allowing the firm to onboard merchants, collect payments on their behalf across instruments, and handle settlement and refunds. The Bengaluru-based firm has an online and physical payment aggregator licence along with a prepaid payment instrument (PPI) approval from the banking regulator. "Stakeholder trust has been central to how we've built CRED... we've operated with a high bar for performance, reliability, transparency, and governance from day zero. The authorisation... reflects the trust we've consistently built... and sets the foundation for the next chapter of enabling financial progress for India's most creditworthy," said Kunal Shah, founder, Cred.

BS REPORTER

Oppn CMs urge PM to ensure cooking gas supply isn’t disrupted

ARCHIS MOHAN
New Delhi, 11 March

Amid the Opposition’s criticism of the government’s handling of the fallout from the conflict in West Asia, and its demands for a discussion in Parliament on the issue, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday accused the Congress of indulging in cheap politics over the crisis.

The Congress on Wednesday repeated its demand for a discussion in Parliament on the issue, while Chief Ministers, including M K Stalin of Tamil Nadu, Pinarayi Vijayan of Kerala and Mamata Banerjee of West Bengal urged the PM and the Union government to take steps to ensure that the supply of cooking gas is not disrupted.

The Centre on Wednesday said that the Union Home Secretary held a meeting with the chief secretaries and director generals of police of states and Union Territories where he asked them to take proactive action to prevent hoarding and black-marketing of LPG cylinders. The states and UTs were also asked to ensure a credible flow of information to people by appointing spokespersons and also use its verified social media handles to communicate to the people the steps that is being taken to manage the fallout of the conflict in West Asia.

Addressing a Bharatiya Janata Party-led National Democratic Alliance rally in Kerala’s Kochi, Modi said that the Congress “yuvaraj” (prince) doesn’t know about the developments taking place in the country as he was unaware that the youth and various companies in

India, including in Kerala, were into drone manufacturing.

Referring to the West Asia crisis, the PM said he claimed that the India of today does not leave its citizens stranded elsewhere and that the central government was working to ensure that all help is provided to Indians stuck in the Gulf region. He said the Congress

PM NARENDRA MODI SAID CONGRESS WAS PLAYING POLITICS ON THE ISSUE BY MAKING ‘PROVOCATIVE AND IRRESPONSIBLE STATEMENTS’

was playing politics on the issue by making “provocative and irresponsible statements.” The PM said the Gulf countries were looking after Indians who live and work there well, and he was grateful to them for that.

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) on Wednesday said two Indians were killed, and one is missing, when merchant vessels came under attack during the ongoing war in West Asia. MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said the control rooms of the ministry and that of its missions in the region are functioning round the clock and helping out Indians that have reached out. MEA officials said the airspace of some of the countries, especially Kuwait and Bahrain, is completely shut, and alternative arrangements have been made to fly out Indians from airports in Saudi Arabia. The Congress on Wednesday reiterated its demand for a full-

fledged discussion in Parliament on the West Asia crisis that has led to energy shortage. Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said the energy crisis is deepening in the country and people are being made to suffer the hardships.

“The country deserves the truth. We demand a full discussion on this crisis in Parliament and the Prime Minister must answer the nation,” the Congress chief said.

Kharge said India’s basmati exports are stuck, wheat exports disrupted, medicine prices likely to surge as raw material costs rise nearly 30 per cent, textile sector is facing cascading cost pressures and the price of aviation fuel is rising. “From ceramics and glass to FMCG and automobiles, every sector is feeling the heat. Every product likely to become costlier,” Kharge said in a social media post.

In his letter to the PM, TN CM Stalin appealed to Modi to ensure the safe evacuation of Tamils stranded in West Asia and requested urgent intervention to address disruptions in LPG supply caused by the ongoing conflict in the region. Bengal CM Banerjee on Wednesday criticised the Centre for the LPG supply constraint. “The central government should have first ensured enough reserves of LPG, oil and gas. Without that, they have imposed restrictions sans any proper planning to tackle the situation,” she said. Banerjee alleged that the Centre was focusing more on politics rather than addressing the issues arising out of the energy situation.

..... with PTI inputs

Disassociate from authors of judiciary chapter: SC to govt

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 11 March

Acting tough against three experts involved in drafting of a controversial chapter in NCERT’s class 8 social science book containing “offending” contents on corruption in the judiciary, the Supreme Court on Wednesday directed the Centre and all state governments to disassociate from them.

The apex court directed the Centre to constitute a committee of domain experts within a week for the purpose of finalising the curriculum of NCERT’s legal studies of not only class 8 but higher classes also.

A Bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant was informed that the chapter was drafted by the textbook development team under the chairmanship of professor Michel Danino and consisting of members Suparna Diwakar and Alok Prasanna Kumar. “At the outset, we have no reason to doubt that professor Michel Danion and his associates Suparna Diwakar and Alok Pra-



sanna Kumar either do not have reasonable informed knowledge with respect to Indian judiciary and/or they deliberately and knowingly misrepresented the facts in order to project a negative image of Indian judiciary before the students of class 8...,” the bench said. The top court said it sees no reason as to why these persons be associated in any manner for the purpose of preparation of curriculum or for finalisation of textbooks for the next generation of children.

It directed the Centre, state governments and Union Territories, universities, and public in-

stitutions receiving government funds to “disassociate three of them forthwith and not to assign any responsibility which incur fully or partially public funds”. It said this order, however, shall be subject to their approaching the top court for modification along with an explanation, if any, they wish to tender.

The Bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi, said it was “equally perturbed” with the stand taken by NCERT director in his affidavit that the chapter has been “duly rewritten”.

“We direct that if at all chapter 4 of the subject textbook has been rewritten, the same shall not be published unless it is approved by a committee comprising domain experts,” it said.

The Bench said the Centre should also revisit the composition of the National Syllabus and Teaching Learning Material Committee (NSTC), especially those with whom the offending chapter was digitally shared by members of the textbook development team.

Adhere to fiscal deficit norms: NITI to states

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 11 March

Government think tank NITI Aayog on Wednesday urged state governments to adhere to fiscal deficit norms under the FRBM Act through disciplined expenditure management, broadening the GST base, and enhancing their own tax capacity.

The Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management (FRBM) Act aims to regulate the country’s debt level by restricting fiscal and revenue deficits as a percentage of GDP. NITI Aayog’s 2026 Fiscal Health Index (FHI) for 2023-24 suggests that states with widening revenue deficits should prioritise aligning revenue expenditure with sustainable revenue growth.

Odisha, Goa, Jharkhand, Gujarat, Maharashtra Chhattisgarh, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka and Madhya Pradesh have emerged as India’s top 10 fiscalwise states, according to the latest fiscal health index for the financial year 2023-24.

Bihar, Karnataka and Telangana showed a mild recovery, whereas Punjab, West Bengal and Kerala remained at the bottom of the index. In the FHI of 2025, which ranked states based on their fiscal situation during 2022-23, Odisha was number 1, followed by Chhattisgarh, Goa, Jharkhand and Gujarat.

Among north-eastern and Himalayan states, Arunachal Pradesh has topped in the index, followed by Uttarakhand, Tripura, Meghalaya, Assam and Mizoram.

The report was released by NITI Aayog Vice Chairman Suman Bery.

“We are seeing at the national level shocks that come from a number of sources. We are talking international shocks, but there are domestic shocks as well... so one important developmental consequence of maintaining strong fiscal health is, of course, to have a buffer when shocks hit,” he said. The FHI is a comprehensive framework for assessing and comparing the fiscal performance of states.

▶ FROM PAGE 1

Don’t panic, fuel cargoes on the way: Govt

To ensure household availability, the government has prioritised LPG and gas supplies for domestic cooking fuel and compressed natural gas (CNG) for transport, reducing allocations to other sectors including the fertiliser industry, hotels and restaurants, and refineries.

India imports around 60 per cent of its LPG requirements, of which nearly 90 per cent transits through the Strait of Hormuz, the official said. Of India’s total natural gas consumption of 189 million standard cubic metres per day (mscmd), around 46 mscmd has been affected after QatarEnergy halted LNG production. Qatar is India’s largest LNG supplier.

“Procurement of energy supplies from other sources is underway. Cargoes are on the way to India. There is no need for panic,” Sharma said. Refineries across the country are operating at the highest capacity levels, with some running at more than 100 per cent capacity, she added.

Two Indians killed

Two Indian nationals have been killed and another is missing after a merchant vessel operating in the conflict zone in West Asia came under attack, government officials from the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said during the inter-ministerial briefing.

The victims were Indian seafarers working aboard commercial ships in the region. Authorities said efforts are underway to gather further details about the incident and locate the missing individual.

According to an official from the Shipping Ministry, 28 Indian-flagged vessels are currently operating in the Persian Gulf region, carrying more

than 700 Indian seafarers. Of these, 24 vessels with 677 Indian crew members are located west of the Strait of Hormuz, while four vessels with 101 Indian crew members are operating east of the strategic waterway. The government has also set up 24-hour control rooms at the Ministry of External Affairs and the Directorate General of Shipping to respond to queries and monitor developments.

Officials said the MEA control room received 75 phone calls and 11 emails in a single day, largely from families seeking information about relatives working in the region. Apart from the fatalities at sea, some Indians in West Asia have also been injured in separate incidents linked to the ongoing tensions. One Indian national sustained rib injuries and is recovering in hospital, while another injured in Dubai is receiving medical treatment.

The government said it is also closely monitoring the situation of Indian nationals in Iran. Around 9,000 Indians are currently in the country, including students. Some have already returned to India following official advisories.

Authorities have facilitated the relocation of some students and pilgrims to safer cities within Iran and have also enabled land evacuation routes through Armenia and Azerbaijan for those wishing to leave. Officials said the safety of Indian nationals remains a priority, noting that nearly 10 million Indians live across Gulf Cooperation Council countries. The government continues to maintain close diplomatic contact with regional governments while monitoring the situation closely.

global exports, create jobs, and boost economic growth of the region, he added.

“For the first time in half a century, the United States will build a new refinery designed specifically for American shale oil,” said America First’s Chairman and Founder John V Calce, as quoted by Reuters. Despite being a top crude oil producer, the US is dependent on imports because refineries in the country are configured

to process heavy crude oil instead of lighter shale oil.

“In February 2026, America First Refining received a 9-figure investment from a global supermajor at a 10-figure valuation. AFR has also signed a binding 20-year offtake term sheet with the same global supermajor that secures commitments to

Gas supply jitters begin rattling industry pockets

Industry insiders said vehicle manufacturers continue to operate normally while closely monitoring the evolving situation. Tata Motors, one of India’s largest passenger vehicle makers, has not experienced any disruption in production so far, sources said. However, the company is closely tracking developments across both its own facilities and its supplier ecosystem. Sources added that mitigation measures, such as reprioritising the use of available resources across operations, could be activated if required.

“So far, there is no disruption in the production of vehicles. The key raw materials required for manufacturing such as metals and polymers are not affected. Polymers are largely derived from oil and refinery operations continue, so the basic supply chain for vehicle manufacturing remains intact,” said Anurag Singh, advisor at Primus Partners.

However, he added the impact could be felt more by consumers than manufacturers. If compressed natural gas (CNG) availability tightens, vehicle owners, especially taxi operators, may have to temporarily switch to petrol, increasing their running costs.

Rohan Kanwar, vice president and sector head for corporate ratings at Icra, echoed a similar view, noting that automotive original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) are not expecting any immediate disruption to vehicle production. However, he said companies remain cautious about potential indirect effects. Higher fuel prices could affect freight availability and logistics costs, while petrochemical-linked input costs may also rise. Some of these pressures could be partially offset through cost optimisation measures, he added.

Companies manufacturing tower masts or telecom towers that primarily run on LPG have switched to low-flame operations for galvanisation after LPG supplies stopped, said Manoj Kumar Singh, di-

rector general of the Digital Infrastructure Providers Association (DIPA), the industry body representing telecom infrastructure providers. Although steps have been taken to prevent damage to plants and maintain zinc in molten form, the industry body cautioned that tower manufacturing units may have to shut down operations entirely if the LPG disruption persists. This, in turn, would disrupt the supply chain and ongoing as well as planned tower rollout activities by telcos.

With inputs from Reuters

purchase, process, and distribute American-produced energy exclusively sourced from American shale oil,” the company said, without disclosing the supermajor’s name. India’s RIL has not yet issued a statement on the refinery project.

The LPG shortage could also affect catering services that support large corporate campuses, particularly those serving IT companies and multinational firms. HungerBox, a Bengaluru-based food technology platform that manages institutional cafeterias, said operations are currently running normally. The company serves 243 clients, manages 891 cafeterias and works with 886 food partners across 38 cities. Sandipan Mitra, co-founder and chief executive officer of HungerBox, said the LPG shortage has not yet affected its services.

“As of now the LPG shortage has not impacted our services, and operations across corporate and institutional campuses continue to run normally,” Mitra said. “We are closely monitoring the situation, as most kitchens in India’s institutional food service sector still rely on commercial LPG.”

He added that the company has put multiple contingency measures in place in case the situation worsens. These include maintaining priority cylinder inventory buffers, exploring alternative fuel sources, rationalising menus to reduce cooking-intensive items, and adjusting service windows if required. For critical facilities such as hospitals, HungerBox is maintaining dedicated backup fuel arrangements to ensure uninterrupted services.

Three large corporate houses based in Delhi and

Mumbai said they have not yet experienced any impact at their headquarters. One company executive said hybrid work arrangements introduced during the pandemic, such as two days of work-from-home each week, remain in place, but no additional changes have been made in response to the LPG supply concerns.

Amid concerns over a possible LPG shortage, the Indian Railway Catering and

Tourism Corporation has directed catering units at railway stations in its western zone to shift to microwave and induction plates and maintain stocks of ready-to-eat food items for passengers. In a March 10 communication, IRCTC asked operators of food plazas, refreshment rooms and ‘Jan Ahaars’ to use alternative arrangements to maintain seamless catering services for passengers.

Sensex enters correction territory; Nifty on verge

A fall of 10 per cent from recent highs is typically defined as a “correction”, a technical signal used by market participants to mark a phase of weakness.

Investor anxiety was also visible in the India VIX, the volatility gauge, which jumped 11.4 per cent to 21.06. The selloff erased ₹5.14 trillion (trn) in investor wealth in a single session, taking the total market capitalisation (mcap) of BSE-listed companies down to ₹442 trillion. Since the war’s outbreak,

mcap has dipped ₹21.6 trn.

Foreign portfolio investors remained net sellers, offloading about ₹6,267 crore of equities on Wednesday, while domestic institutions bought shares worth ₹4,966 crore. Brent crude traded at \$90.7 a barrel, even as reports suggested the International Energy Agency could release emergency reserves of up to 400 million barrels. For India, heavily dependent on imported oil, higher crude prices raise inflation risks and weigh on growth.

Death with ‘dignity’: SC allows passive euthanasia

“Aims must ensure that such withdrawal or withholding is carried out through a robust palliative and end-of-life care plan which is specifically tailored to manage symptoms without causing any discomfort to the applicant and ensuring that his dignity is preserved to the highest degree,” the Bench said.

Rana, a Ghaziabad native, was pursuing a B Tech degree at Panjab University in 2013 when he fell from the fourth floor of his paying guest accommodation and sustained a brain injury leading to comatose state.

During the hearing, the Bench observed that India lacks a comprehensive statutory framework governing end-of-life care and urged the Union government to consider enacting legislation in this area.

Rana’s family had approached the apex court seeking permission to withdraw life-sustaining treatment in line with the Supreme Court’s 2018 Constitution Bench judgment recognising the legality of passive euthanasia for terminally ill patients. That ruling established guidelines

allowing withdrawal of life support in cases where a patient had issued an advance directive or living will, as well as in situations where no such directive existed.

In 2023, another Constitution Bench revised parts of the 2018 guidelines to simplify the process, introducing timelines for medical boards to make decisions and reducing the role of judicial magistrates.

“Harish Rana, presently aged 32 years, was once a young, bright boy... His brain injury left him in a condition of persistent vegetative state (PVS) with 100 per cent quadriplegia... Medical reports show that his medical condition has not improved in the past 13 years,” the Bench said.

Justice Pardiwala, who authored the main opinion, also acknowledged the devotion of the patient’s parents. “Among the manifold truths about human existence that this case reveals, the most enduring is the resilience of love. In our considered opinion, the greatest tragedy in life is not death but abandonment. Despite the catastrophic tragedy that struck the appellant, his family never left his side. He

has been cared for, protected and cherished every moment. To us, this unwavering vigilance is a testament to the true meaning of love,” he said in the judgment.

The judgment does not fall within the domain of logic and reason alone but lies at the intersection of love, loss, medicine and mercy, Justice Pardiwala said.

Earlier, the Delhi High Court had rejected the family’s request on the ground that Rana was not dependent on mechanical life support and could survive without external assistance. The family subsequently approached the Supreme Court in 2024 but did not obtain relief at that stage. The court had, however, permitted them to return if circumstances warranted, following which the present application was filed last year.

Law experts say the ruling marks an important moment in the practical implementation of the court’s earlier jurisprudence. “Passive euthanasia has been permitted in India for over a decade, but courts have remained cautious due to the lack of clear precedents on its implementation. The Supreme Court’s decision in Harish Rana vs Union of India marks the first practical application of the framework devel-

oped in Aruna Shanbaug (2011) and refined in Common Cause (2018), which recognised the right to die with dignity,” said Biplob Lenin, partner at Cyril Amarchand Mangaldas, adding that the judgment does not alter the existing legal position but clarifies how the framework should operate in practice.

“The ruling may encourage more families of patients in irreversible conditions to seek similar relief. At the same time, the Court has emphasised that such decisions must continue to involve careful medical evaluation and procedural safeguards,” Lenin said, noting that the case also highlights the need for clearer legislation governing end-of-life decisions.

Supriya Majumdar, partner at Elarra Law Offices, said the decision gives formal recognition to passive euthanasia in legitimate cases involving terminally ill patients. She cautioned that the absence of a statutory framework could create risks of coercion in some cases, particularly where families may be burdened by medical costs. “While the court has emphasised strict adherence to the two-tier medical board system, a clear statutory framework is still urgently required,” Majumdar said.

BS SUDOKU

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Solution tomorrow

HOW TO PLAY

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IN BRIEF

TRUMP-EPSTEIN SPOTLIGHT



A new art installation by the anonymous artist collective Secret Handshake appeared on the National Mall in Washington, DC, depicting figures representing US President Donald Trump and the late financier Jeffrey Epstein

PHOTO: REUTERS

US core inflation slowed as expected before war with Iran

Underlying US inflation slowed in February from a month earlier, offering some relief from price pressures before the war with Iran. The consumer price index, excluding food and energy, rose 0.2 per cent from January, according to Bureau of Labor Statistics data out Wednesday. From a year ago, it was unchanged at 2.5 per cent — the slowest pace in nearly five years. The overall metric advanced 0.3 per cent from January and 2.4 per cent from the prior year. The pullback in underlying inflation reflected lower prices for used cars as well as motor vehicle and health insurance. Housing costs — one of the biggest components of the CPI — were tame for a second month. A key metric known as rent of primary residence rose 0.1 per cent, the least in five years.

BLOOMBERG

Amazon to raise record €14.5 billion from euro bond sale

Amazon.com Inc. is raising €14.5 billion (\$16.8 billion) in its euro bond market debut, the biggest ever corporate bond sold in the currency, as Big Tech firms pour money into AI infrastructure. The tech giant boosted the deal from the €10 billion size expected by the market on Tuesday and is offering maturities ranging from two to 38 years, according to people familiar with the matter, who asked not to be identified. So far, investors have placed more than €31.8 billion of orders, marking a record for a corporate debt sale in the currency.

BLOOMBERG

Microsoft backs Anthropic against Pentagon action

Microsoft is throwing its weight behind Anthropic in asking a federal court to block the Trump administration's designation of the artificial intelligence firm as a supply chain risk. Microsoft, in a legal filing, is challenging Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth's action last week to shut Anthropic out of military work by labelling its AI products as a national security threat. The Pentagon took the action against Anthropic after an unusually public dispute over the company's refusal to allow unrestricted military use of its AI model Claude.

AP

Iran warns world: Get ready for oil at \$200/bbl

- >Three merchant ships hit by projectiles in Strait of Hormuz
- >Iranian official says Mojtaba Khamenei lightly injured
- >Operation will continue until we achieve all objectives: Israel

AGENCIES
11 March

Iran's military command said on Wednesday the world should be prepared for oil to hit \$200 a barrel, as three more ships came under attack in the blockaded Gulf.

Iran fired at Israel and targets across the Middle East on Wednesday, demonstrating it can still fight back and disrupt energy supplies despite what the Pentagon has described as the most intense US-Israeli strikes yet. Oil prices that shot up earlier this week have eased and stock markets have rebounded, with investors betting for now that US President Donald Trump will find a quick way to end the war he began alongside Israel nearly two weeks ago. But so far there has been no let-up on the ground, or any sign that ships can safely sail through the Strait of Hormuz, where a fifth of the world's oil has been blockaded behind a narrow channel along the Iranian coast in the worst disruption to energy supplies since the oil shocks of the 1970s.

"Get ready for oil be \$200 a barrel, because the oil price depends on regional security which you have destabilised," Ebrahim Zolfaqari, spokesperson for Iran's military command said in comments addressed to the US. After offices of a bank in Tehran were hit overnight, Zolfaqari also said Iran would respond with attacks on banks that do business with the US or Israel. People across the Middle East should stay 1,000 metres from banks, he added.

In the latest public display of defiance, huge crowds of Iranians took to the streets on Wednesday for funerals for top commanders killed in airstrikes. They carried caskets and brandished flags and portraits of slain Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei and his son and successor, Mojtaba.

An Iranian official told *Reuters* that Mojtaba Khamenei had been lightly injured early in the war, when airstrikes killed his father, mother, wife and a son. He has not appeared in public or issued any direct message since the war began.

The Iranian military said on Tuesday it had launched missiles at a US base in northern Iraq, the US naval headquarters for the Middle East in Bahrain, and at targets in central Israel. Explosions rang out in Bahrain, while in Dubai four people were injured by two drones that crashed near the airport.

Three more merchant ships were struck in the Gulf by unknown projectiles, according to agencies that monitor maritime security, raising the number of ships reportedly hit since the war began to 14.

Crew were evacuated from a Thai-flagged bulk freighter after an explosion caused a fire. A Japan-flagged container ship and a Marshall Islands-flagged bulk carrier also sustained damage.

US and Israeli officials say their aim is to end Iran's ability to project force beyond its borders and destroy its nuclear programme, though they have also invited Iranians to topple the country's clerical rulers.

Israel's Defence Minister Israel Katz said on Wednesday the operation "will continue without any time limit, as long as required, until we achieve all objectives and win the campaign."



The Thailand-flagged cargo ship Mayuree Naree, bound for India, engulfed in black smoke in the Strait of Hormuz, struck by "two projectiles of unknown origin" while sailing through the Strait on Wednesday, causing a fire and damaging the engine room

PHOTO: REUTERS

IEA to release record 400 million barrels from emergency oil reserves

AGENCIES
11 March

The International Energy Agency (IEA) agreed to discharge 400 million barrels from emergency oil reserves, its largest ever release, as governments seek to contain a price spike driven by the Middle East war.

"The oil market challenges we are facing are unprecedented in scale," IEA Executive Director Fatih Birol said Wednesday in a statement. "IEA member countries have responded with an emergency collective action of unprecedented size." The decision was unanimous, Birol said, without specifying the pace, duration and location of the planned fuel releases — details that will be key for energy markets. Japan said earlier it would unilaterally release about 80 million barrels, starting as soon as March 16.

Oil soared to almost \$120 a barrel in London earlier this week as flows through the Persian Gulf's critical Strait of Hormuz remained essentially halted, though futures have since eased — in part on expectations that governments would tap their oil reserves. Prices dipped following Wednesday's announcement, before ticking back up. The most important thing for the stability of energy markets remains the resumption of traffic through the strait, Birol added.

The IEA's move exceeds the 182.7 million barrels that member states ultimately put into the market in 2022 after Russia invaded Ukraine. That action, formally approved at a meeting of the agency's governing board in March of that year, equated to a release of 2 million barrels a day in its initial month, and was subsequently extended and supplemented.

But potential supply losses from this crisis may be much bigger than in 2022. The IEA, which co-ordinates stockpile releases for OECD countries, has said its 32 members hold more than 1.2 billion barrels in public emergency stockpiles, including the largest buffer, the US Strategic Petroleum Reserve. There's a further 600 million barrels of industry stocks under government obligation. These countries are obligated to hold at least 90 days of net oil imports, which can consist of stockpiles maintained exclusively for emergency use or inventories held for commercial purposes, as well as stocks stored under bilateral agreements.

South Korea will release 22.46 million barrels of oil from strategic reserves, joining other IEA members, the country's industry ministry said.

Britain said it would contribute 13.5 million barrels of oil to a coordinated release from strategic reserves, joining other IEA members. "With this action, the UK is playing our part in working with our international allies to address the disruption in oil markets," energy minister Ed Miliband said in a statement.

The IEA has previously helped implement five such interventions: in the buildup to the 1991 Gulf War, after hurricanes Rita and Katrina in 2005, following the outbreak of civil war in Libya in 2011, and twice in 2022 in response to disruptions connected to the Ukraine war.

Shell declares force majeure to clients who buy Qatari LNG

REUTERS
London, 11 March

Shell, the world's largest liquefied natural gas trader, has declared force majeure on LNG cargoes it buys from QatarEnergy and sells to its clients worldwide, three sources told Reuters on Wednesday.

Qatar, the world's second-largest exporter of LNG, announced a production halt at its 77 million tons per annum (mtpa) facility last week and declared force majeure on LNG shipments.

Shell declined to comment.

Other Qatari LNG buyers, including TotalEnergies and some Asian companies, have received force majeure notices from Qatar and told customers they would not be selling them Qatari LNG as long as the facilities remain shut, two other sources said.

A source close to TotalEnergies said the French oil and gas major has not declared force majeure, a notice used to describe events outside a company's control, such as a natural disaster, which usually releases it from contractual obligation without penalty.

Both Shell and TotalEnergies have long-term partnerships with QatarEnergy and are partners in the company's massive North Field expansion project which aims to boost capacity by 2027.

Sources told *Reuters* last week that the force majeure notices sent to clients stated that LNG deliveries for March will not be affected, with the impact being felt as of April.

Japan to release around 80 million barrels from emergency oil stocks

Japan plans to release around 80 million barrels from its private and national oil reserves, the Ministry of Economy, Trade and Industry said on Wednesday, to help calm global oil markets and prevent supply shortages caused by the Iran war. Japan would suffer the greatest impact from the closure of the Strait of Hormuz — the route for about 70 per cent of its oil imports, a METI official told a briefing, as Japan Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi announced the reserves release from March 16, ahead of an expected broader release led by the International Energy Agency (IEA). Should the IEA-led coordinated reserves release be agreed, Japan's planned release would be part of that total, the official said.

AGENCIES

Standard Chartered evacuates staff from offices in Dubai

Standard Chartered has begun evacuating staff from offices in Dubai and told them to work from home, two sources said on Wednesday, as lenders step up precautionary measures following an Iranian warning that Tehran will target US and Israeli banks in the region. Iran will target economic and banking interests linked to the US and Israel in the region, after an attack on an Iranian bank, a spokesperson for Tehran's Khatam al-Anbiya military command headquarters said on Wednesday. All HSBC branches are closed in Qatar until further notice to ensure safety of customers and staff, as per text message to all customers in Qatar. Switzerland has also temporarily closed its Embassy in Iran, as per statement by the country.

AGENCIES

AI incites a new wave of grieving parents fighting for online safety

CECILIA KANG
11 March 11

On a video call with grieving parents two years ago, Megan Garcia shared how she had lost her son, Sewell.

For months, the 14-year-old had compulsively turned to an artificial intelligence (AI) chatbot character created by Character.AI, she said. He later confessed suicidal thoughts to it, after which the bot encouraged him to take his life, she added. Everyone wept. Most of the parents had also lost their children. Except they faulted social media, not specifically AI, for creating dangers.

"There were so many echoes to what we experienced, and we thought, 'When is this ever going to end?'" said Julianna Arnold, who said her 17-year-old daughter, Coco, died in 2022 after meeting a man on Instagram who gave her fentanyl. "We knew then that AI was our issue, too," or years, parents who say they have lost their children to social-media-related harms have fought to draw attention to safety risks for youths online. They have lobbied lawmakers to force apps like Instagram and TikTok to limit features that could heighten depression or bullying or lead to sexual exploitation or drug overdose.

But as technology has raced ahead, a new generation of parents is reeling.

They say they lost their children to suicide after AI chatbots egged them on. In a bittersweet collaboration, the two sets of parents are now combining forces in an attempt to force change.

They are crashing congressional hearings and swarming state legislatures, demanding laws that put better guardrails around both technologies. Dozens of parents have shown up in Los Angeles to draw attention to a landmark social media addiction trial, which seeks to hold tech companies accountable over claims of personal injury. The trial is heading into closing arguments, and a verdict is expected this month. Their aim: to finally push a child safety reckoning for tech giants, much like the one that came for Big Tobacco last century.

"Same problems, just called a different technology," said Arnold, who leads the advocacy group Parents Rise. "But it's happening much faster with AI, and we see that the firms are acting faster to try to get ahead of legislation." Concerns about the effects of tech on youths are mounting globally. In December, Australia barred children under 16 from using social media. Malaysia, Spain and Denmark are considering similar rules.

But the parents face an uphill battle in the US. Dozens of federal bills to regulate social media have failed in the wake of tech lobbying and concerns about limit-



ing the free speech rights of teenagers.

Congressional support to regulate AI has been even weaker. US President Trump has pushed for giving the companies free rein to win a technology race with China and has threatened states that pass AI laws. AI firms and their executives have poured hundreds of millions of dollars into super PACs aimed at electing AI-friendly candidates in November.

Social media and AI firms both say they have added safety features and more

parental controls to their products. Character.AI, which is licensed by Google, introduced age restrictions. Google and Character.AI settled a lawsuit with Garcia and other parents over their children's deaths for undisclosed terms.

"Providing young people with a safe, healthy experience has always been core to our work," José Castañeda, a spokesman for Google, said in a statement. "We're applying that same responsible approach as we develop AI products."

"No one should have to experience the pain these families have felt," said Edward Patterson, a spokesman for Meta, which owns Instagram and Facebook, in a statement. "We will continue listening to parents, working with experts and law enforcement and conducting in-depth research to understand the issues that matter most."

Arnold joined a group of parents who made frequent appearances in Washington, pushing for legislation like the bipartisan Kids Online Safety Act, which would have forced social media companies to design their platforms to be less addictive and harmful. They attended child safety hearings and appeared at news conferences alongside senators to tell their stories.

At one Senate hearing in 2024, Arnold was among more than a dozen parents in the room holding photos of their

deceased children. Mark Zuckerberg, the chief executive of Meta, was pressured into standing and facing the parents to apologise. "I was so angry seeing him face us, but also it felt like things might actually change at that time," Arnold said.

They didn't. The Kids Online Safety Act was passed overwhelmingly in the Senate but failed in the House. In early 2025, Arnold founded Parents Rise with nine other families to also focus on state-level lobbying for child safety.

"In December, the parents became aware of an effort by lawmakers to quash all state efforts to regulate AI. Last year, 38 states enacted 100 AI-related laws, many focused on safety, according to the National Conference of State Legislatures.

They trekked again to Washington to protest outside the National Gallery of Art. They lit up a side of the gallery with a projected message: "Don't Let AI Buy the Government."

Lori Schott, who was at the evening protest, said she had lost her 18-year-old child, Annalee, to suicide in 2020 after she slipped down a rabbit hole of toxic content on Instagram, Snapchat and TikTok. "Annalee grew up in a digital world that had no safety standards, no guardrails, no meaningful oversight, and with AI, that's just accelerating," Schott said.

Arnold and other parents visited the offices of senior lawmakers, including a

meeting with staff for the Senate majority leader, John Thune of South Dakota. They said Thune's office would not say if he supported their cause. Other requests for meetings with lawmakers were denied.

This month, the parents mobilised again, protesting on Capitol Hill to urge lawmakers to adopt stronger measures in a new House draft version of the Kids Online Safety Act. They called for protections including forcing the companies to proactively mitigate the most serious harms they pose to children and to find ways to identify minors who are lying about their age. They have also staked out the Los Angeles courthouse where the landmark trial is underway, the first in a series of cases accusing Meta, YouTube, Snap and TikTok of creating addictive technologies that harm young people.

The firms deny the allegations. But a victory for the plaintiff could result in huge monetary penalties and potential changes to the platforms.

Schott slept in front of the courthouse overnight with other parents to be at the front of the line to get in to hear the head of Instagram, Adam Mosseri, testify on February 11. "It's been a very long three weeks," Ms. Schott said of the trial. "And it's been a very long road — years — before the trial."

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Rethinking FDI

Policy must evolve with changing realities

The Union Cabinet on Tuesday approved changes to rules governing investment from countries sharing land borders with India, otherwise called land-border countries (LBCs). This is a pragmatic decision. However, India's regime of foreign direct investment (FDI) needs to evolve with the changing global economic and geopolitical environment. The Union government had restricted FDI from LBCs in 2020 through Press Note 3. It was then argued that the change attempted to curb opportunistic acquisitions of Indian companies during the crisis caused by the pandemic. As a result, entities from countries that shared land borders with India were allowed to invest only through the government route. One of the reasons for the policy change was to restrict investment from China due to border tensions. Once those tensions eased and the pandemic's impact receded, Indian businesses started demanding a relaxation in restrictions. On its part, the government selectively allowed such investment from LBCs, particularly China. The success in developing an ecosystem for Apple Inc is a notable example.

Given the changes in the economic environment over the past few years, the government has done well to review the policy. Investment from entities with non-controlling LBC beneficial ownership of up to 10 per cent will now be permitted through the automatic route, subject to the applicable sectoral cap and other conditions. Investment will also be subject to reporting relevant information and details to the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade. Further, entities from LBCs wishing to invest in specific sectors — such as capital goods, electronic components, electronic capital goods, and polysilicon — will have their proposals processed and decided within 60 days. The Committee of Secretaries, under the Cabinet secretary, is empowered to revise the list. The guidelines note that the majority holding and control of the investee entity must be with resident Indian citizens or Indian entities controlled by resident Indian citizens.

The revised guidelines should help improve the ease of doing business and attract FDI. From a policy standpoint, it is not easy for any large country to exclude China, the world's second-largest economy, from its broader economic calculations. The decision also comes at an important juncture because India needs to attract FDI. Given the uncertainty in the global financial system, India is facing capital outflows and is running a deficit in the balance of payments. A sustained deficit on the capital account could significantly complicate external-sector management.

However, given the geopolitical sensitivities, there is a need to review the overall FDI regime. There are genuine concerns about China, and several countries across the world are calibrating their relations with the country. In the present context, scrutinising investment coming from specific countries may not be enough. Despite the guidelines on beneficiary ownership, it may not always be possible to determine whether investment coming from, say, Singapore or European countries is not from entities controlled by Chinese capital. Again, one could argue why interests should be protected only against Chinese capital. What India needs is to identify a set of sectors it views as strategic and which a hostile country can use to undermine its interests. In other words, India needs to spot sectors in which it will develop its own capabilities or be in partnership with select trusted countries. The rest can be liberally opened up for foreign investment. India needs large doses of foreign investment to supplement domestic savings to achieve higher growth rates. But in a world that is becoming increasingly unpredictable by the day, it must also safeguard its strategic interests.

Misguided strategy

Andhra's population policy weakens women's freedom

Andhra Pradesh has become the first state to announce a population-management policy to encourage families to have more children. The state plans to reverse the age-old “*Hum Do, Hamare Do*” family-planning campaign, which helped reduce the national total fertility rate (TFR) to about 2 from 3.2 in 2000, by offering an incentive of ₹25,000 to couples that have a second or third child and subsidising in vitro fertilisation (IVF) treatment. This payout is driven by anxieties that the state's TFR has fallen to 1.5, significantly below the replacement level of 2.1. The apprehension is that decelerating population growth could impact the state's representation in Parliament ahead of a potential delimitation exercise as well as its access to funding under Finance Commission allocations linked to each state's population. These are not invalid concerns, and the progressive southern states have all expressed similar reservations. However, this approach is inappropriate.

For one, it reflects narrow ethnocentricity, which is out of sync with a country as integrated as India. This assumption would make implementing the policy problematic. If “identity” is defined by geographical boundaries, then Andhra Pradesh has significant cohorts of settlers from other parts of India. Would a Punjabi or Bengali domiciled in the state for decades be eligible for the subsidy? Though not explicitly stated, the policy undoubtedly aims to boost the Telugu population. However, large numbers of Telugu people inhabit other states, with Telangana, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, and Maharashtra being the most prominent. Would the policy address their concerns? The nativist focus of the policy, a grim emulation of practices increasingly followed in the United States and Europe, sets a poor precedent for states with similar TFR records. It overlooks the fact that as part of India, the state can augment talent and skills from anywhere in the country. Migration has been the backbone of economic growth. The country's most dynamic cities — Kolkata in the past, or Mumbai, Bengaluru, Gurugram, or Hyderabad today — are the most cosmopolitan, having been built on the toils of blue- and white-collar migrants.

The policy also runs the risk of creating adverse outcomes. The first concerns the quality of human capital. Given that India's and Andhra Pradesh's falling TFR is the result of improved education and incomes, most of the subsidy could well be accessed by poorer families with less wherewithal to sustain larger families. The state has recognised this issue with generous add-ons, such as a ₹1,000 monthly nutrition support for the third child up to five years and free education in government institutions for the second and third child up to the age of 18 years. But these in no way cover the full cost of raising a child in optimum conditions. So far, no country that has offered similar incentives has managed to reverse falling TFRs. The second perverse consequence concerns women's rights. Falling TFRs typically reflect improvement in women's education and, to an extent, their growing agency within society. Smaller families reduce the childcare burden for women and enable them to explore opportunities in education or professional careers. This is no small achievement. In a patriarchal country like India, offering incentives to have more children could narrow women's freedom of choice and reverse decades of hard-won social progress.



ILLUSTRATION: BINAY SINHA

A tilted balance

The Finance Commission ignores Union govt's fiscal laxity while questioning state profligacy

Given the asymmetric distribution in the assignment of revenue and expenditure powers between the Union and the states, the founding fathers of the Constitution provided for the appointment of Finance Commissions every five years to determine fiscal transfers through tax devolution and grants-in-aid to the states. The transfers are to be determined by assessing the revenue-raising capacities and expenditure needs arising from the assignments of the Union and the states. In making these assessments, judgments are unavoidable.

As Justice P V Rajamannar, the chairman of the Fourth Finance Commission, stated, the assessment is a “...gamble on the personal views of five persons, or a majority of them.” Nevertheless, in exercising these judgements, they are expected to follow (i) the assignment system detailed in the Seventh Schedule; (ii) concerns about macroeconomic stability and the developmental needs of the Union and individual states; and (iii) clarity in functional domains. As the Commission is supposed to be an arbiter and a semi-judicial expert body, it is required to be impartial.

The Sixteenth Finance Commission states that its approach was to consider the “available” and “required” revenue resources with the Union and the states to bridge the gap and to estimate additional revenue effort and expenditure economy at both levels of government to “rework the available” and “required” resources, repeating the exercise until the acceptable balance is achieved. The shares in the divisible pool are determined in line with this balance (p.18).

While making the assessment of Union government finances, the Commission is quite appreciative of the restraint exercised by the Union government during the pandemic and the reduction in deficits and debt since the spike that took place in the pandemic year. However, it simply ignores the fact that, except in 2007-08, in none of the years since the FRBM Act was adopted in August, 2003 has the Union government complied with the deficit and debt targets set by successive Finance Commissions, on one pretext or another.

POLICY
PILLARS
M GOVINDA RAO

Ironically, the target itself should have been revised downwards as the household sector's financial savings, which determines the borrowing space, have steadily declined from 10 per cent in 2002-03, when the Twelfth Finance Commission determined the target, to 7.4 per cent in 2011-12 and further to 5.1 per cent in 2023-24. The Union government has been shifting goalposts and changing definitions or offering explanations for the slippages. With the aggregate fiscal deficit substantially exceeding the available borrowing space, the corporate sector is faced with an elevated cost of borrowing, vitiating the investment climate, or is forced to seek external funds to finance investments.

Even in making the assessments, the tilt comes out clearly. The Commission rightly flags the problems of the discoms and the profligacy arising from the proliferation of subsidies and transfers at the state level, but looks the other way when it comes to even greater largesse by the Union government.

Apart from the explicit subsidies given in the Budget, the Union government has approved multiple, massive, multi-year bailout packages for BSNL and MTNL, involving ₹2.3 trillion in combined relief packages (2019, 2022, 2023), 4G/5G spectrum allocation, and debt restructuring.

Under the Rozgar Mela initiated by the Prime Minister on October 22, 2022, aimed at recruiting one million personnel across Union government ministries and departments in mission mode, over 1.1 million appointment letters have already been issued.

Under the PM-KISAN scheme launched in February 2019 to provide income support to landholding farmer families across India, over ₹4.09 trillion has been disbursed to more than 110 million farmers until November 2025. Are these not transfers initiated for political reasons? These are only some examples. The Commission simply chose to ignore them.

The biggest twist in the tale is the Commission's treatment of the Centrally Sponsored Schemes (CSS) and their financing through cesses and surcharges. The Commission states that these schemes account for 50 per cent of the transfers from the Union to the

The return of the nativists

The most potent signs of the integration of India's people emerged in the first days of the Covid-19 lockdown six years ago. As shops and factories downed shutters and construction sites froze, tens of thousands of workers and their families took to the roads. Unceremoniously evicted by employers and landlords, they were forced to make their way home from the boom towns of the south and west — on foot, bicycles, bullock carts (the lucky ones by lorry or trains) — to Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Rajasthan and West Bengal.

The Covid-19 exodus demonstrated the cynically utilitarian treatment by local residents towards people from other Indian states who play a vital role in sustaining economies far away from their homelands. Eight years earlier, the precarious state of internal migrants was underlined as thousands of northeastern migrants fled Bengaluru, Chennai and Pune on unfounded rumours of violence against their communities linked to communal clashes in Assam. Given the role they play in these cities' thriving retail and services business, the Karnataka government moved swiftly to allay their fears and assure them protection. No similar crisis has occurred since.

Despite clear evidence of the dynamism that migrants have brought to India's most prosperous states, parochialism is gaining traction throughout India. The frequent attacks on Muslims as outsiders or infiltrators are one outward manifestation of the threat perception many Indians have harboured for decades. But the killing of a young man of Tripura origin by local thugs on suspicion of being Chinese in Uttarakhand last year underlines the depth of the paradox. As emerging pockets of prosperity stoke the demand for the varied skills and abilities of citizens around the country, Indians are increasingly

seeing other Indians as aliens.

Trust the politicians to pick up on an easy issue to enhance their appeal by promoting policies designed to focus on parochial values. The most enticing option here has been to reserve low-level jobs for locals hired by the private sector. Andhra Pradesh (2019), Haryana (2020) and Karnataka (2024) went down this route. All of them have foundered.

The Andhra Bill, which aimed to reserve 75 per cent of jobs in industrial units, factories and joint ventures for local candidates, has been stalled after a challenge in the High Court indicated that the law could be unconstitutional. The Haryana Bill was transparent in its intent. The Statement of Objects and Reasons to the Bill cited the influx of migrants in the state competing for low-paid jobs. The law met a more decisive outcome in 2023, after a bench of the Punjab and Haryana High Court quashed it as unconstitutional (the state has since appealed to the Supreme Court). Specifically, the high court said, the law violated Article 14 (the right to equality) and Article 19 (freedom of trade and commerce).

Significantly, the Punjab and Haryana High Court made a pointed observation: That the law created discriminatory artificial divisions among citizens. Not that this finding of a northern higher court deterred the Karnataka government down south. In 2024, the state government proposed a law to reserve 50 per cent of management and 75 per cent of non-management roles for locals. This announcement caused such a fierce backlash from industry — especially the IT and ITes industry that put Bengaluru on the world map — that it has been in limbo ever since.

Whatever the impediments, as Europe and the United States have demonstrated, parochialism has an enduring appeal, never more so than when good jobs are hard to come by. Back in 2012, undivided

SWOT
KANIKA DATTA

SHYAM SARAN

In 1937, the American journalist Edgar Snow published *Red Star Over China*, a book that introduced Mao Zedong to the world as a romantic, agrarian reformer and a charismatic figure leading a grass-roots movement for China's liberation from a feudal and corrupt regime of the Guomindang or the KMT party headed by General Chiang Kai-shek. For nearly a century, Snow's narrative served as the foundation for the Western understanding of the Chinese Revolution. With his latest work, *Red Dawn Over China*, Frank Dikötter offers a persuasive counter-nar-

rative that draws from his meticulous research into the voluminous Chinese Communist Party (CCP) archives, supplemented by Russian archives. It is the approach with which one is familiar in Mr Dikötter's earlier works, comprising *The Tragedy of Liberation, 1945-57*, *Mao's Great Famine, 1958-62*, and *The Cultural Revolution, 1962-76*. The latest history reverses the chronology to take us back to the period 1911-45, which saw the birth of the CCP in 1921 in Shanghai and its subsequent transformation into a revolutionary party, leading up to its final victory in the civil war with the KMT in 1949.

The four histories together offer a comprehensive, granular and revisionist history of the Communist revolution from its early beginnings to the end of the Cultural Revolution in 1976.

What are the main takeaways from Mr Dikötter's latest book?

One, he has detailed how the birth of CCP, its ideological identity, its political

tactics and military strategy, were all carefully instilled among the CCP leaders and cadres by a succession of Soviet handlers. These were drawn from Soviet experience of using ruthless violence, adopting a culture of secrecy and conspiratorial imaginings, conducting constant and bloody purges and offering a one-party Leninist state as an institutional model. At no time during this period did the CCP have a significant membership or popular following. Its tactics of perpetrating endless violence and recourse to extortion from a countryside already ravaged by war belies its image as a people's movement. This enables us to understand the dynamics of current Chinese politics and its institutional underpinnings. The notion that under Mao the CCP was mostly an indigenous movement needs to be nuanced. There were disagreements between the CCP leaders and their Soviet advisors but in most cases, the Soviets were able to impose their own assess-

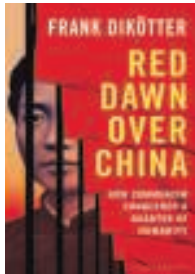
ments of the situation and the tactics to be followed. Even after the ideological break with the Soviet Union from 1958 onwards, the Soviet imprint on the CCP remained and endures to this day.

Two, Mr Dikötter dispels the lingering view of the CCP as an important component of the anti-Japanese coalition in the Pacific war. He produces a wealth of archival evidence to show how the CCP mostly sat out the war and conserved its limited military capacity, while letting the Japanese progressively decimate the KMT. The US belief that the CCP ought to be supported because it was a nationalist more than a communist entity is thoroughly debunked in the book.

Three, the CCP and its People's Army was able to prevail over the KMT, thanks to the material and military support provided by the Soviet Union after the defeat of Japan in 1945. The Soviet Union took over the whole of Manchuria from Japan's Kwantung Army and made it available to the revolutionary army as a

base from which to attack the KMT. The massive volume of weapons surrendered by the Japanese was handed over to the CCP and this support proved crucial in the CCP's eventual takeover of Beijing and its victory over the rest of the Chinese landmass.

The story is repeated in Xinjiang where the Soviets helped by first taking it over and then handing over control to the CCP. In contrast, US and Western assistance and support to the KMT was hesitant and niggardly, influenced by Chiang Kaishek's reputation as being corrupt and authoritarian. Mr Dikötter has used Chiang's dairies to throw light on the complex set of challenges he had to deal with during the 1945-49 civil war. Some historical accounts draw attention to the fact that Stalin was also extending support to Chiang Kai-shek and may have preferred a weak KMT-CCP coalition to rule over post-war China. The present volume shows that the Soviet support to



Red Dawn Over China: How Communism Conquered a Quarter of Humanity by Frank Dikötter Published by Bloomsbury 384 pages ₹799

Chiang was tactical while the objective all along was to ensure that the CCP prevailed in the civil war.

The establishment of the People's Republic of China may have initially created the expectation of a government of social reformers and gradual change. The CCP moved swiftly to consolidate its power by dismantling virtually all vestiges of the old order. A one-party Leninist state on the Soviet model replaced the old order within a short span of time, validating the view that totalitarianism is an inherent feature of such a state. There may be adaptations in response to changing domestic and external challenges but whenever power of the party is threatened, the default option is invariably the ruthless imposition of control. We are seeing this play out in the current power play in China.

The reviewer is a former foreign secretary

Sebi chief urges stricter valuation rigour for AIFs as IPO exits rise

KHUSHBOO TIWARI Mumbai, 11 March

Tuhin Kanta Pandey, chairman of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi), on Wednesday called for greater discipline in valuations by alternative investment funds (AIFs), as a growing number of their portfolio companies prepare to tap public markets.

Speaking at the IVCA (Indian Venture and Alternate Capital Association) Conclave 2026, Pandey said credibility in the AIF ecosystem begins with robust valuation practices, especially since many funds invest in early-stage startups and illiquid assets.

“Weak or opaque valuations erode confidence. When investee companies move towards public markets, valuation concerns can distort price discovery and weaken trust. Therefore, fair valuation matters,” he said.

His remarks come amid a steady pipeline of private equity (PE)-backed companies heading for initial public offerings (IPOs). According to EY, PE-backed exits through public markets totalled 42 deals worth \$3.89 billion in 2025. Major exits included Groww parent Billionbrains Garage Ventures, Urban Company, Tata Capital, Pine Labs, Hexaware Technologies, Lenskart Solutions, and Tanneco Clean Air India.

Pandey also emphasised the role of AIFs in strengthening corporate governance standards at companies that may eventually list on stock exchanges.

“As businesses move towards public

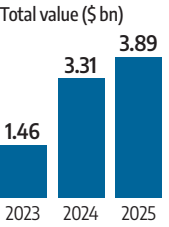


Top PE-backed IPO exits in 2025

Company/Asset	Seller(s)	Amt (\$ mn)	Deal stake (%)
Hexaware Technologies	Carlyle	1,012	20
Groww	Peak XV, Tiger Global & others	626	9
Tanneco Clean Air India	Apollo Global	404	22
Lenskart	SoftBank, Temasek & others	340	4
Dr. Agarwal's Health Care	Temasek, TPG	251	17
Urban Company	Accel, Bessemer India & others	162	10
Tata Capital	IFC	133	1
Pine Labs	Peak XV, Actis, Temasek & others	119	4
Schloss Bangalore	Brookfield & others	117	7
JSW Cement	Apollo	108	27

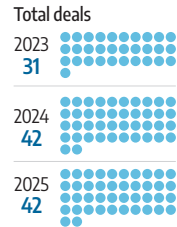
Source: EY analysis of VCCEdge data

Cashing out



Source: EY Analysis of VCCEdge data

PE-backed IPO exits

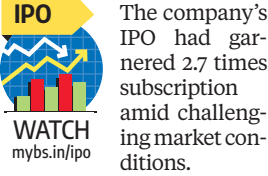


negotiable standards,” Pandey said. The number of accredited investors has risen to 2,181 as of February 2026, up from 649 in May 2025, following Sebi’s simplification of the accreditation process. The regulator is also working to further ease the framework and accel-

erate approval timelines. Pandey said Sebi is exploring a ‘lodge and launch’ model for certain AIF schemes, under which due diligence certificates issued by merchant bankers could be relied upon. However, for accredited investor-only schemes, AIF managers would remain responsible for disclosures and due diligence. Such a model could accelerate fund launches and enable faster mobilisation of private capital, he said. He also urged AIFs to channel more capital into startups and sectors requiring long-term investment. “India needs long-term capital for healthcare, education, climate transition, sustainable infrastructure, and other priority sectors. AIFs can help channel domestic and global capital to these areas,” Pandey said.

Sedemac surges 7.4% on debut amid weak mkts

Shares of Sedemac Mechatronics rose 7.4 per cent during their trading debut on Wednesday. After hitting a high of ₹1,613, the stock settled at ₹1,452, up ₹100, or 7.4 per cent, over its issue price of ₹1,352.



The company’s IPO had garnered 2.7 times subscription amid challenging market conditions. Sedemac’s ₹1,087-crore IPO is entirely an offer for sale (OFS). At the last close, the company was valued at ₹6,412 crore.

BS REPORTER

Flipkart set to pitch for IPO in April

Online retailer Flipkart Internet is set to start the formal process for banks to pitch for work on its potential initial public offering (IPO) as soon as next month, according to sources. The Walmart-backed e-commerce company has already held informal talks with investors and bankers to gauge appetite for a listing in Mumbai. Sources said an IPO could take place later this year or early 2027. Deliberations are at an early stage and details such as timing may change, the people said. A Flipkart representative didn’t respond to a request for comment.

BLOOMBERG

‘Risk-reward ratio has turned favourable for long-term investors’

Indian equities can attract their share of emerging market flows without requiring foreign investors to “sell India” for markets like China — offering a strategic hedge to the artificial intelligence (AI) theme amid global volatility. **Rahul Singh**, chief investment officer, equities, at Tata Asset Management, discusses this and other matters with **Puneet Wadhwa** in an email interview. Edited excerpts:

Is this a good time to invest in markets?

■ While we are not yet at rock-bottom levels that justify a maximum equity allocation, the thematic and “narrative” froth in a lot of sectors has receded. India’s valuation premium over other emerging markets has also moderated significantly dropping from a high of 90 per cent to approximately 50 per cent now. At this level, the market can attract its fair share of emerging market flows without requiring foreign investors to sell India to buy other markets like China, especially if they want a hedge to the AI theme.

Are there any pockets for investment at current levels?

■ While some midcap pockets still command high prices, the overall risk-reward ratio has turned more favourable for long-term investors, as the disconnect between price and fundamentals begins to narrow across several key industrial sectors.

What are your learnings from 2025?

■ A primary learning from 2025 was the global dominance of the hardware-led AI super-cycle. India did not participate in the GPU and chip manufacturing phase leading to significant capital migration toward specialised global tech hubs. A major hit was on the resilience of the IT sector earnings. While major upgrades were absent, the cessation of downward revisions ensured IT stopped being a drag on overall corporate profitability. The biggest miss was the slower-

than-anticipated growth recovery. Nifty 50 earnings per share (EPS) growth lingered near 3 per cent for much of the year before its recent move toward the 8 per cent range. This lag highlighted the delay in domestic demand recovery despite strong government capital expenditure and stabilising global macro conditions through the year. The outlook for earnings next year is better, led by BFSI, consumption, and commodities.

Do you plan to change your strategy?

■ The strategy for the next year is shifting toward sectors with a probable growth visibility such as banking, consumer, resources and manufacturing. [We] remain underweight on traditional IT services, as the recovery there is expected to be gradual rather than sharp. For the digital-themed portfolios, we are diversifying away from legacy IT services. Focusing on internal consumption and credit growth can provide a cushion against shifting global trade dynamics.

Would you suggest a more passive investing strategy now?

■ The current landscape suggests that

active stock-specific management is far more appropriate than a purely passive approach. For instance, the defence sector has matured into a stock-specific market rather than a broad thematic play where every company rises together. In the IT sector, the transition from legacy models to AI-driven service-led spend is a complex and painful process. Navigating this requires an active ability to identify specific providers who can successfully modernise complex legacy systems to gain a competitive advantage. Passive strategies, on the other hand, may inadvertently capture laggards struggling with this technological shift.

Have corporate earnings reached a stage where foreign investors sit up and take notice?

■ Corporate earnings are reaching a critical pivot point. Nifty 50 EPS growth is projected to climb from 3 per cent last year to roughly 8 per cent this year with a further jump to 15 per cent expected by FY27. This revival, combined with the cooling of India’s valuation premium, makes the market more attractive to foreign institutional investors who were previously deterred by high entry costs.

While India may not receive a disproportionate share of emerging market flows immediately, the decline in selling intensity is a positive sign.

The combination of domestic demand revival and a stable currency suggests a highly competitive performance against Asian peers. India remains a structural growth story, and the earnings trajectory is finally aligning with these long-term expectations.



Operational hurdles in KYC, high costs deter int’l investors in GIFT City

IFSCA considering video KYC for foreign nationals

KHUSHBOO TIWARI Mumbai, 11 March

High costs and operational challenges in the know-your-customer (KYC) process have limited fund management entities (FMEs) at Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City) from onboarding overseas investors, often restricting their offerings to offshore family offices and institutional investors, fund managers said.

They said the requirement for physical attestation of documents adds to time and cost, making it difficult to onboard individual clients.

Sources said the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA), the unified regulator for GIFT-IFSC, has formed a committee and received representations from FMEs to resolve the challenges. Fund managers have sought regulatory relaxations such as recognising prior KYC conducted by regional distributors, expanding the presence of KYC registration agencies (KRAs), and introducing greater flexibility in the KYC framework, which currently places the responsibility on FMEs.

“The responsibility of completing the KYC falls on the FMEs. A more practical approach would be to recognise jurisdictions with strong regulatory controls, and impose additional checks only for investors from jurisdictions where such safeguards are weaker,” said a senior official at an FME.

KYC verification requirements vary depending on the investor’s jurisdiction. At present, there is one KRA in the GIFT-IFSC.

“For non-resident Indians (NRIs) and foreign investors, physical original application along with supporting documents is required. They (foreign investors/NRIs) need to courier the physical applica-



Obstacles in the way

- Regulatory ambiguity across required documents makes FMEs cautious in outreach
- Jurisdiction-specific compliances also a problem
- Physical attestation of documents increases time and expense for foreign investors
- Video KYC for NRIs allowed, but challenges persist for foreign nationals
- Most overseas inflows still from family offices and institutions

tion, which adds a lot of costs for the investor. Second, the attestation has to be from the officials in the respective jurisdictions depending on the type of investor, adding up to the operational challenges,” said Jay Kothari, lead investment strategist and head of international business at DSP Mutual Fund. Kothari added that even in case of NRIs based in the UAE, Singapore, or Hong Kong, the money raised has to be routed through a registered distributor there — unless the investor has directly reached out to the FMEs which can be accommodated via reverse solicitation.

“This clarity is not there in every jurisdiction, making FMEs very cautious of how they approach,” he added. DSP is one of the largest CAT-3 AIF (alternative investment

fund) managers within the GIFT-IFSC with assets of around \$1 billion raised from overseas institutions.

Another fund manager noted that in global markets, a significant portion of retail investments happens through platforms that host multiple mutual funds and similar investment products.

“These platforms onboard both funds and investors. Investors invest through the platform, which aggregates and sends trades to the funds. A similar platform-based mechanism should be available in GIFT City,” the person said, adding that conducting separate KYCs for multiple jurisdictions from GIFT City is operationally complex. Accepting KYCs completed by distributors in those jurisdictions could ease the process, he added. As of December 2025, there were 202 FMEs operating in GIFT City with over 313 schemes launched. While fundraises have crossed \$17.34 billion, total commitments have exceeded \$32 billion.

However, industry participants said most overseas inflows — cumulative data for which is not publicly available — have largely come from family offices and institutional investors.

IFSCA allowed retail schemes from the financial hub last year. While the regulator also enabled video KYC for NRIs, fund managers said the facility does not eliminate the requirement to submit physical application forms.

“It is not applicable to all investment products,” an industry official said.

Sources added that the IFSCA is working to extend the video KYC framework for foreign nationals also. Alongside, it has allowed acceptance of KYCs of Indians completed by the KRAs.

Email queries to IFSCA remained unanswered till the time of going to press.

Sebi’s income rose 31% in FY25

CAG flags internal control issues in report

KHUSHBOO TIWARI Mumbai, 11 March

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) reported a total income of ₹2,713 crore in 2024-25 (FY25), up 31 per cent from ₹2,075 crore recorded in FY24, according to the latest audited annual accounts.

The market regulator’s corpus or the capital fund also expanded to ₹7,235 crore, surging by nearly 30 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y).

The settlement and compounding charges also saw a steep rise, growing from ₹104

crore to ₹815 crore in FY25. Under Sebi’s settlement framework, entities facing enforcement proceedings may resolve cases without admission of guilt by paying a settlement amount.

Further, the regulator’s investment portfolio also expanded during the year. Investments included ₹2,857 crore in government securities, ₹2,215 crore in deposits with scheduled banks, and ₹30 crore invested in the National Centre for Financial Education. In its audit report, the

Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG) noted certain internal control issues, such as balances of the head office and branches not agreeing, indicating that transactions were not completely accounted for.

“There were unreconciled differences in the lease deposits as reflected on liability side of the financial statements and lease deposit liability calculated based on executed lease agreements,” the report said.

It added that in the physical verification report, certain assets were marked ‘disposed of’ but were not removed or discarded from the books.

THE COMPASS

Petchem, power plants to face brunt of gas allocation

DEVANGSHU DATTA

The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas this week issued a notification addressing gas allocation, given likely shortages due to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz amid the ongoing conflict in West Asia. The order commits 100 per cent allocation of average gas consumption over the past six months for Priority Sector I which includes domestic piped natural gas (PNG), compressed natural gas (CNG) for transport, liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) production and pipeline operations.

Fertiliser plants will receive 70 per cent of the past six months’ average. Supply to tea industries, manufacturing and other industrial consumers supplied through the national grid will be at 80 per cent. Supply to industrial and commercial consumers through city gas distributors (CGDs) will be at 80 per cent. The ration-

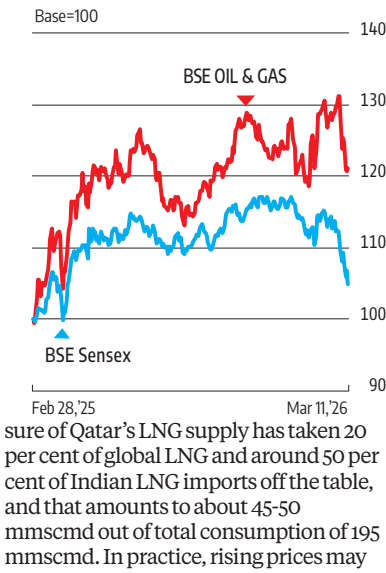
ing could lead to reduced supply (or full curtailment) to petrochemical facilities, power plants and refineries (which may receive 65 per cent allocation). No diversion or reselling will be allowed. Overall CGD consumption, including for industrial and commercial sectors in the third quarter of 2025-26 (Q3FY26) was 45 million metric standard cubic metres per day (mmscmd). Of this, households and CNG consumption would be around 35 mmscmd, which is currently unaffected. Fertilisers consumed 57 mmscmd on average over Q2 and Q3, and 17 mmscmd could be reduced. Other industrial sector consumption over Q2 and Q3 was 43 mmscmd and 8.6 mmscmd of this could be reduced. Refineries consumed 15.5 mmscmd in the past few quarters and 5.5 mmscmd could be curtailed.

These calculations are ballpark in the absence of more details. But the rough

estimates imply this order is braced for up to 30-35 per cent cutback in supply (around 55-60 mmscmd). Petrochemicals (petchem) and power plants will be taking the biggest hits. CGD players will cut back 20 per cent supply to industrial and commercial consumers which consume roughly a third of CGD. The reallocation of high pressure, high temperature (HPHT) gas may also occur.

The calendar year 2025 (CY25) data indicated up to 70 per cent of India’s LNG imports (63 mmscmd) came through the Strait of Hormuz from Qatar, the United Arab Emirates and Oman. GAIL has done a 1.74 million-tonne US LNG volume swap for West Asia which implies that its transmission segment’s dependency on Hormuz is around 30 per cent.

This order allows for the contingency that the Hormuz supply will be unavailable indefinitely. The force majeure clo-



curtail demand to some extent also.

The gazette notification deals with allocation of domestic and new well gas and the pricing and availability of imported LNG may be a major concern. The fertiliser industry may be hard-hit and also petchem which affects ONGC, GAIL Pata (petchem facility), Reliance O2C among others. Gas-fuelled power plants are already operating at very low capacity. Refineries may have to curtail production if they get only 65 per cent of normal consumption. Among CGD players, Gujarat Gas which sees around 50 per cent of volumes offtake from industrial and commercial players will be more affected than Mahanagar Gas and Indraprastha Gas which only have mid-teens exposure to industry and commercial. But all three CGD players would suffer some impact. Refiners may seek to switch to alternates like fuel oil which usually trends cheaper than gas so earnings impact may be relatively low. However, all fossil fuels are witnessing price spikes. There may also be environmental concerns and associated costs since fuel oil is much “dirtier” than

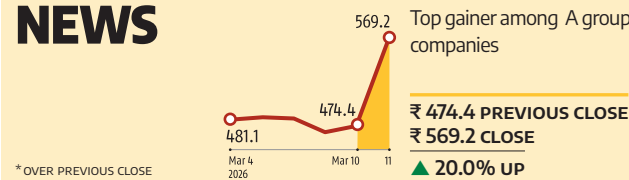
gas. Petchem has been a loss-making segment for a while due to poor spreads and supply curtailment may just make a bad situation worse. Gail’s Pata plant (unlisted subsidiary) relies completely on Qatar and this could lead to a shutdown.

Rising costs and rupee depreciation will lead to margin compression for all players and lower volumes would hurt Gail and Petronet especially. Petronet’s Dahej terminal has over 75 per cent exposure to Hormuz. Kochi and Chhara terminals are also 100 per cent dependent on the gas from West Asia. Mundra (88 per cent), Dhamra (65 per cent) and Ennore (62 per cent) terminals also have high exposures while Hazira (25 per cent) and Dabhol (zero exposure) source more from US, Russia and Australia. Petronet has issued force majeure notices to GAIL, Indian Oil Corporation and BPCL. Gujarat Gas has also issued force majeure notices to industrial customers.

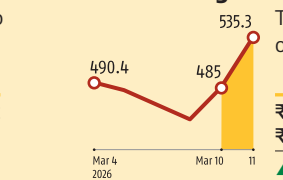
More clarity is dependent on the duration of the Iran war, the Strait’s reopening and resumption of Qatar’s LNG exports.

IN THE NEWS

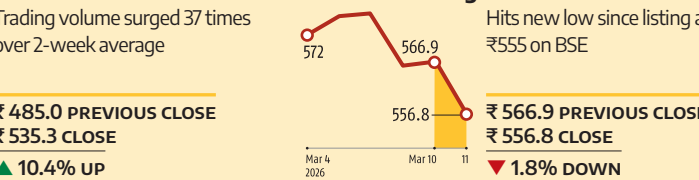
■ Adani Total Gas



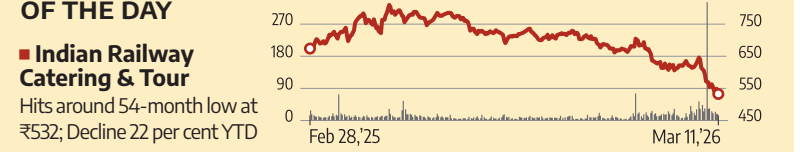
■ TTK Prestige



■ Tata Technologies



STOCK OF THE DAY



NIFTY 50

Company	Close (₹ 11 Mar '24)	% Chg	Wt	PE	Std	Company	Close (₹ 11 Mar '24)	% Chg	Wt	PE	Std
Adani Enter	1974.7	-1.1	0.5	68.7	97.7	JSW Steel	1178.8	-2.9	1.4	36.7	40.0
Adani Ports	1410.8	-0.9	2.5	57.1	163.3	Kotak Mah Bank	383.2	-2.2	2.5	20.3	28.2
Apollo Hosp	7840.0	-1.0	0.7	68.8	76.1	L & T	383.0	-1.8	2.8	24.6	25.6
Asian Paints	2323.0	-2.1	0.9	52.4	53.3	Mah & Mah	316.8	-3.8	1.4	24.6	25.6
Axis Bank	1258.5	-4.5	3.2	14.9	15.9	Maruti Suzuki	13497.0	-2.7	1.6	28.4	29.2
Bajaj Auto	9327.5	-2.9	1.4	29.2	24.6	Manulife India	1032.2	-1.0	0.7	68.7	142.8
Bajaj Fin	893.7	-4.9	2.2	30.5	34.6	Nestle India	1233.7	-0.6	0.8	76.1	74.8
Bajaj Finserv	1795.1	-3.0	1.0	28.9	20.9	NTPC	373.9	-1.6	1.5	15.2	18.2
Bharti Airtel	484.1	-2.0	1.4	55.6	55.6	ONGC	270.8	-0.6	1.2	9.0	10.4
Birla Soft	1807.3	-2.3	4.3	33.6	47.1	Power Grid	298.8	-0.1	1.2	17.9	17.7
Cipla	1329.5	-0.3	0.7	22.6	23.4	Reliance Ind	1390.2	-1.3	8.4	24.8	47.1
Coal India	446.8	-0.7	0.9	9.2	9.2	SBI	1091.1	-1.9	4.0	12.4	13.3
Crompton	825.5	-0.8	1.9	23.8	23.8	Shriram Finance	1031.7	-2.9	1.3	21.2	21.3
Eicher Motor	7253.5	-0.9	0.6	40.0	40.0	Sun Pharma	1249.9	-1.9	2.2	17.4	18.3
Eternal	232.8	-1.2	1.9	93.25	85.4	Tata Consumer P	1073.4	-2.4	0.6	73.3	69.8
Grasim Ind	2735.6	-0.3	0.9	39.4	48.25	Tata Steel	194.7	-0.1	1.4	24.8	15.5
HCL Techno	1359.3	-0.8	1.3	21.3	29.9	TCS	264.9	-1.8	1.8	76.1	100.0
HDFC Bank	384.0	-1.8	11.3	17.2	17.6	Tata Sports PV	335.4	-2.9	0.6	20.9	22.1
HDFC Sd Life	649.1	-0.2	0.6	74.0	74.0	Tata Tea	110.0	-0.1	0.2	17.4	18.3
HUL	1276.4	-0.9	4.8	17.8	18.3	Titan Company	432.9	-1.2	1.8	73.3	69.8
HUL	216.4	-1.3	1.7	46.5	47.5	Tech Mahindra	133.4	-0.2	0.7	27.2	31.1
ICI(Bank)	1294.3	-1.3	8.2	17.5	18.9	Titanium	410.3	-1.5	1.5	75.3	82.1
Infosys	1276.3	-1.5	4.0	17.8	18.9	Trent	362.4	-2.4	0.7	17.8	68.5
Indraprastha	1276.3	-1.5	4.0	17.8	18.9	UltraTech	1146.0	-1.6	1.2	43.5	44.7
ITC	389.0	0.0	3.4	18.8	19.2	Wipro	202.2	-0.6	0.5	16.0	17.6
JS Financial	238.7	1.1	0.7	95.9	27.0	Nifty50	23866.3	-1.5	100.0	22.7	27.3

BSE SENSEX

Company	Close (₹ 11 Mar '24)	% Chg	Wt	PE	Std	Company	Close (₹ 11 Mar '24)	% Chg	Wt	PE	Std
Adani Ports	1410.8	-0.9	1.1	25.7	163.3	L & T	383.0	-1.0	5.6	30.6	46.7
Asian Paints	2323.0	-2.1	0.9	52.4	53.3	Mah & Mah	316.8	-3.8	1.4	24.6	25.6
Bajaj Fin	893.7	-4.9	2.7	30.5	34.6	Manulife India	1032.2	-1.0	0.7	68.7	142.8
Bajaj Finserv	1795.1	-3.0	1.3	28.9	20.9	Power Grid	298.8	-0.1	1.4	17.9	17.7
Bharti Airtel	484.1	-2.0	1.7	55.6	55.6	Reliance Ind	1390.2	-1.3	8.4	24.8	47.1
Eternal	232.8	-1.2	2.4	93.25	85.4	Sun Pharma	1249.9	-1.9	2.2	17.4	18.3
HCL Techno	1359.3	-0.8	1.5	21.3	29.9	Tata Consumer P	1073.4	-2.4	0.6	73.3	69.8
HDFC Bank	384.0	-1.8	13.6	17.2	17.6	Tata Steel	194.7	-0.1	1.4	24.8	15.5
HUL	1276.4	-0.9	4.8	17.8	18.3	TCS	264.9	-1.8	1.8	76.1	100.0
ICI(Bank)	1294.3	-1.3	8.2	17.5	18.9	Tata Sports PV	335.4	-2.9	0.6	20.9	22.1
Infosys	1276.3	-1.5	4.0	17.8	18.9	Titan Company	432.9	-1.2	1.8	73.3	69.8
Indraprastha	1276.3	-1.5	4.0	17.8	18.9	Titanium	410.3	-1.5	1.5	75.3	82.1
ITC	389.0	0.0	3.4	18.8	19.2	Trent	362.4	-2.4	0.7	17.8	68.5
Kotak Mah Bank	383.2	-2.2	3.0	20.3	28.2	UltraTech	1146.0	-1.6	1.2	43.5	44.7

WORLD INDICES

Indices	Close	% Chg	Indices	Close	% Chg
Americas (Mar 10,26)	3227.7	0.3	Taiwan Taipei	3411.2	4.1
ASX 200	7568.4	-0.1	Kospi	5610.0	1.4
Nasdaq Composite	4770.5	-0.1	Kuala Lumpur Comp	1708.8	0.4
Dow Jones	37341.1	-0.6	Shanghai Se Comp	4133.4	0.3
IBEX 35	10331.1	-0.6	Stock Exchange of Hong	1407.3	0.1
FTSE 100	13743.1	-1.0	Strait Times	4863.8	0.1
DAX	7958.4	-1.1	Volatility (Mar 10,26)	7398.4	0.7
Asia/Pacific (Mar 11,26)	25525.4	-1.4	COBE S&P 500	26.1	4.8
Nikkei 225	55025.4	-1.4	COBE Dow Jones	24.9	-23.6
Hang Seng	25898.8	-0.2			

MAJOR INDICES

Previous Close	Open	High	Low	Close	Change	% Chg
BSE Sensex	78,206.0	78,238.9	78,234.4	76,759.3	-7,663.7	-1342.3
BSE 100	25,350.7	25,359.8	25,393.4	24,909.6	-4,440.1	-10.6
BSE SENSEX	25,480.9	25,496.4	25,544.6	25,041.7	-25,072.0	-408.9
BSE-200	11,064.0	11,074.1	11,100.7	10,883.3	-10,897.0	-167.1
BSE-500	35,005.2	35,044.6	35,153.7	34,487.1	-34,529.8	-475.4
BSE IPO	14,472.4	14,520.5	14,588.6	14,330.3	-14,381.9	-89.4
Dollor-30	6,986.8	-	-	6,860.9	-125.9	-1.8
Nifty 50	24,261.6	24,231.9	24,299.0	23,864.9	-394.8	-1.6
Nifty Next50	67,228.0	67,375.9	67,765.4	66,363.7	-66,498.7	-729.3
Nifty 500	22,343.0	22,351.9	22,440.9	22,009.3	-22,043.3	-96.0
India VIX	18.9	18.9	21.4	17.2	-21.1	-2.2
Nifty CPSE	7,088.5	7,093.5	7,164.4	7,079.8	-7,090.1	-1.6

BS 200

WHAT THIS STOCK PAGE CONTAINS AND WHY

BS 200 stocks account for over 95 per cent of the volume of shares, value and trades on the Bombay Stock Exchange and National Stock Exchange.

For BS 200 stocks, the company name is followed by its BSE group in brackets and the symbol indicating the

paid-up value. Four categories of information are provided: First, the basic information on the day's trading. Information is also given on the number of shares traded, and also the price trend with 52-week highs and lows.

The third sub-set of information is the stock's market capitalisation. The market capitalisation is shown in ₹ crore and is arrived at by multiplying the closing prices of shares with closing price per share (EPS) for trailing 12 months. EPS is calculated on the basis of consolidated earnings wherever available or the price has moved.

The table also contains the company's P/E multiple. The P/E multiple is arrived at by dividing the day's closing price by its reported earnings per share (EPS) for trailing 12 months. EPS is calculated on the basis of consolidated earnings wherever available or the price has moved.

Open Interest: OI is the number of contracts open at end of day in the futures and options segment. OI thus indicates traders' expectations. High OI is typically when traders see a continuing trend.

Strike Price: The price at which an option may be exercised. An option is "in-the-money" if the market price exceeds the SP (in case of a call option) and the market price is below SP (in case of a put).

Otherwise it is "out-of-the-money".

Expiry date: The date on which a derivative expires. An unexercised option

becomes valueless while futures contracts are compulsorily settled on expiry. On NSE, it is the last Thursday of every month.

Put/call ratio: The ratio of open interest in put options to call options.

Abbreviations: When a significant change occurs in the day's closing value

compared with the previous close, the close price is underlined. A significant change means a 3 per cent or more in scrips whose market values are over 10 times paid-up value or 15 per cent for the rest of the shares.

The letters H or L appended to prices indicate a new high or low in the scrip; the letters

XD after the traded quotes indicate that the scrip has gone ex-dividend after that date. XD denotes ex-bonus, XR ex-rights; XO ex-interest; all AGM/FGM preference shares/mergers and others. M denotes volume of shares in million, L in lakhs & in '000'.

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FDI easing not meant for Chinese firms, clarifies govt

SHREYA NANDI
New Delhi, 11 March

Global investors having Chinese sharehold- ing of up to 10 per cent will be eligible to invest in India under the automatic route, across sectors. But this would depend on sectoral caps, according to changes approved under the foreign direct invest- ment (FDI) policy, government officials said on Wednesday.

Earlier, foreign firms with shareholders from China or land-border nations owning even a single share had to seek mandatory approval to invest in any sector in India under the Press Note 3 of the FDI policy.

However, entities registered in China and Hong Kong and countries sharing land borders with India, will continue to need prior government approval in case they want to invest in India.

“All the restrictions for investors from land-bordering countries (LBCs) are still applicable. There is no relaxation so far as entities or investors in LBCs are concerned. This relaxation is only for entities in non-LBCs and having beneficial owners from LBCs below 10 per cent and non-controlling stake... there are no relaxations as far as investments from LBCs are concerned,” Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) joint secretary Jai Prakash Shivahare said. He added that if a firm from a country sharing land border with India provides technology and holds even one per cent stake, through which it may exercise some form of control, the investment will still need approval through the government route.

Shivahare’s statement came a day after the Union Cabinet adopted a calibrated approach of easing restrictions on invest- ments from countries sharing land borders with India, including China. It made two amendments — allowed investors from



“IT’S A CHANGING WORLD AND THE OPENING UP DOESN’T MEAN THAT CONCERNS WITH REGARD TO SECURITY HAVE GONE AWAY”

Amardeep Singh Bhatia, DPIIT secretary

The fine print

- Sectors like rare earth magnets and battery components included in list
- List can be expanded or reduced by a CoS headed by Cabinet Secretary
- Despite expedited mechanism, security and political clearance will not be eased

China and other land-border countries holding up to 10 per cent non-controlling stakes under ‘automatic-route’ and intro- duced a definitive timeline for processing investment proposals in select sectors to boost domestic manufacturing.

The Press Note 3 restrictions to cases where land-border country investors have only non-strategic, non-controlling interest was seen as adversely affecting flows from investors, including private equity (PE) and venture capital (VC) funds.

DPIIT secretary Amardeep Singh Bhatia

said that large global firms such as Black- Rock, Carlyle were seeking the easing of the press note.

Press Note 3, notified on April 17, 2020, amended the FDI policy, which mandated prior government approval for investments from an entity of a country, which shares land border with India or where the benefi- cial owner of an investment into India is situated in or is a citizen of any such country. India’s position was revised for ‘curbing opportunistic takeovers/acquisi- tions’ of domestic firms, considering their financial stress due to Covid.

The move was mainly targeted to restrict investments from China, amid tensions at the border. Before 17 April, 2020, invest- ments from China could proceed without any prior government approval — also known as the automatic route.

Proposals for investments from China and other land-border countries will include advanced battery components, rare earth permanent magnets, rare earth processing sectors and such applications will be pro- cessed and decided within 60 days. Bhatia told reporters that this list can be expanded or reduced by a committee of secretaries (CoS) headed by the Cabinet Secretary. The list also includes sectors like capital goods, electronic capital goods, electronic compo- nents, polysilicon and ingot-wafer.

However, he clarified that despite the expedited mechanism being laid out by the government and a definitive 60-day time- line for processing investment proposals, the security and political clearance will not be eased. “It’s a changing world and the opening up doesn’t mean that concerns with regards to security have gone away,” Bhatia said.

At present, about 600 applications are under Press Note 3. The amendments will come into effect after DPIIT and the finance ministry notify it.

Startups may get to access ‘stalled’ capital under new PN3 regime

PEERZADA ABRAR, UDISHA SRIVASTAV, KHUSHBOO TIWARI & AASHISH ARYAN
Bengaluru/New Delhi/Mumbai, 11 March

India’s move to revise its Press Note 3 rules is expected to ease regulatory friction that has slowed funding from overseas entities with even minority Chinese investment. It would also potentially unlock stalled capital for startups while main- taining scrutiny over strategic investments, industry execu- tives said.

The changes could revive cross-border capital flows, support fundraising momentum for technology startups and ease ownership complexities ahead of potential initial public offerings (IPOs), said industry experts. They said the Union Cabinet had approved impor- tant changes to the foreign

“The policy is poised to revive deal activity and improve access to global capital,” said Salman Waris, managing partner at tech law firm Tech- Legis Advocates & Solicitors.

Experts said the policy shift could also boost confidence among startups preparing to go public. This is because clearer rules and faster access to fund- ing improve investor visibility, valuation prospects and oper- ational stability.

“The 60-day approval time- line for proposals in key sectors like electronics and capital goods also supports timely scaling and integration into global supply chains. These are critical for IPO readiness,” added Waris. While easing restrictions, the government maintains sectoral caps, major- ity ownership with Indian entities, and strict beneficial ownership disclosures, ensuring that national security and control are preserved.

The Indian Venture and Alternate Capital Association (IVCA), the apex industry body repre- senting India’s alter- native capital ecosystem, also welcomed the govern- ment’s decision to amend the guidelines. The industry body added that the amendments represent a constructive step towards balancing national security considerations with the need to maintain India’s attractiveness as a destination for global capital.

Ashley Menezes, chairper- son, partner and chief operat- ing officer (COO), ChrysCapital, and chairperson, IVCA, said, “The government’s decision to refine the Press Note 3 frame- work is a timely and thoughtful

step. By providing clarity around beneficial ownership and enabling automatic route investments where there is a nominal holding, the policy addresses a long-standing con- cern faced by investors. This will help restore momentum to capital flows into the country.”

Since the introduction of Press Note 3 in 2020, invest- ments where the beneficial owner was from a country shar- ing a land border with India required government approval.

While the policy was intro- duced to safeguard against opportunistic takeovers during the pandemic, its application to cases involving minority and non-controlling investors in global fund structures had cre- ated practical challenges for cross-border investment flows.

Industry executives said the revised framework now pro- vides clarity to global investors where land-bordering country investors may be present as minority limited partners in diversified global fund struc- tures. This would thereby ease investment flows from interna- tional private equity and ven- ture capital funds.

Rajat Tandon, president, IVCA, said: “IVCA welcomes the government’s decision to refine the Press Note 3 frame- work and provide greater clar- ity around beneficial ownership and investment pathways. As the industry body representing India’s alternative capital ecosystem, we believe this is a very constructive step that eases operational friction for global funds investing in India. The industry will now examine the benefits of the revised framework. But it is fair to say that the changes already mark a significant improve-

ment for fund structures and cross-border capital flows.”

IVCA also noted that the introduction of a defined time- line for approvals in specific manufacturing sectors will help accelerate technology partnerships, joint ventures and supply chain integration.

Pratibha Jain, group general counsel & head of strategy, Ever- stone group, said: “The govern- ment’s clarification on the Press Note 3 framework is a welcome and pragmatic step. By bringing greater clarity to the treatment of beneficial ownership and minority participation in global fund structures, the revised policy addresses a long-stand- ing ambiguity for the private equity/venture capital industry. This should help facilitate smoother capital mobilisation and investment flows into India’s growing innovation, technology and manufacturing ecosystem.”

Rohit Jain, managing partner, Singhanian & Co, said, “Majority of the firms that are getting listed today have gone through that cycle where Chi- nese investments have been appropriately restructured. By and large, the shareholding would not be held by Chinese ultimate beneficial owners. That issue does not seem to affect too many current com- panies that are getting listed. With the 5-6 years cycle, most of the companies have restruc- tured in some manner... On any future changes in these struc- tures, the sentiments are very cautious given the geopolitical situation. Everyone is waiting to see how long this war con- tinues and to what extent the situation worsens before clarity around expansion or other opportunities.”

Centre proposes doing away with double testing of pooled blood plasma products

SANKET KOUL
New Delhi, 11 March

To ensure regulatory harmon- isation in testing blood products with global norms, the Centre has proposed doing away with testing of pooled blood plasma for Hepatitis B surface antigen and antibodies to HIV and Hepatitis C, considering these tests are done before the prod- ucts are manufactured.

Pooled blood plasma is a standardised product created by the combination of plasma collected from multiple donors, which is then pro- cessed, tested and used for

therapeutic, diagnostic and research purposes.

In a gazette notification amending the Drugs and Cos- metics Act, the Union Health Ministry said the requirement of final products to be tested for freedom from HIV I and HIV II antibodies, Hepatitis B surface antigen and Hepatitis C virus antibody shall be omitted.

“The proposed amendment is a progressive step towards regulatory harmonisation, scientific rationalisation of testing requirements, and reduction of avoidable com- pliance burden while continu- ing to uphold the highest

standards of patient safety,” the ministry said in a press note.

It added that the first homo- geneous pool of plasma is man- datorily tested for Hepatitis B surface antigen (HBsAg), Hepatitis C virus RNA and anti- bodies to HIV, according to the harmonised standards of Indian, British, European and United States pharmacopoeias.

“Pooled plasma must test negative for these viral markers before it is permitted for frac- tionation. Besides, only plasma pools that meet these safety requirements are used for manufacturing plasma- derived medicinal products,”

the ministry stated.

Despite this, experts said that under the current regula- tory framework, the final prod- ucts manufactured from already tested and qualified plasma pools are again tested. “This results in duplication of testing for the same viral markers at both the pooled plasma stage and the finished product stage, with such double testing not aligned with inter- national regulatory practices,” an official in the know said.

The Centre has invited objections and suggestions on the proposal from any person within 30 days.

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Insight Out

OPINION

Labour Codes and the search for clarity

The first of a two-part series on labour Codes looks at wage definition, compliance challenges, and the road ahead



SUMITA DAWRA

India's long-awaited labour reforms are finally entering the implementation phase. With the final notification of rules by the Centre and states/UTs, the labour Codes will soon become fully operational. For businesses, however, the real challenge is no longer legislative change but interpreting how the new Codes will function in practice.

The reforms seek to align labour regulation with contemporary economic realities — ensuring decent living standards and social security for employees, establishing a technology-driven labour governance framework, and reducing the heavy compliance burden of labour-related statutes, which reportedly accounted for more than 40 per cent of business-related compliances in the country.

These measures are expected to advance labour force formalisation, strengthen manufacturing competitiveness, and simplify compliance, particularly for micro, small and medium enterprises. Yet, despite the rationalisation of the legislative framework, several provisions remain open to interpretation, prompting stakeholders — especially industry — to seek greater clarity.

Two issues relating to the new wage definition have generated particular discussion. One concerns its implementation across the country, including the manner of wage calculation and the date from which it becomes operational. The implications are significant, as they directly affect the financial planning and

cash-flow management of establishments.

Another issue relates to the expanded applicability of minimum wages across all categories of employees. This raises a connected interpretational question of whether the statutory overtime rate will apply to all employees or only to those classified as workers under the Codes.

This article is the first part of a two-part series examining key provisions under the labour Codes that have generated debate due to interpretational ambiguities. Part I focuses on the implications of the revised wage framework. Part II will examine other operational aspects, including the number of hours in a normal working day, social security coverage, employer liability, the use of contract labour in core activities, the inspector-cum-facilitator enforcement mechanism, and the interaction of the labour Codes with the Shops and Establishments Acts of States and Union Territories.

Uniform definition of wages and its implications

One of the most significant provisions concerns the definition of wages, which has been made uniform across the country for the first time. The objective is to ensure a fair wage structure while preventing the manipulation of salary components to reduce statutory liabilities.

Earlier labour laws contained multiple definitions of wages. As a result, employers often structured salary packages in ways that kept the basic wage component low while increasing allowances.

The Code on Wages provides a clearer framework by defining wages to include all remuneration — whether by way of salaries, allowances, or otherwise — while exhaustively listing exclusions such as bonus, house rent allowance, conveyance allowance, and employer contributions to

pension or provident fund [Section 2(y)].

However, a proviso states that if these excluded components exceed one-half (or such other percentage as may be notified by the Central government) of total remuneration, the excess will automatically be included in the wages. This provision ensures that the basic wage remains at a reasonable level for the calculation of statutory payments relating to social security and other employee benefits.

Treatment of unlisted allowances

Allowances vary widely across organisations, including for senior leadership roles. Employers therefore seek clarity on how allowances not listed in the Codes should be treated when applying the one-half (or other notified) cap.

A close reading of Section 2(y) suggests that the provision has been drafted with deliberate clarity. While the definition of “wages” is broad, the exclusions appear carefully and exhaustively listed. In practical terms, if a payment or allowance is not specifically mentioned in the exclusion list, it must be treated as part of wages.

The design appears intentional: To prevent arbitrary classification of allowances by employers as being “outside wages” and to ensure fair treatment of employees.

Impact on employers and financial planning

The revised wage composition is expected to increase employee benefits. From the employer's perspective, however, it may also lead to a higher cost to the company due to increased social security contributions and other statutory liabilities.

Companies are confronted with the question of whether implementation should begin from 21 November 2025 — the date of notification — or whether they

ONE OF THE MOST SIGNIFICANT PROVISIONS CONCERNS THE DEFINITION OF WAGES, WHICH HAS BEEN MADE UNIFORM ACROSS THE COUNTRY FOR THE FIRST TIME TO ENSURE A FAIR WAGE STRUCTURE



should wait until the final rules are prescribed by the Centre and states.

In practice, provisions that are definitional and self-contained should be implemented without delay. The definition of wages falls squarely within this category. Although the final notification of the percentage cap is still awaited, businesses should accord immediate priority to a review of wage restructuring for all employees.

Several large companies such as TCS, Infosys, L&T, and Tech Mahindra have already indicated that they are provisioning for the restructuring of wage components in anticipation of higher liabilities for social security payments and other employee welfare benefits. These adjustments are essentially a one-time correction arising from the revised wage structure.

Minimum wages and overtime interpretation

The new labour Codes also expand the scope of minimum wage protection. Minimum wages will now apply to all employees — skilled, semi-skilled, or unskilled — engaged in technical, operational, managerial, or administrative roles.

Earlier, minimum wage provisions

applied only to scheduled employment, leaving many employees outside the protection framework. This expansion raises a related question regarding the category of employees eligible for overtime wages.

Under the Code on Wages, overtime is payable to “an employee,” whereas the Code on Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions (OSH&WC) specifies overtime payment to “a worker.” This difference in terminology has generated debate over whether managerial and supervisory employees may also claim overtime, which must be paid at not less than twice the normal rate of wages.

To address this issue, it is necessary to understand the distinction between “employee” and “worker.” Under the Codes, a worker is defined as a person engaged in skilled, unskilled, manual, operational, technical, clerical, or supervisory work, but excludes those in managerial or administrative roles, as well as supervisors drawing wages exceeding ₹18,000 per month. This clarifies that overtime under the OSH&WC Code applies specifically to such workers.

However, the reference to overtime wages being payable to “employee,” as mentioned in the Code on Wages, nevertheless creates some uncertainty. In the broader context of the Code on Wages, it is

presumed the provision is intended primarily to safeguard wage payments across the workforce.

At the same time, overtime provisions are historically linked to the welfare and safety of workers engaged in labour-intensive activities. Their purpose is to protect workers from excessive physical labour and to compensate them for work beyond normal working hours. Managers and senior leadership would generally fall outside this category.

Nevertheless, employers should review employment contracts to determine whether working hours have been defined for employees, including senior leadership.

Need for common narrative

The implementation of the new labour Codes marks an important step towards modernising India's labour regulatory framework and carries significant implications for the Indian economy. At this stage, it is important for a common narrative to emerge that clarifies the provisions and brings all stakeholders onto the same page as the country progresses towards a ‘Viksit Bharat’.

The writer is a former Union labour secretary. Views are personal

OPINION

Getting to the AI frontier

India cannot remain only a user of AI systems shaped elsewhere. It must transition from access to leadership



JAYANT SINHA

The AI Impact Summit demonstrated that India has made meaningful progress in building the foundations of an artificial intelligence ecosystem. Under the IndiaAI Mission, shared compute capacity has expanded, graphics processing unit (GPU) pricing has been lowered, teams are developing indigenous foundation models, and applications across agriculture, health, finance, and public services are being catalysed. This application-first approach has created momentum. The question now is whether this approach is sufficient for the strategic environment taking shape.

The baseline of the AI economy is a G2 world dominated by the United States and China. Frontier model development requires tens of thousands of advanced GPUs, dense data centre clusters, reliable power, specialised talent, and multi-year capital commitments. Both the US and China are making annual investments in the hundreds of billions of dollars in frontier AI capabilities. Once compute, energy, and research ecosystems co-locate at this scale, advantage compounds.

Leading AI researchers have warned that middle powers, such as India, cannot rely on diffusion of AI applications alone. The capital and talent required to train frontier systems are rising sharply, and access to the most advanced models cannot be assumed indefinitely. Even if applications spread widely, economic rents and strategic leverage accrue where frontier capability is built and continuously improved. The implication is not that every nation must match the United States or China, but that credible near-frontier capability is necessary to avoid structural dependency.

Several middle powers have drawn this conclusion. France has backed Mistral as a frontier lab tied to sovereign compute initiatives. Japan has integrated AI into its economic security framework. The United Arab Emirates (UAE) has combined capital and energy advantage to build sovereign model programs and large-scale infrastructure. While none of these countries is

seeking to match the US or China, they are building up their strategic leverage.

India's current approach is application-first and focused on democratising AI access. Companies such as Sarvam are building multilingual models suited to Indian conditions, and IndiaAI is expanding shared compute access. This is necessary but not sufficient. An application-first strategy has become a full-stack AI strategy for five reasons.

First, value extraction is moving upward. Frontier model owners capture disproportionate rents through application programming interfaces (APIs), enterprise licensing, and ecosystem control. Building applications on externally controlled models risks long-term dependency. Second, affordability cannot be assumed. As AI becomes embedded in enterprise and public systems, pricing power may concentrate. Near-frontier domestic capability materially improves negotiating leverage.

Third, national security considerations are inseparable from AI capability. Frontier models are dual-use systems relevant to cybersecurity, intelligence, logistics, and defence. Operational autonomy at the inference layer is useful, but strategic autonomy requires influence over training and updates. Fourth, long-term capability building requires depth. Frontier labs anchor research talent, generate spillovers into academia and industry, and create durable scientific capacity. Without concentrated nodes, ecosystems plateau at integration rather than advance core science.

Fifth, training priorities reflect the interests of those who fund and control frontier labs. The most advanced multimodal systems are optimised for enterprise productivity, advertising, and global consumer markets. India's needs differ. With hundreds of millions consuming entertainment in multiple languages, there is substantial demand for multimodal models that can generate and localise video, audio, and interactive content across Indian languages and cultural contexts. If training objectives are set elsewhere, optimisation will not prioritise Indian linguistic nuance or regional storytelling economics. Over time, this shapes which industries benefit most from AI advances.

The obvious question is cost. A serious

frontier program would likely require annual capital commitments in the low single-digit billions of dollars over five to seven years to fund large-scale GPU clusters, energy provisioning, and sustained research teams. In the context of India's overall digital infrastructure and industrial investment plans, this is material but manageable. It represents strategic insurance rather than financial overreach. Moreover, we have many corporate groups that can build such a frontier capability working within a well-designed policy framework.

This effort should be designed carefully. India does not need a proliferation of symbolic labs. We should strive to enable a small number of frontier-scale champions with ring-fenced compute access, milestone-based funding, and periodic performance review. Shared pools should continue to support ecosystem diffusion,

but frontier training requires dedicated capacity and long-horizon planning.

The strategy should also be embedded in a broader middle-power framework. In a G2 baseline world, pluralism will not emerge organically.

India should work with France, the United Kingdom, Japan, Korea, the UAE, and others to build a distributed network of frontier capabilities that reach 80 to 90 per cent of global best performance on critical capability benchmarks. Such a network would reduce systemic dependence, create interoperability options, and influence governance norms more effectively than isolated efforts.

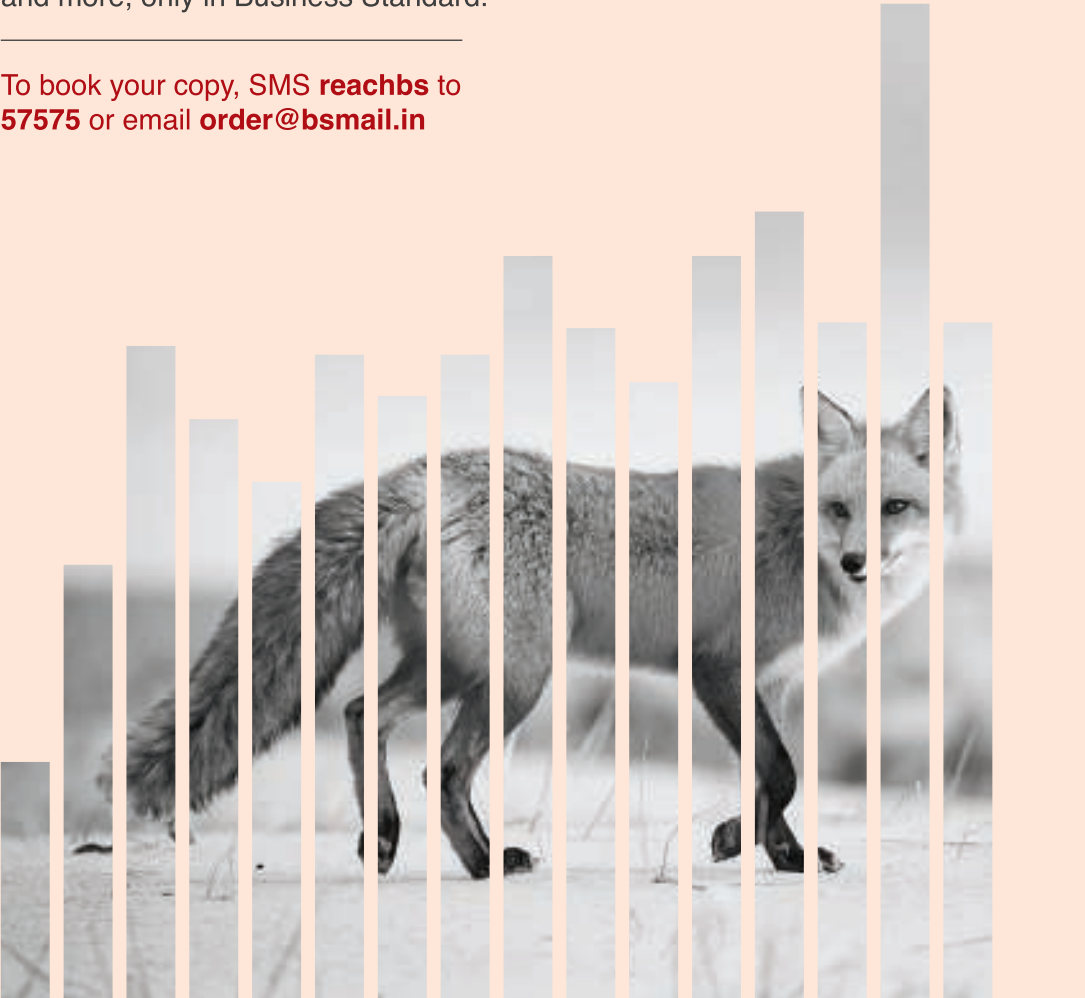
India's civilisational scale strengthens the case. With one-sixth of humanity and extraordinary linguistic diversity, India cannot remain only a user of AI systems shaped elsewhere. Artificial intelligence will increasingly mediate economic transactions, public services, cultural production, and national security. The AI Summit should therefore mark a transition from access to leadership. In the coming decade, countries that possess credible frontier capability will shape the terms on which AI is diffused. India must be among them.

The writer is president, Everstone Group, and visiting professor in practice at the London School of Economics. He is a former Union minister and Lok Sabha MP. Views are personal

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Aadhar Housing Finance Ltd.

Corporate Office: Unit No. 802, Natraj Rustomjee, Western Express Highway and M.V. Road, Andheri (East), Mumbai- 400069.

Uttam Nagar Branch: 3rd Floor, S.S. Motors Building, 274 Nawada, Opposite Metro Pillar No. 715, Uttam Nagar, Delhi-110059.

**APPENDIX IV POSSESSION NOTICE (for immovable property)**

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of **Aadhar Housing Finance Limited (AHFL)** under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, Demand Notice(s) issued by the Authorised Officer of the company to the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) mentioned herein below to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within **60 days** from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under Sub-Section (4) of the Section 13 of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002. The borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of AHFL for an amount as mentioned herein under with interest thereon.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s) (Name of the Branch)	Description of Secured Asset (Immovable Property)	Demand Notice Date & Amount	Date of Possession
1	(Loan Code No. 18600000081/ Uttam Nagar Branch) Santosh Kumar Tripathi (Borrower) Arti Tripathi (Co-Borrower)	All that part & parcel of property bearing, Kh No 351 Plot No F 1918 1919 1920 First Floor with roof rights Block F Kh No. 351 Rampark Extension, Ghaziabad, UttarPradesh 201102. Boundaries : East - Plot No F-1921, West - Plot No F -1917, North- Road 20 ft wide, South - Road 20 ft wide	10-12-2021 & ₹ 24,23,993/-	10-03-2026

Place : Uttar Pradesh
Date : 12.03.2026

Authorised Officer
Aadhar Housing Finance Limited

REGIONAL OFFICE NOIDA,
C-3, 2nd Floor, Sector 1, Noida 201301. PH-0120-2524896
Email: recoverynoida@canarabank.com

Date: 11-03-2026

To,
1. **Shri Rajat Verma S/o Adesh Verma,**
R/o Plot no. 61/62, 3rd Floor, Near ABVP School, Guru Angad Nagar, Laxmi Nagar, East Delhi, Delhi- 110092
2. **Smt. Nisha Sharma,** R/o Plot no. 61/62, 3rd Floor, Near ABVP School, Guru Angad Nagar, Laxmi Nagar, East Delhi, Delhi- 110092
Subject: Demand for Payment of Outstanding Dues / No Objection to release the property upon payment by the builder in terms of their offer/request
Dear Sir/Madam,

This has reference to the loan facility availed by you for **Flat no A-1808**, Tripartite Agreements dated 12-10-2020 were executed between 1. you i.e. Shri Rajat Verma S/o Shri Adesh Verma, 2. M/s Skyhigh Infra Projects Pvt.Ltd. (the Builder), and 3. Canara bank (e-Syndicate Bank).

Due to your failure to comply with the repayment scheduled as per the sanctioned terms, the loan accounts have slipped into NPA dt. 30-12-2021. The bank has also filed a suit before the Hon'ble DRT, Lucknow vide OA No. 896/2023, Canara Bank Vs Rajat Verma & Ors. whereby the Hon'ble Tribunal has passed an order dated 15-07-2024, against the defendants "to pay the dues within a period of two months from the date of judgment, failing which the applicant bank will be entitled to recover the same from the secured assets, personal movables and immovable assets of the defendants."

Recently, the bank has come to know that the builder has already cancelled the booking of Flat A-1808, vide letter dt. 06.05.2024. Further, the Builder has offered to release the property upon receipt of part-payment agreed by the bank. It is also observed that, despite several communications and the lapse of four years from the date of NPA, you have failed to discharge your total outstanding liabilities, and an amount of **Rs 47,30,166.32 (Rupees Forty Seven Lakhs Thirty Thousand One Hundred Sixty Six and Paisea Thirty Two Only)** remains due and payable in your loan accounts.

The details of the Flats/Units are as follows:

S.NO.	ACCOUNT	FLAT NO.	TOTAL OUTSTANDING DUES (10-03-2026)
1.	8778915000011	A-1808	Rs 47,30,166.32 (Rupees Forty Seven Lakhs Thirty Thousand One Hundred Sixty Six and Paisea Thirty Two Only)
TOTAL			Rs 47,30,166.32

You are hereby called upon to pay the entire outstanding amount within 7 (Seven) days from the date of this notice. Please note that in the event of your failure to comply within the stipulated time:

1. Upon your failure, the Bank shall be constrained to consider and accept the Builder's proposal/offer by accepting the part-payment to be made by the Builder and proceed with the release of the aforesaid properties upon receipt of the part-payment, as agreed by the bank.
2. The bank shall continue its legal actions to recover the balance outstanding dues in accordance with law, together with applicable interest, costs, and charges.

This notice is issued without prejudice to the Bank's rights to initiate further legal proceedings, including but not limited to enforcement of securities and recovery actions under applicable laws.

You are therefore advised to treat this as a final opportunity to clear the outstanding dues within the stipulated period else the bank may consider the builder's proposal/offer and will proceed to release the property upon receiving the part payment.

Yours faithfully,
Authorized Signatory

REGIONAL OFFICE NOIDA,
C-3, 2nd Floor, Sector 1, Noida 201301. PH-0120-2524896
Email: recoverynoida@canarabank.com

Date: 11-03-2026

To,
Shri Kuldeep Soni S/o Krishan Kumar, R/o H.No. 94A, Nangal Sirohi (104), Mahendragarh, Haryana - 123028
Subject: Demand for Payment of Outstanding Dues / No Objection to release the property upon payment by the builder in terms of their offer/request
Dear Sir/Madam,

This has reference to the loan facility availed by you for **Flat no B-1908**, Tripartite Agreements dated 30-12-2020 were executed between 1. you i.e. Shri Kuldeep Soni S/o Shri Krishan Kumar, 2. M/s Skyhigh Infra Projects Pvt Ltd. (the Builder), and 3. Canara bank (e-Syndicate Bank).

Due to your failure to comply with the repayment scheduled as per the sanctioned terms, the loan accounts have slipped into NPA dt. 29-01-2023. The bank has also filed a suit before the Hon'ble DRT, Lucknow vide OA No. 21/2024, Canara Bank Vs Kuldeep Soni, whereby the Hon'ble Tribunal has passed an order dated 16-01-2026, against the defendants "to pay the dues within a period of two months from the date of judgment, failing which the applicant bank will be entitled to recover the same from the secured assets, personal movables and immovable assets of the defendants."

Recently, the bank has come to know that the builder has already cancelled the booking of Flat B-1908, vide letter dt. 10.05.2024. Further, the Builder has offered to release the property upon receipt of part-payment agreed by the bank. It is also observed that, despite several communications and the lapse of four years from the date of NPA, you have failed to discharge your total outstanding liabilities, and an amount of **Rs 30,41,320.11 (Rupees Thirty Lakhs Forty One Thousand Three Hundred Twenty and Paise Eleven Only)** remains due and payable in your loan accounts.

The details of the Flats/Units are as follows:

S.NO.	ACCOUNT	FLAT NO.	TOTAL OUTSTANDING DUES (10-03-2026)
1.	86889330001054	B-1908	Rs. 29,45,474.30
2.	125005856896		Rs. 95,845.81
TOTAL			Rs 30,41,320.11

You are hereby called upon to pay the entire outstanding amount within 7 (Seven) days from the date of this notice. Please note that in the event of your failure to comply within the stipulated time:

1. Upon your failure, the Bank shall be constrained to consider and accept the Builder's proposal/offer by accepting the part-payment to be made by the Builder and proceed with the release of the aforesaid properties upon receipt of the part-payment, as agreed by the bank.
2. The bank shall continue its legal actions to recover the balance outstanding dues in accordance with law, together with applicable interest, costs, and charges.

This notice is issued without prejudice to the Bank's rights to initiate further legal proceedings, including but not limited to enforcement of securities and recovery actions under applicable laws.

You are therefore advised to treat this as a final opportunity to clear the outstanding dues within the stipulated period else the bank may consider the builder's proposal/offer and will proceed to release the property upon receiving the part payment.

Yours faithfully,
Authorized Signatory

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that (1) Mr. Rajeev Bajaj & (2) Mr. Sameer Bajaj became the owners of the Plot no. A-113, (167.23 Sq. Mtrs.), Surya Nagar, Ghaziabad, U.P. after the death of Mrs. Sushila Bajaj who acquired the said property by virtue of Freehold Deed dated 03.06.2008 bearing Doc. No. 15506 and further the said property has also been mutated in favour of (1) Mr. Rajeev Bajaj & (2) Mr. Sameer Bajaj vide Mutation Dated 14.02.2024. Now, the owners (1) Mr. Rajeev Bajaj & (2) Mr. Sameer Bajaj are intending the sell the said property to M/s Medion Bioleach Pvt. Ltd. and M/s Medion Bioleach Pvt. Ltd. is financing the purchase of the said property from ICICI Bank Ltd. If any body has any charge/interest/tittle in the said property or any kind of dispute kindly inform the undersigned in writing on the below mentioned address within 10 days of the present. **Sahaj Shekh, Advocate** Senior Legal Manager, North Eye Advisors B-220, 2nd Floor, Noida One, Tower-B, Sector-62, Noida, UP-201309 Email: lsr-northeye.co.in, Contact No-729417072

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public that the original Transfer Deed-cum-Sale Deed of Flat No. 6/256-B, Sector-22, Noida-201301, registered in the name of Mr. Ajit Singh on 05-07-2005 at Tehsil Noida, has been lost/misplaced around 01-03-2026. If any person finds the above-mentioned Transfer Deed-cum-Sale Deed, he/she is requested to kindly return the same to the address mentioned below. Any use of the said registered document by any person other than the lawful owner shall be considered completely illegal. In case the original Transfer Deed-cum-Sale Deed in the name of Mr. Ajit Singh is not found, the owner of the property shall obtain a duplicate/certified copy from the concerned authority, which shall be treated as the original document and may be used for future purposes.

Ganga Rawat, G/256-B, Sector-22, Noida-201301 Mobile: 8448063862 Date: 09.03.2026

GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND

Office of the Executive Engineer
Irrigation Division, Jasidih Camp-Deoghar

E-Procurement Tender Notice

Tender Reference No. :- WRD/Irr. Div., Jasidih camp-Deoghar/ SBD-IFB-01/2025-26 Dt :11.03.2026

1.	Name of the work	Construction of CD at ch. 1715/1709, ch. 1754/1748, ch. 1784/1778, ch. 1843 & ch. 2064.00, DLR Bridge at ch. 1728, ch. 1747/1750 & ch. 2000.00 and SLR Bridge at ch. 1824.00 of Punasi Main Canal
2.	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Rs. 06,70,24,396.07 (Rs. Six crore seventy lakh twenty four thousand three hundred ninety six and seven paise) only/-
3.	Time of Completion	360 Days
4.	Last date & Time for receipt of bids	06.04.2026 Up to 5:00 P.M.
5.	Date of Publication of Tender on website	16.03.2026 01:00 P.M.
6.	Name & address of office inviting tender	Executive Engineer Irrigation Division, Jasidih Camp-Deoghar
7.	Contact no. of Procurement officer	097710-63448
8.	Helpline number of e-Procurement cell	06432-232477

Note :- Only E-Tender will be accepted
Further details can be seen on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>

Executive Engineer
Irrigation Division, Jasidih Camp-Deoghar

PR 374711 Water Resource(25-26)\$D

HINDUJA HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED
Corporate Office: No. 167-169, 2nd Floor, Anna Salai, Saidapet, Chennai-600015.

Branch Office: F8, First Floor, Mahaxmi Metro Tower, Sector 4, Vaishali, Ghaziabad, 201019 Email: auction@hindujahousingfinance.com
RLM - Arun Mohan Sharma - 8800898999 • CRM - Saurabh Kumar - 7503188646
RRM - Amit Kaushik - 9587088333 • CLM - Kashish Bhatia - 999371936

NOTICE UNDER SECTION 13(2) OF THE SECURITIZATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (SARFAESI ACT)
In respect of loans availed by below mentioned borrowers / guarantors through HINDUJA HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED, which have become NPA with below mentioned balance outstanding on dates mentioned below. We have already issued detailed Demand Notice dated as mentioned below Under Sec. 13(2) of Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 by Registered Post / Speed Post / Courier with acknowledge due to you which has been returned undelivered / acknowledgement not received. We have indicated our intention of taking possession of securities owned on one of you as per Sec. 13(4) of the Act in case of your failure to pay the amount mentioned below within 60 days. In the event of your not discharging liability as set out herein above the Bank / Secured Creditor may exercise any of the right conferred vide section 13(4) of SARFAESI Act while publishing the possession notice / auction notice, electronically or otherwise, as required under the SARFAESI Act, the Bank / Secured Creditor may also publish your photograph. Details are hereunder:-

Sr.	Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s)	Demand Notice Date & Amount
1.	DL/DEL/PAND/A000000191, Mr. Chandar Prakash Yadav (Deceased) Through Legal Heirs, MRS. Lali Devi, House No.26D, Ram Vihar, Banthala, Loni Dehat, Ghaziabad U.P. 201102	18.02.2026 & Rs.10,75,766/- as on 14.02.2026 NPA Date : 06-03-2024

Description of Property: Residential House/Plot/ Property, having area measuring 75 sq yards, i.e 62.70 sq mtrs, out of Kharsa No.228, Block-D, Situated in Ram Vihar Colony, Village Banthala, Pargana Loni, Tehsil and District Ghaziabad-201102 BOUNDARIES : EAST : Rasta 15 ft wide, WEST: Rasta 10 ft wide, NORTH: Other's Property, SOUTH: Other's Property

2.	DL/DEL/DL/H/A000000848, Mr. Dinesh Kataria (Deceased) Through Legal Heirs, Mrs. Nitu Khurana, BE-297, Hari Nagar, South West Delhi, Delhi-110064	18.02.2026 & Rs.5,12,656/- as on 14.02.2026 NPA Date : 05-07-2024
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Description of Property: Residential Flat No.A208/31, Third Floor, without roof rights, area measuring 33.59 sq mtrs, situated in Aashra-1 Aashra Enclave, Sector-4A, Located in colony Mandola Vihar, Tehsil Loni, District Ghaziabad-201102 BOUNDARIES : NORTH: EAST : 9mt wide Drive way North WEST : Flat No.A-208/34, South East: Flat No.A-209/34, SOUTH:West: Flat No.A-208/32

3.	DL/LNCU/NOIU/A000001354, Mr. Rakesh Kumar (Deceased) Through Legal Heirs, Mrs. Ramesh Devi, House No. 159, Badshahpur Sirsoli, Ghaziabad U.P.-201102	18.02.2026 & Rs.21,03,832/- as on 14.02.2026 NPA Date : 05-09-2024
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Description of Property: Residential House/Property, bearing No.00509, out of Kharsa No. 1319, area measuring 300 sq yards, i.e 250.83 sq mtrs, located in Badshapur, Sirsoli, Pargana and Tehsil Loni, District Ghaziabad, U.P. BOUNDARIES : EAST : Rasta 9ft wide, WEST : House of Mahipal, North: Other's Property, SOUTH : House of Mahipal

4.	DL/GRN/SNPR/A000000094, Mr. Keshav Dedha (Deceased) Through Legal Heirs, Mrs. Versha, Kh No 133, Illichpur, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201102	18.02.2026 & Rs.23,36,646/- as on 14.02.2026 NPA Date : 03-06-2025
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Description of Property: Residential Plot, area measuring 300 sq yards, i.e 250.83 sq mtrs, out of Kharsa No.3322, situated in Village Illichpur, Pargana and Tehsil Loni, District Ghaziabad U.P. Boundaries: EAST: Rasta 12 ft wide, WEST: Others Plot, NORTH: Property of Keshav Dedha, SOUTH: Rasta 15 ft wide

5.	GZ/CHP/CHPL/A000000075, Ms Sonia, M27.MIG, Pocket-2 New Kandoli, Delhi-110096. Mr Bheem Singh, 539, Prakash Nagar, Khora Colony, Ghaziabad U.P.-201309	18.02.2026 & Rs.27,96,202/- as on 14.02.2026 NPA Date : 05-09-2025
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Description of Property: Residential Flat No.FF-1 HIG, First Floor, without Roof Rights, Front RHS Side, area measuring 86.49 sq mtrs, situated in Plot No.MM-32, DLF Ankur Vihar, Village Sadullabad, Pargana and Tehsil Loni, District Ghaziabad U.P. Boundaries: EAST: Plot No.MM-33, WEST: Flat No.FF-02, NORTH: Flat No.FF-04, SOUTH: Open Area.

6.	DL-MNR-VSEN-A000000369, Mr Mir Hasan S/o Ali Hasan, Mrs Sanno W/O Mir Hasan, Ward No-47, Near Kali Mandir, Ashok Vihar, Loni Dehat, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201102	18.02.2026 & Rs.10,01,115/- as on 14.02.2026 NPA Date : 05-12-2025
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Description of Property: Residential House, area measuring 50 sq yards, i.e 41.803 sq mtrs, out of Kharsa No.261, Situated in Taaz Enclave, Ashok Vihar, Village Loni, Pargana and Tehsil Loni, District Ghaziabad, U.P. Boundaries: East: Plot of Asif, West: Plot of Vaki, North: Other's Property, South: Rasta 20ft wide.

The above mentioned Borrowers/ Guarantors are advised (1) To collect the original notes from the undersigned for more and complete details and (2) To pay the balance outstanding amount interest and costs etc. within 60 days from the date of notice referred to above to avoid further action under the SARFAESI Act.

Date: 12.03.2026, Place: Ghaziabad

Authorized Officer
Hinduja Housing Finance Limited

Indian Bank			
ALLAHABAD			
Zonal Office: Tindwari Road Near Saint Mary School Banda (U.P.)-210001			
POSSESSION NOTICE (Rule 8(1) for Immovable Property)			
Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorised Officer of the Indian Bank, under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 8 & 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 (issued a Demand Notice (details of which have been mentioned hereunder) calling upon the borrowers to repay the amount mentioned in the respective notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The Borrowers having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrowers and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under section 13(4) of the said Act read with les 8 & 9 of the said rules. The borrowers in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the properties and any dealings with the properties will be subject to the charge of the Indian Bank for an amount and interest & charges there on as described here in below: We draw attention to the provisions of Section 13(8) of the SARFAESI Act and the Rules framed there under which deals with your rights of redemption over the securities.			
S. No.	Name of The Borrowers/Mortgagors/Guarantors/Partners Branch	Description of the Immovable property	Date of Demand Notice Date of Possession Notice Outstanding Amt.
1.	1. M/s Mayur Motors (Borrower- Partnership Firm) 2. Mr. Ashok Kumar Agrawal S/o Late Narendra Kumar Agrawal 3. Mr. Anoop Kumar Agrawal S/o Late Narendra Kumar Agrawal 4. Mr. Tanmay Agrawal s/o Late Alok Agrawal 5. Mr. Ashish Agrawal S/o Late Narendra Kumar Agrawal 6. Smt. Sangita Agrawal w/o Ashish Agrawal 7. Smt. Jyoti Agrawal w/o Anoop Kumar Agrawal 8. The estate of the deceased Smt. Sushila Devi Agrawal w/o Late Narendra Kumar Agrawal represented by legal heirs Viz. (A) Mr. Ashok Kumar Agrawal (B) Ashish Agrawal (C) Anoop Agrawal (D) Smt. Meenal. Agrawal w/o Sh. Prince Raj Agarwal, (E) The estate of the deceased Mr. Alok Agrawal S/o Late Narendra Kumar Agrawal represented by legal heirs Viz. E(i) Smt. Sweta Agrawal, E(ii) Mr. Tanmay Agrawal.	(i). Equitable Mortgage of property located at Gata No.-11592, near zila Parishad Chauraha Aligani, Distt.- Banda, Uttar Pradesh, in the name of Late Narendra Kumar Agrawal measuring area 264.86 sq. mt. Boundaries- East- Premises of Mahendra Kumar Agrawal, West- Road, North- Road, South-House of Smt. Urmila Nigam. (ii). Equitable Mortgage of Commercial land and building property situated at Gata no 1446, Tindwari Road, Kalu Kuan, Banda, Uttar Pradesh-210001, in the name of Mr. Ashish Agrawal S/o Late Narendra Kumar Agrawal and Late Sushila Devi Agrawal w/o Late Narendra Kumar Agrawal measuring area 367.75 sq. mt. , Boundaries: East- Property of Om Prakash Trivedi, West-Banda Tindwari road, North- Property of Om Prakash Trivedi, South- Property of Kashi Prasad Gupta	11.12.2025 11.03.2026 Rs. 2,24,07,706/- and Interest thereon
Branch: Banda (CBS Code-4079), Mob.: 7837366299			
Date : 12.03.2026 Place: Banda The Authorized Officer: Indian Bank			

SIMBHAOLI SUGARS LIMITED
Regd. Office : Simbhaoli Dist. Hapur (U.P.) - 245207
CIN - L15122UP2011PLC044210
E-mail: info@simbhaolisugars.com Website: www.simbhaolisugars.com

EXTRACT OF AUDITED CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED MARCH 31, 2025 (Rs. in Lacs)

S. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended			Year ended		
		March 31,2025 Audited	December 31,2024 Unaudited	March 31,2024 Audited	March 31,2025 Audited	March 31,2024 Audited	March 31,2024 Audited
1	Total income from operations (net)	33,164.92	22,350.28	37,088.08	99,669.05	120,341.28	
2	Net Profit/ (loss) for the period before Tax and exceptional items	675.20	(261.39)	1,379.48	(1,975.07)	(3,537.41)	
3	Net Profit/ (loss) for the period before Tax and after exceptional items	675.20	(261.39)	1,379.48	(1,975.07)	(3,537.41)	
4	Net Profit/ (loss) for the period after Tax and exceptional items	777.64	(261.29)	1,822.32	(1,981.19)	(3,045.86)	
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [comprising net profit/(loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	755.11	(261.29)	1,768.39	(2,003.72)	(3,099.79)	
6	Paid up equity share capital (face value Rs.10/- each)	4,127.90	4,127.90	4,127.90	4,127.90	4,127.90	
7	Other Equity				(16,643.64)	(16,769.49)	
8	-EPS before exceptional item	6.86	(0.63)	6.39	0.32	(5.35)	
	-EPS after exceptional item	6.86	(0.63)	6.39	0.32	(5.35)	

Notes :

- The Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT), Allahabad bench, Prayagraj has admitted the petition of Oriental Bank of Commerce (now Punjab National Bank), for initiation of Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP) under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016 (IBC) vide its order dated 11.07.2024, Mr. Anurag Goel was appointed as the IRP. Accordingly he has taken control of the Management and Operations of the Company.
- Since the management of the Company have been taken over by the IRP these consolidated financial statements have not been considered and certified by the Audit Committee and not been approved by the Board of directors. However, the same has been certified by Mr. Dayal Chand Popli (CFO) of the Company. Based on these certifications these Consolidated financial statements have been taken on record by the Mr. Anurag Goel (IRP) and signed solely for the purpose of ensuring compliance by the Corporate Debtor with applicable laws and subject to the following disclaimers (Refer notes to accounts no. 17):
 - The IRP has assumed control of the Corporate Debtor with effect from July 12, 2024.
 - The IRP has furnished and signed the report in good faith and accordingly, no suit, prosecution or legal proceeding shall lie against the IRP in terms of section 233 of the Insolvency Code.
 - The IRP while signing the Consolidated financial results, has relied upon the assistance provided by the Key Managerial Personnel, Management and Key Officials of the Corporate Debtor for the year ended on March 31, 2025 have been taken on record by the IRP solely on the basis of and on relying on the certifications, representations and statements of the Management of the Corporate Debtor, for all such information and data, the IRP has assumed that such data are in conformity with the Companies Act, 2013 and other applicable laws with respect to the preparation of the Consolidated Financial Statements and that they give true and fair view of the position of the Corporate Debtor as of the dates and period indicated therein. Accordingly, the IRP is not making any representations regarding accuracy, veracity or completeness of the data or information in the Financial Statements.
- Consolidated Financial results have not been considered and recommended by the Audit Committee as the same are not required as per SEBI (LODR) Regulations.

For Simbhaoli Sugars Limited

Certified By :

Dayal Chand Popli

Long days, longer nights: Seafarers navigate a raging war

Shared meals, regular work schedules, communication with families seeing them through uncertainty

GEORGIE KOITHARA & ANUSHKA BHARDWAJ
New Delhi, 11 March

“This is not a drill.” That was the message the crew heard when the captain called everyone to the citadel — the reinforced safe room deep inside the vessel — as missiles streaked across the sky above the Persian Gulf. This was March 7, a week after the US-Israel-Iran war broke out.

“It was a scary day,” said an Indian sailor currently aboard a merchant ship operating in West Asia. “We felt anxious watching the third officer bring all our documents with him to the citadel. That was the first sighting of missiles; they flew past us.”

The crew could not sleep that night. “There were constant alerts on the phone, telling us to take shelter,” the sailor said. By the next morning, thick black smoke was visible from a nearby oil terminal. The debris of an intercepted missile had fallen on an oil storage unit.

Days later, the ship remains in the region.

“We are getting used to the constant alerts to take shelter, listening to sonic booms from jets flying above us, hearing news of neighbouring ports being targeted, and being the only ship in the terminal,” the sailor said.

His experience reflects that of thousands of maritime workers operating in the waters around the Strait of Hormuz and the Persian Gulf, where hostilities have escalated.

According to a statement by International Maritime Organization (IMO) Secretary-General Arsenio Dominguez, around 20,000 seafarers remain stranded in the Persian Gulf region, working “under heightened risk and considerable mental strain”.

The conflict has already resulted in fatalities and injuries among maritime personnel, including the deaths of three Indian crew members on board foreign vessels. On Wednesday, a projectile hit a cargo ship in the Strait of Hormuz, setting the vessel ablaze.

India, among the world’s largest suppliers of seafaring workforce, has a significant presence in the region. According to the Mumbai-based Sailors Union of India, which represents seafarers in partnership with the Bharatiya Mazdoor Sangh, 36 Indian-flagged ships carrying about 800 Indian crew members are currently operating in the Gulf region. The union puts the total number of Indian seafarers working globally at



Smoke billows from Skylight, an oil tanker carrying 15 Indian and 5 Iranian seafarers, which was hit off Oman's coast on March 1

FILE PHOTO: REUTERS

about 350,000, of which some 125,000 are on Indian-flagged vessels.

The union’s founder and president, RP Veetil, said they are in touch with maritime authorities to obtain information about the seafarers and facilitate communication with their families. However, there are practical challenges in bringing them home.

“When people ask why they simply cannot evacuate everyone, the issue is that every ship needs a minimum number of crew members to operate,” Veetil said. “Someone has to relieve them, and often others are not ready to take charge of the post.”

Eyes on the vessels

Indian maritime authorities say several measures have been activated to monitor

the situation and support seafarers.

In an advisory issued on February 28, the Directorate General of Shipping (DGS) asked all Indian-flagged vessels operating in or transiting the region to undertake comprehensive ship-shore security drills covering multiple threat scenarios, including loitering munitions (such as suicide drones), unmanned surface vessels, and other such threats.

The maritime regulator also advised the vessels to test their ship security alert system before entering the high-risk area to ensure the operational readiness of onboard security systems. The advisory requires ship owners, operators and charterers to carry out voyage-specific risk assessments before planning any transit through the affected waters.

To strengthen monitoring, vessels

Docked in danger

Confirmed incidents in Strait of Hormuz & West Asia

Location/ Date	Fatalities	Injuries	Notes
Port of Bahrain (1 Mar)	1	2	One shipyard worker fatality. Two shipyard workers seriously injured
17 NM NW of Mina Sagr, UAE (1 Mar)	0	0	Fire on board. No injuries
52 NM NW of Muscat, Oman (1 Mar)	1	0	One seafarer fatality
5 NM N of Khasab, Oman (1 Mar)	1	4	Four seafarers injured. One seafarer fatality. One seafarer missing
7 NM east of Fujairah, UAE (3 Mar)	0	0	Steel plating damage. No injuries
10 NM east of Fujairah, UAE (3 Mar)	0	0	Minor damage. No injuries
2 NM north of Oman (4 Mar)	0	0	Hull damage above waterline. No injuries
30 NM SE of Mubarak Al Kabeer, Kuwait (5 Mar)	0	0	Hull breach. No injuries
6 NM north of Oman (6 Mar)	4	3	Four seafarer fatalities. Three severely injured
Al Jubayl, Saudi Arabia (7 Mar)	0	1	One seafarer injured
11NM north of Oman (11 Mar)	0	0	Fire on board. No injuries
25NM north-west of Ra's al Khaymah, UAE (11 Mar)	0	0	Hull damage. No injuries

Source: International Maritime Organization (IMO)

operating in the wider region have also been directed to comply with an existing daily reporting mechanism introduced by the DGS in 2024. Under this system, ships must submit their details each day through an online ship reporting form, allowing authorities to maintain a real-time database of vessel movements, and coordinate responses in case of a maritime security incident.

For vessels already operating in the region when the advisory was issued, additional measures have been prescribed. Masters or company security officers must immediately update the ship’s reporting status and provide the DG Communication Centre with full particulars of the vessel and crew list. Ships are also required to maintain an enhanced security posture throughout the transit; continuously monitor navigational warnings and maritime security advisories; review and fully implement their ship security plans, which outline the steps crews must follow during threats; and brief crews on emergency procedures for threats such as missiles, drones, sea mines and other attacks.

Masters and company security officers have also been instructed to immediately report any suspicious activity, interception, electronic interference, navigation disruption or hostile approach to the DG Communication Centre, which operates round the clock to coordinate responses with relevant maritime authorities.

Binish Varma, a seamen’s welfare officer at the DGS, said ships operating in sensitive waters follow established international training and safety standards. “Different levels of officers receive

specialised training in crisis management and maritime security procedures, and India regularly conducts such training, and certifies seafarers.”

In times of crisis

In the event of an incident, ships typically contact maritime rescue coordination centres in nearby coastal nations, while simultaneously informing their company and relevant authorities.

“These coordination centres exist in every coastal nation,” the official said, adding that countries in the region often work together to manage maritime emergencies.

To strengthen coordination during the current crisis, the DGS has set up a quick response team, which is working with families, shipping companies, recruitment agencies, trade unions, port authorities, and Indian missions abroad.

On board ships, however, crisis management begins with the captain.

Vessels follow structured procedures when geopolitical crises escalate, said Karan Kochhar, head of Marine People Asia at A P Moller-Maersk, a talent management division for seafarers and marine personnel across the Asia-Pacific region.

“When a crisis arises, the first step on board a vessel is to gather accurate information,” Kochhar said, adding that the captain typically calls an emergency meeting with senior officers. Here, information from company security teams, maritime advisories and other credible sources is reviewed before the captain briefs the crew on potential risks and the actions required.

The vessel’s bridge team continuously monitors updates, reassessing risks

based on the ship’s location and developments in the region. Depending on the threat level, additional measures may be implemented, including controlled access to the vessel, heightened bridge vigilance, and readiness of emergency communication systems.

Manan Arora, a chief officer in the merchant navy, said shipping companies, and protection and indemnity clubs — mutual insurance groups that cover liabilities such as accidents, pollution and crew injury through member contributions — closely monitor geopolitical developments and accordingly issue operational guidance.

Merchant ships do not carry weapons, although private armed security personnel may sometimes be deployed when transiting piracy-prone areas, he said. In certain high-risk regions, such as the Gulf of Aden, vessels may also coordinate with naval forces and travel in convoys escorted by warships.

For crews at sea, maintaining morale during crises can be as important as operational preparedness.

“Transparent communication from the captain and continuing with routine operations help keep the crew composed,” Arora said. Shared meals, regular work schedules, and contact with families help reduce anxiety during prolonged periods of uncertainty, Kochhar added.

Few things, however, prepare a sailor for missiles whizzing past the ship.

“At first, we couldn’t sleep,” said the sailor quoted above. “Now, we are slowly getting used to the situation.”

For thousands of seafarers still navigating the Gulf’s volatile waters, this uneasy adaptation has become part of daily life.

CDSCO asks drugmakers selling GLP-1 to refrain from advertising

Drug regulator says any such awareness or promotional campaign will be seen as misleading marketing practice

SANKET KOUL
New Delhi, 11 March

The Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) has asked all drugmakers having marketing authorisation to sell glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) agonist drugs for obesity management to not partake in any promotional activities for the prescription-only drug.

GLP-1 agonists are a class of medicines that help regulate blood sugar, increase fullness (satiety), and slow stomach emptying, leading to weight loss and improved glucose control in patients with Type-2 diabetes and obesity.

“Any promotional activity, including so-called awareness campaigns that function as a surrogate advertisement for prescription-only drugs shall be viewed seriously and may be treated as irrational or misleading marketing practice,” the central drug regulatory body said in a public advisory dated March 11.

This comes after some pharmaceutical companies have stepped up multimedia awareness campaigns, not directly promoting their drugs, but building awareness around obesity being a disease and encouraging users to consult doctors, as the race for India’s GLP-1 drug market intensifies.

American pharma major Eli Lilly has been running a multimedia obesity awareness campaign since last year, and recently it ran ad films featuring celebrities like Boman Irani, Ratna Pathak, and Supriya Pathak to raise-a-



COMPANIES ARE TURNING TO MULTIMEDIA CAMPAIGNS FOCUSED ON OBESITY AWARENESS SINCE INDIAN REGULATIONS PROHIBIT DIRECT-TO-CONSUMER DRUG ADVERTISING

wareness of obesity as a disease and urge doctor consultations.

Similarly, Danish drugmaker Novo Nordisk recently ran an advertisement on the front page of a leading national daily, urging readers to consult a doctor for obesity management.

As a result, the CDSCO has prohibited all manufacturers, importers, and marketing authorisation holders from advertising GLP-1-based products.

“Any promotional activity carried out under the pretext of disease awareness, influencer engagement, corpor-

ate campaigns, or similar activities that create brand recall/product visibility of the prescription shall also be treated as violations,” the advisory added.

With Novo Nordisk’s blockbuster GLP-1 agonist drug semaglutide, better known by its brand name Ozempic, going off patent on March 20, Indian markets are also expected to be flooded with more than 30 cheaper generic versions.

Over the past year, new launches in the injectable GLP-1 agonist segment — such as Mounjaro, Wegovy and Ozempic — have already driven a 177 per cent rise in sales in this category on a moving annual turnover (MAT) basis to ₹1,446 crore in February 2026, compared with ₹571 crore in February 2025.

Of these, Mounjaro and Ozempic are currently approved in India only for Type-2 diabetes, and prescriptions are restricted to diabetic patients.

However, with awareness among the broader population limited, companies are turning to multimedia campaigns focused on obesity awareness since Indian regulations prohibit direct-to-consumer drug advertising.

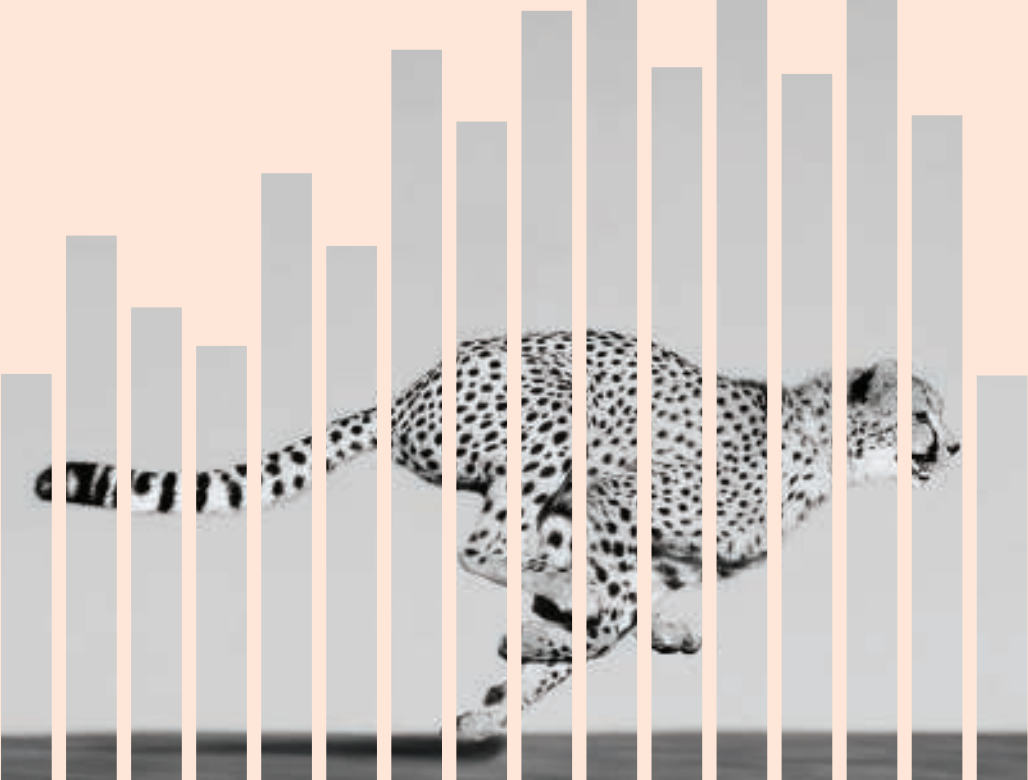
India’s large disease burden has also made it an attractive market for weight-loss therapies. According to the World Health Organisation (WHO) estimates for 2023-24, the country has around 101 million people living with diabetes, and another 136 million with pre-diabetes.

Studies suggest India also has 254 million people with generalised obesity, and 351 million with abdominal obesity.

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